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Trump's limits on mail-in votes can proceed

Justices allow for start of process but final legality of plan remains unclear

By Abbie VanSickle
and Ann E. Marimow
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — A divided Supreme Court on Monday allowed the Trump administration to move forward with plans to restrict mail-in voting before the midterm elections. In an emergency order, the justices said President Trump could proceed with implementing an executive order he had signed, which directed the US Postal Service to help decide which voters should receive

mail-in ballots. Under the executive order, the Department of Homeland Security will also create lists of citizens that the administration believes could be used to monitor voter rolls for noncitizens. The decision means the administration can move ahead with planning for restricting the use of mail ballots even as a lower court continues to weigh the legality of Trump's executive order. But with a little more than two months until Election Day — and considerably less

time before early voting begins in many states — it remains unclear whether the White House's rules will be in effect for a midterm election in which control of both chambers is at stake. Additional legal action is a near certainty with the plan's fate not yet final. A separate injunction by the same lower court complicates matters. That court action prevents the Postal Service from implementing some parts of the executive order. That case could also soon be headed to the justices. Monday's order from the Supreme Court was unsigned, as is typical in such emergency rulings. The

majority wrote that it agreed with the government's argument that it should be able to move forward with its plans, finding that the Trump administration was "likely to suffer irreparable harm" unless the justices lifted a freeze that had been imposed by lower courts. The three liberal justices dissented, with Justice Ketanji Brown Jackson warning that the majority "needlessly injects chaos and uncertainty into the upcoming midterm elections." The majority said the states that challenged the president's order could not demonstrate that they

VOTING, Page A4

In a first, biotech jobs fall in Mass.

Signs, however point toward a comeback, heartening sector

By Jonathan Saltzman
GLOBE STAFF

The number of people working in Massachusetts' renowned biotech sector fell last year, the first time that's happened since at least 2002, according to a new report. The state's biopharma workforce shrank by about 3,600 employees in 2025, to a total of 113,503, as industry headwinds and uncertainty about federal funding for scientific research battered the sector, according to the annual "industry snapshot" by the Massachusetts Biotechnology Council trade group. Compared to 2024, the workforce declined by 3.1 percent.

3.1%
decline in biotech jobs, a loss of 3,600 workers.

Many of the lab buildings in Greater Boston that everyone thought would be filled with scientists when venture capital flowed freely early in the pandemic now stand empty, a symbol of what former Federal Reserve chairman Alan Greenspan once dubbed irrational exuberance. But before you bet against landing a biotech job in Massachusetts, take note: the 2025 employment total is almost certainly already out of date, said Ben Bradford, head of external affairs for MassBio. That's good news for Massachusetts, where biotech pumped roughly \$42 billion into the state's economy in 2024, according to the group's most recent available estimate. Workforce numbers typically lag behind a re-

JOBS, Page A10



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

The Orange Line is still running south of the Back Bay Station. It won't be, however, from Sept. 10 to 14.

For T riders once more: It's off the beaten/soldered/replaced track

With Red, Green, then Orange lines down, another season of discontent looms

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

In the relative quiet of July, once the World Cup ended and the tall ships sailed away, the MBTA embarked on a slate of improvement projects that closed part of the Red Line, then the Green, and now the Orange. The parade of shutdowns has disrupted untold daily routines and forced T riders to strategize, frequently and frustratingly, about how to navigate Greater Boston with one train line inoperable almost all the time. Hannah Kirby last week planned to walk the two miles to her job as a clinical researcher during the ongoing Orange Line

stoppage. Leonardo Dantas decided he would rather work from his Melrose home than fight his way downtown. And Sophia Kotelly realized she would have to find another way to her boyfriend's apartment at Assembly Square. "I like to assume they're doing really great work down there during the shutdowns," added Jonathan Padrazo, an Orange Line rider from Malden whose daily travel time to his Back Bay job has doubled during the closure. "But it's difficult for me no matter which way you put it." Faced with an ever-mounting backlog of repairs and construction projects, the T under general manager Phil Eng is now regu-

larly shutting subway lines for extended periods instead of limiting work to nights and weekends when it is less disruptive to the traveling public. Agency leaders say the prolonged closures allow the T to catch up on years of deferred maintenance, faster and at less cost. "We're doing this work instead of kicking the can down the road," chief operating officer Ryan Coholan said. The problem for riders is obvious: Disruptions have seemingly sprouted everywhere, putting strap-hangers through a cascade of service suspensions that began last month and will continue through the fall.

SHUTDOWNS, Page A7

Healey's focus turns to public safety record

She says it's not campaign issue; GOP rivals disagree

By Chris Van Buskirk
GLOBE STAFF

Governor Maura Healey drilled home a message when she signed a major immigration bill this month: The new law banning federal agents from making warrantless arrests in state courthouses was about "public safety." The law's focus, she emphasized, is "protecting public safety." "The law I'm signing today," she added, if only to underline the point, "is a public safety law." Healey, in turn, also gave herself a plank to add to her campaign platform. The first-term Democrat and her supporters have repeatedly tried to firm up her public safety credentials and guard her right flank against attacks concerning crime by two Republicans vying to challenge her in November. In recent months, Healey twice pressed to seat a former prosecutor on the state's Parole Board, de-

PUBLIC SAFETY, Page A7

Prosecution witness rejects Clancy claim

Testifies that her goal was to kill herself

By Shelley Murphy,
Travis Andersen,
and Lea Skene
GLOBE STAFF

PLYMOUTH — A forensic psychologist who evaluated Lindsay Clancy for prosecutors testified Monday that he rejects her claim she killed her three children while following the commands of a male voice in her head during a postpartum psychotic episode. Kirk Heilbrun offered a different motive that supports the prosecution's theo-



GREG DERR/THE PATRIOT LEDGER/POOL

A psychologist said Lindsay Clancy had "intrusive thoughts."

ry of the murder case against Clancy. He told jurors he concluded that Clancy had been having "intrusive thoughts" about killing herself for months and decided to commit suicide in early 2023 and take her children with her because "she was convinced that they would suffer without her." He suggested Clancy's claim about the voice was contrived, saying it was "very unusual" because she never heard the "command hallucination" before she strangled 5-year-old Cora, 3-year-old Dawson, and 8-month-old Callan in the basement

CLANCY, Page A10

A body found in the woods is believed to be a woman who is a suspect in the death of her husband, a veteran Worcester police officer. **B1.**

The Trump administration is preparing to revoke the business and tourism visas of up to 200,000 foreigners who are seeking asylum in what would be the largest single mass revocation of visas in US history. **A4.**

The Trump administration called it an economic apocalypse for Iran but it did not reveal many details of its plan to turn the fighting there into an economic battle. **A3.**

Massachusetts businesses and consumers could pay a price for President Trump's 50 percent tariffs on Canadian goods, Larry Edelman writes. **D1.**



Identical twin suns

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High 78-83, low 63-68.

Wednesday: Lots of sun.
High 78-83, low 63-68.

Sunrise: 6:02. Sunset: 7:30.

Weather and comics, **D5-6.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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Farmers struggle with Agriculture Dept.

Basic services suffer amid a depleted agency

By Linda Qiu
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — Mary and Zachariah Ben, farmers in New Mexico, believed they were on the verge of buying the property of their dreams last fall: 47 acres, with enough cropland to grow heirloom corn and a processing facility to expand their organic baby food business.

But the low-interest loan they secured from the Agriculture Department to make the purchase in Aztec, N.M., was on hold for months, first during the government shutdown that lasted until mid-November and then as federal workers left the agency in droves. Only half a dozen loan specialists who could help process their claims remained in the entire state, the couple learned, leaving them in limbo indefinitely and the seller impatient to know whether the agreement would ever go through.

Zachariah Ben, who along with his children is a member of the Navajo Nation, ultimately turned to private lenders instead, and the family absorbed more than \$200,000 in interest as a result. “At least we got the land because we could have also lost that, and we would have if we had to wait” on the Agriculture Department, Mary Ben said.

The experience of the Bens, whose aim of providing organic and shelf-stable options for young children appears to align with some of the Trump administration’s stated goals, is not unique. Across the country, farmers and rural residents describe struggling to obtain the basic services the Agriculture Department is meant to offer, including loans and grants, technical assistance, and financing for housing and utilities. Sharp attrition under the



NINA RIGGIO/NEW YORK TIMES

Mary and Zachariah Ben were trailed by their children as they harvested squash for their baby food business in Aztec, N.M.

Trump administration, largely through voluntary resignations and dismissals by the Department of Government Efficiency, have left many of the Agriculture Department’s local offices with skeletal staffing — and, in some counties, with no one at all.

The ripple effects of the Agriculture Department’s depleted workforce illustrate how the Trump administration’s mission of shrinking the federal bureaucracy has undercut a competing priority: delivering for farmers, a core political constituency. Strained government resources also risk posing additional challenges for a farm economy that administration officials have described as “dire,” increasing barriers to entry for new farmers who need more assistance, imped-

ing assistance to producers already facing tough economic conditions, and hampering basic services and government aid in the most remote and poorest places.

“All these practical things that make the wheels go around in a community were facilitated by USDA, and it was with staff who knew how to navigate and had the trust of the local community,” Senator Pete Welch of Vermont, the top Democrat on the Senate subcommittee on rural development, said in an interview. “It’s something that was working, was working well, and was very cost-efficient. And now it is being demolished.”

Trump administration officials have defended the staffing cuts as voluntary and necessary to trim a bloated agency.

Overall, more than 20,000 workers out of more than 110,000 left the Agriculture Department through the first half of 2025, according to an inspector general report. Recently obtained data showed that the Farm Service Agency, a division whose approval the Bens sought in applying for a low-interest loan, has no staff left in dozens of counties across the country, forcing farmers to travel long distances for assistance or to simply give up. Among divisions that directly work with farmers and aid rural residents, the percentage of departures is even higher.

The Agriculture Department said it currently had about 93,000 employees after hiring more workers this year, and that it believed staffing lev-

els were adequate as “services and supports have become more targeted and efficient” through planned technological improvements.

Still, its plans to fundamentally overhaul the agency, as well as funding cuts proposed by President Trump’s latest budget, are likely to deepen difficulties for farmers and rural communities.

Already, the agency is moving more than half of its staff in the Washington region out of the nation’s capital, a move that is all but certain to further thin the ranks of the agency.

Likewise, Trump’s budget for the next fiscal year proposes a nearly \$5 billion cut to the Agriculture Department, essentially eliminating programs for beginning farmers, conservation, and rural aid.

DAILY BRIEFING

US military kills 2 in attack on boat in Pacific

WASHINGTON — The US military killed two men in a strike against a boat in the eastern Pacific that it said was transporting narcotics, US Southern Command announced early Monday. It was the first such strike by the military since June 21.

The United States began a campaign of boat strikes last year in the run-up to the military operation that seized Nicolás Maduro, the president of Venezuela. The military has continued the operations in the Caribbean and the eastern Pacific, killing at least 223 people in 67 strikes that it said were involved in the narcotics trade.

But narcotics experts say the boat strikes have failed to slow the smuggling of cocaine from South America to the United States. According to Brown University, the costs of the operation were \$4.7 billion as of March 31.

Legal specialists also have said the strikes are illegal extrajudicial killings because the military is not permitted to deliberately target civilians — even suspected criminals — who do not pose an imminent threat of violence.

Southern Command provided little detail about the Sunday strike but noted that intelligence reports said the vessel was trafficking narcotics and traveling on a route used by drug smugglers.

“Joint Task Force Western Hemisphere executed a lethal kinetic strike on a low-profile vessel operating along established narco-trafficking routes in the Eastern Pacific,” Southern Command said in a statement.

NEW YORK TIMES



TREVOR BEXON/GETTY IMAGES

Firefighters make progress against Nev. wildfire that’s destroyed 30 homes

RENO, Nev. — Crews have started to contain a wildfire in the Sierra Nevada foothills near Reno, Nev., that destroyed more than 30 homes as it spread perilously close to dense neighborhoods, officials said Monday.

Containment reached 27 percent, and there was no new growth of the Hawk Fire, which

has held steady at about 23 square miles since it burned out of control on Sunday, authorities said at an afternoon news briefing.

“We are making progress,” said US Forest Service District Ranger Matt Zumstein.

The number of residents under evacuation orders and

warnings was reduced to about 63,000, down from more than 90,000 people when the blaze mushroomed over the weekend. While winds have eased, there’s still concern that gusts could push the flames through dry brush into newly developed neighborhoods in Nevada’s largest city outside of metro Las

The Hawk Fire burned on Sunday in Reno, Nev. Containment reached 27 percent, and there was no new growth of the fire, which has held steady at about 23 square miles since it burned out of control on Sunday, authorities said.

Vegas. Firefighters are also contending with hot temperatures and low humidity. At least 32 homes have burned, and six are damaged, but authorities said those numbers are sure to rise as assessment teams begin to survey the charred areas.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Prolonged heat wave to grip South

A prolonged and dangerous heat wave is set to grip parts of the Southern United States this week, as forecasters warned that temperatures are expected to soar into triple digits, with daily records at risk of being broken.

The most intense heat is initially expected across the Southern Plains and Lower Mississippi Valley before shifting west into parts of the Southwest later in the week.

Bob Oravec, a meteorologist at the Weather Prediction Center, said temperatures were expected to reach or exceed 100 degrees across large

parts of the region, with several daily record highs possible, particularly in Texas and Oklahoma.

The heat will not ease much after sunset, with much of the South expected to remain above 80 degrees for several nights in a row.

The Weather Prediction Center issued extreme heat warnings and heat advisories across large areas of Louisiana, Oklahoma, southwest Arkansas, Texas, and southeast New Mexico, as well as for portions of Southern California and central and southern Arizona.

NEW YORK TIMES

Convicted ex-deputy dies in prison

A former Illinois sheriff’s deputy who shot and killed a Black woman at her home after she called 911 died Sunday while serving a 20-year murder sentence.

Sean Grayson, 32, who was white, was found guilty in October of second-degree murder in the 2024 killing of Sonya Massey, a rare in-

stance of an American law enforcement officer convicted of a crime in an on-duty shooting.

He was sentenced in January and had been in prison for just over six months when he

died.

His lawyer, Daniel Fultz, confirmed his death but declined to provide further details.

Grayson had applied for medical release but was unanimously denied by the Illinois Prisoner Review Board last month.

During his sentencing, Grayson’s lawyers said he had colon cancer that had spread to his liver and lungs. Judge Ryan Cadagin gave Grayson the maximum sentence allowed.

NEW YORK TIMES

Colleges revisit required testing

Rise of AI raises essay concerns

By Alan Blinder
and Mark Arsenault
NEW YORK TIMES

A new era of college admissions is unfolding after years of turmoil.

Standardized testing requirements are being revived, or are under consideration, from coast to coast. Admissions officers at both big public schools, like the University of Georgia, and top-tier private institutions, like Washington University in St. Louis, are shedding some application essays. Administrators everywhere are fretting about what role artificial intelligence may play in applications.

The COVID-19 pandemic led many schools to loosen their processes and, in many cases, rely more on components like essays. But AI’s rise, questions about student preparation, the end of affirmative action, and the Trump administration’s campaign to prioritize “merit” in admissions are driving a swing back.

College applications were up during the last admissions cycle, after a more diverse pool of students applied and students applied to more schools on average. But demographic shifts are expected to send enrollments diving in the coming years. At the same time, higher education is wrestling with concerns about the value of college, especially as AI starts to reshape the workforce.

As schools prepare for a future with fewer students and more AI, approaches that make applying to college simpler — and more attractive to families — could help them cushion the impact.

The personal essay is still central to many college applications. But supplementary essays are falling out of favor.

Tulane University, for instance, paused its requirement for applicants to write about why they want to attend the school. Concerns about potential AI-generated essays “were definitely a factor,” said Michael Strecker, a university spokesperson.

Georgia, Cornell University, the University of Virginia, and Texas Christian University have recently pared back essay requirements. Washington University dropped an optional essay that many applicants apparently did not consider truly optional.

Reducing the number of required essays makes applying easier, which tends to raise a school’s application numbers. By attracting more applicants, a school lowers its acceptance rate, which can make it appear more exclusive — though many colleges do not want to be seen as intentionally pumping up rejection notices.

While Georgia’s decision to drop a supplemental essay was more about simplifying the process for applicants, other experts said the possibility that students are using AI to help with essays is a rising concern.

“AI has hastened the realization that the written word in this context isn’t necessarily an accurate representation of how somebody thinks and how somebody writes,” said Christoph Guttentag, who retired in 2025 as dean of undergraduate admissions at Duke University after having read student applications for 42 years.

For the record

■ **Correction:** A caption with a story on the use of social media in the real estate industry on the Business front Monday mischaracterized the role of real estate agent Katherine Kraneburg. She represents a potential buyer of the Newton condominium.

The Globe welcomes information about errors that call for corrections. Information may be sent to comments@globe.com or left in a message at 617-929-8230.

The World

DAILY BRIEFING

US Marines cancel drill with S. Korea

SEOUL — The United States has canceled a joint amphibious landing exercise with South Korean forces that was set for next month, citing resource constraints driven by the war in Iran, the South Korean military announced Monday.

The US Marine Corps had notified its South Korean counterpart in June that Middle East operational demands would prevent the deployment of forces for the biennial exercise, the South Korean Marine Corps said Monday.

The move marked the second joint military drill with South Korea to be canceled or downsized during President Trump's second term. The decision has intensified doubts over Washington's commitment to maintaining a credible deterrent on the Korean Peninsula and its capacity to manage concurrent global conflicts, as US weapons stockpiles have fallen to troubling levels.

NEW YORK TIMES

Congo death toll hits weekly record

BUNIA, Congo — More than 300 people died of Ebola in eastern Congo in the past week, one of the highest weekly tolls yet, government data showed Monday, as health workers struggle to catch up with an outbreak that is spreading at unprecedented speed.

Ministry of Health data showed that as of Saturday, the outbreak had recorded 5,514 cases and 2,642 deaths, including 317 deaths reported in the previous seven days. But Congolese experts have said the outbreak that started weeks before it was confirmed could be three times the known size.

This is the fastest-growing Ebola outbreak in history, with many people dying outside treatment centers. It has recorded seven times more deaths at this stage than the 2014-2016 West Africa Ebola outbreak, which is the deadliest in history, with more than 11,000 in all.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Deportees sent on to another nation

DAKAR, Senegal — Six people who were deported by the United States to Liberia last week resisted getting off the plane and instead were sent to Equatorial Guinea, another African nation that signed a third-country deportation agreement with the Trump administration, a person on the plane and a lawyer in contact with the six said Monday.

Under a series of often secret agreements, the Trump administration has deported thousands of people to two dozen countries that aren't their own as it pushes ahead with its immigration crackdown, advocates say. Immigration lawyers say the practice is being used as a legal loophole to indirectly return some asylum seekers to countries they fled.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Turkey sentences 5 opposition mayors

ISTANBUL — A Turkish court on Monday convicted five mayors of municipalities run by the country's main opposition party on corruption charges in a trial that critics have denounced as politically motivated.

The case before an Istanbul court included allegations of bribery, bid-rigging, and fraud in relation to municipal contracts. Critics of the government of Turkish President Recep Tayyip Erdogan say the trial targeted the opposition Republican People's Party and that the prosecution relied on secret witnesses and defendants implicating other defendants in return for lighter punishment.

The Turkish government insists the country's judiciary is free from political influence.

ASSOCIATED PRESS



ROMAN PILIPEY/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

SOLEMN VISITATION — A woman visited a makeshift memorial for fallen Ukrainian and foreign soldiers during Ukraine's Independence Day on Independence Square in Kyiv on Monday, as Moscow amps up warnings aimed at the British government. **A5.**

US moves to cripple Iran's economy

Details scarce on Trump's plan to isolate foe

By Alan Rappeport
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration Monday announced what it called its most comprehensive assault to date on Iran's economy, unveiling a package of measures that are intended to isolate Iran from the rest of the world.

The move is a shift by the United States in favor of confronting Iran with economic warfare as negotiations to end the military conflict continue to sputter. The war with Iran remains a drag on the global economy, one that has pushed energy prices higher and eroded President Trump's approval ratings.

The Trump administration has billed the effort as the coming of an economic apocalypse for Iran. But the announcement Monday did not make clear how the measures would further disrupt Iran's economy or whether they would be severe enough to get Iran to end its nuclear program and allow oil to move freely through the Strait of Hormuz.

Trump, who carried out a "maximum pressure" campaign against Iran during his first term, enacted a package of measures called Operation Economic Fury aimed at Iran earlier this year. Monday, Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent characterized the announcement as D-Day,

but later acknowledged it was more of a warning shot that would begin a period of "quiet diplomacy" with counterparts around the world.

Speaking at the Treasury Department, Bessent labeled the initiative Operation Economic Outcast, and vowed that the United States would "tighten the noose" around Iran by imposing sanctions on every source or facilitator of its revenue. The campaign is intended to exert pressure on other countries that continue to trade with Iran or help it evade US sanctions.

"This is a sustained campaign to collapse every last option for Iran," Bessent said. "The campaign we begin today will gather force with every day that follows, and it will not end until this regime stands alone."

The new Iran sanctions include more than 60 entities, individuals, and vessels around the world that allow Iran to procure nuclear and missile technology, Bessent said. The Treasury Department is also imposing sanctions on Iran related to digital assets, gold, and the aviation sectors that Iran uses to help finance its economy.

Bessent said that waves of additional sanctions, including on a large financial institution, would be announced in the coming days and weeks.

Much of the work of isolating Iran, he added, will take place through private negotiations with other countries to compel them to cut ties with



JULIA DEMAREE NIKHINSON/ASSOCIATED PRESS

In Washington, D.C., Monday, Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said the US would "tighten the noose" around Iran.

Iran. The Treasury secretary said the United States did not have a set timeline for such talks, but that it did not have "infinite patience." The threat of the new sanctions already appeared to be yielding results, with the United Arab Emirates announcing last week that it is halting all trade and financial transactions with Iran.

The United States has a unique ability to use sanctions as a diplomatic tool because of the status of the dollar as the world's reserve currency. Because the dollar is used in most of the world's financial transactions, the Treasury Department has the ability to cut individuals and businesses off from much of the global financial system. However, overuse of these tools has the potential to push countries away from using dollars and could create chaos across

the world economy.

Bessent suggested that the United States was giving other nations an opportunity to sever their relationships with Iran before embarking on broader "secondary" sanctions.

"We are giving everyone the opportunity to remedy bad behavior," Bessent said.

In an acknowledgment that a barrage of new sanctions aimed at countries around the world could have unwanted consequences, Bessent added: "Why would I want to blow up the global financial system?"

The most complicated of the diplomatic negotiations will be with China, which is the largest buyer of Iranian oil and has a financial system that is largely insulated from the threat of US sanctions. Asked about sanctions on Chinese banks, Bessent said, "No one is above the reach

of US sanctions" but did not address China specifically.

The United States is in a fragile trade truce with China and its president, Xi Jinping, is expected to meet with Trump next month. The Treasury Department has imposed sanctions on independent Chinese refineries that buy Iranian oil, but it has refrained from imposing large-scale sanctions on Chinese financial institutions that facilitate such transactions.

"Until we see actions against more meaningful countries and companies continuing to trade with Iran, it's just words," said Daniel Tannebaum, a partner at Oliver Wyman and senior fellow at The Atlantic Council. "Ideally, quiet diplomacy is playing out between Trump and Xi to make a deal to pull China from Iran, but that's a big question in terms of how much influence President Trump has there."

Iran's Foreign Ministry said Monday that Iran would not bow to an escalating pressure campaign by the Trump administration, after one of the country's top security chiefs threatened reprisals against countries that joined the United States' "economic war."

Esmail Baghaei, the Foreign Ministry spokesperson, said Monday that the Trump administration was merely "repeating methods that have proven unsuccessful" in the past.

"Iran will certainly use all multilateral capacities to counter economic sanctions," he told reporters at a news conference.

Iran cracks down on youth luxury: coffee shops

Claims the cafe culture causes misconduct

By Leily Nikounazar and Yeganeh Torbati
NEW YORK TIMES

Through war, political unrest, and rampant inflation that has put the dreams of many beyond reach, Iran's youth have held on to one luxury that helps them feel normal in abnormal times: frequenting coffee shops with friends.

Across the country, they pack into cafes and spill out onto the sidewalk — chatting, smoking cigarettes, flirting, and enjoying one of the few affordable diversions still available to them. These mixed-gender gatherings, where women go unveiled and some customers even discreetly drink alcohol, both illegal acts in Iran, have become a conspicuous counter-culture, visible to any passerby.

It has not escaped the attention of the authorities, either. In

recent weeks, police have been shutting down dozens of cafes, usually citing a failure to abide by Iran's mandatory hijab law.

The crackdown has stretched across the country, taking in restaurants and boutiques as well, according to statements from officials, though some businesses have since reopened.

It is a social scene, experts say, that challenges the government's efforts to dominate Iran's public spaces. Since nationwide protests in January that began over the spiraling economy and were crushed by lethal force, the government has sought to tightly control any public gatherings.

And as the United States' war with Iran, aimed in part at unseating the Islamic Republic, drags on without resolution, the regime has held progovernment nighttime rallies that serve both to bolster a narrative of popular public support and dissuade dissidents from protesting.

Cafe owners, employees, and their customers in Tehran said in interviews that the authori-

ties appeared to be targeting cafes that were clustered next to each other. The small footprint of these businesses often means that customers linger on the sidewalk, forming spontaneous gatherings that the authorities regard with wariness.

"It seems that a campaign has begun to control postwar Iran, a society that is unhappy and under strain," said Amir, 45, a cafe owner in Tehran who said his business was not shuttered in the latest round but had been previously. "We always console ourselves with the thought that this is just a wave. They come and shut us down, but we rise again."

Amir, like other Iranians interviewed for this article, asked to be identified only by his first name for fear of retribution from Iran's government.

"The cafes are being shut down because of the crowds that gather outside them in the afternoons," said Mona, 36, an artist in Tehran. The authorities, she said, "seem to think it's some kind of protest gathering

or something, when really it's just a bunch of young women and men who look a little different from what the officials are used to, hanging out together."

Iran's Foreign Ministry did not respond to a request for comment. Authorities have given various justifications for shutting down the businesses, from regulatory violations to not complying with mandatory hijab rules. "Social and moral misconduct," "failing to observe Islamic values," and "norm-breaking" have also been cited.

Indeed, the coffee shops, with their impromptu gatherings and customers who flout the hijab law, do break the rules and norms that the government expects Iranians to abide by. Three Tehran residents, including one cafe owner, said that many of the cafes in central Tehran were known for serving beer. Alcohol consumption in Iran is punishable by lashing.

Haleh Mir Miri, an author and researcher in Canada who has written a book on Iran's coffee shop culture, said the scene

serves both as a respite from family and social restrictions and as a rejection of the government's ideology.

"Through cafe culture, people could imagine and invent other ways of living and becoming," she said. "For a totalitarian government accustomed to homogenizing people's lives, that is inherently dangerous."

Even if the closures are an effort to disrupt this cafe culture, the government has struggled to curb drastic changes in Iranian society over the past four years.

In summer 2022, the then-government of President Ebrahim Raisi harshly cracked down on women who were not abiding by the compulsory hijab rule. The authorities carried out violent arrests, and a 22-year-old woman, Mahsa Amini, died in custody after being detained by Iran's morality police.

So far, the current government led by President Masoud Pezeshkian appears to have largely refrained from arresting individual women for not wearing hijabs.

Justices allow mail-in vote plan to proceed

►VOTING
Continued from Page A1

were sufficiently harmed by voting rules that had not yet taken effect. The justices cautioned that their order was preliminary and not a final decision about whether the administration’s order “will necessarily be lawful” once the plans are complete. “On that score, time will tell,” the majority said in the 10-page, unsigned order.

In response to the court’s order, New York Attorney General Letitia James called the ruling a “painful setback” but predicted it would not be the final word from the court.

“The right to vote is sacred, and no administration should be allowed to put that right in jeopardy by making it harder for eligible voters to cast their ballots,” she said in a statement. “This fight is far from over. We are exploring our legal options.”

Trump signed the executive order in March as part of his broader attempts to curtail voting by mail. It directed federal agencies to create “state citizenship lists” of people who will be 18 or older as of Election Day.

Federal officials were then directed to send those names to state election officials, who administer the vote, purportedly so they could use them to purge voter registration lists of anyone who is not a citizen. The order also instructed the Postal Service not to mail ballots on behalf of anyone whose name was not on the approved list.

Several court challenges immediately followed, including a lawsuit in federal court in Massachusetts brought by Democratic state attorneys general. The challengers argued that the president exceeded his authority because the US Constitution gives Congress and the states power over elections, not the executive branch.

In late June, Judge Indira Talwani, a US District Court judge in Massachusetts, temporarily blocked the president’s order, finding that it violated the Constitution’s separation of powers. She also determined that Congress had not delegated authority to the Postal Service to determine which voters should receive mail ballots and that the executive order did not allow enough time be-



ASSOCIATED PRESS 2020 FILE

A District Court judge from Massachusetts had ruled that states and Congress hold power over elections.

fore November for the Postal Service to follow the legally required process for agencies when they adopt new rules.

Talwani issued a separate broader ruling in a related case this month, blocking any enforcement of the executive order for the 2026 midterms. She again emphasized that the Constitution does not grant authority over elections to the executive branch. She also noted that, con-

trary to Trump’s claims of widespread voter fraud, the government had not provided “evidentiary support of illegal or fraudulent absentee voting.”

A federal appeals court earlier upheld Talwani’s temporary block. At that point, Trump administration lawyers filed an emergency application asking the justices to step in. Several Republican state attorneys general filed a separate request.

In a brief to the court, the Democratic state attorneys general wrote that the executive order “would allow the federal government to rush out an unprecedented, legally indefensible voter-verification and ballot-interception program that would, among other things, give the U.S. Postal Service far-reaching new powers and responsibilities.”

They also argued that allowing the order to be implemented would mean a chaotic rollout not long before states begin to send out absentee ballots.

And they wrote that voters could be confused and disenfranchised, given that the federal government was likely to make errors in compiling citizen lists and that valid voters would have little time to challenge the government’s determinations.

Using mail ballots has become increasingly popular with voters of both parties, with about 30 percent of all ballots cast that way during the 2024 presidential election, according to federal data.

Material from the Associated Press was used in this report.

US set for largest visa revocation in history

Effort will target up to 200,000 asylum seekers

By Matthew Lee
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration is preparing to revoke the business and tourism visas of up to 200,000 foreigners who have applied for or are currently seeking asylum status in the United States. If it happens, the move would be the largest single mass revocation of visas in US history and would likely face legal challenges.

Unless challenged or revised, the State Department is expected to announce in the coming weeks the revocation of so-called B1 and B2 visas issued between 2016 and 2026 whose holders have sought asylum or are now seeking asylum, according to State Department documents obtained by the Associated Press and two US officials. The action will be taken in coordination with the Department of Homeland Security.

“We are coordinating with DHS to identify and revoke the nonimmigrant visas of foreigners who have come to the United States claiming to be short-term visitors, but then file for asylum to stay here permanently,” said State Department spokesman Tommy Pigott.

He declined to comment on the number of visas that might be revoked, saying “as the process will be ongoing, the number of revocations remains dynamic and will be done on a rolling basis.”

The revocations would not necessarily result in their immediate deportation, the officials said. Most of those with asylum cases currently pending would be recategorized but would lose their status as business or tourism travelers, according to the officials, who spoke on condition of anonymity because the revocations are not final yet.

Since President Trump took office for his second term last year, his administration has steadily ramped up restrictions on visa applicants — demanding more information about their social media histories, requiring the posting of expensive bonds for the processing of visas, and outright banning the issuance of visas to citizens of certain countries.

In a social media post on Monday, Deputy Secretary of State Christopher Landau called out people who he said try to use tourist and business visas to get into the United States and then apply for asylum.

“People in the US and all over the world are fed up with bogus asylum claims,” Landau wrote on X. “Asylum isn’t supposed to be a loophole to circumvent immigration law.”

B1 visas are generally issued for business trips and B2 visas are generally issued for tourism, family visits, or medical care. It was not immediately clear from the documents or the officials how many of these visa holders are seeking or have sought asylum in the United States and would be affected by the revocations.

Current applicants for B1 and B2 visas are asked to affirm that they will not apply for asylum in the United States and prove that they intend to return to their home countries.

In the past 18 months, the State Department has revoked about 175,000 visas for people who have been convicted or accused of crimes ranging from drunken driving to rape and robbery, as well as for people who have spoken out publicly against US policies, particularly in the Middle East.

The administration has also moved to crack down on so-called birth tourism, a practice the administration claims is used by foreign pregnant women to come to the United States to give birth so that their child will benefit from birthright citizenship. Trump has tried several times to end birthright citizenship, but those challenges have been rejected by courts, including the Supreme Court.

Democrats’ chances of winning back Senate improving

As a tumultuous primary season draws to a close, Democrats have opened up more than one path to winning control of the Senate, according to strategists in both parties and independent analysts, reshaping the battle on a map where Republicans still hold significant advantages.

Voters are uneasy about President Trump’s handling of the economy, and his unpopular war with Iran has driven increases in the costs of fuel, food, and health services, putting Republicans on the defensive in states they once saw as much safer terrain.

The basic contours of the map remain challenging for Democrats. Holding 47 seats in the Senate, they must flip at least four to win a majority. At the same time, they are trying to defend seats in two states Trump won in 2024. And four of the six most competitive races are in states Trump won by double digits.

Republicans are also hoping that Democratic divisions in two important battlegrounds, Maine and Michigan, could help offset some of the political headwinds.

But Trump’s approval rating is below 40 percent, unnerving Republicans, who worry that voters in the center will break for Democrats. And rank-and-file Democratic voters are plainly energized: They have been turning out in huge numbers for primaries.

Now the battle for the Senate, once seen as tilting heavily toward the GOP, is increasingly up for grabs.

The latest show of Democratic strength came last week in conservative-leaning Alaska. Former Rep. Mary Peltola, a Democrat who had recently fired a top aide and changed campaign managers, led Senator Dan S. Sullivan, the Republican incumbent, by more than 5 percentage points in the state’s non-partisan primary, according to incomplete results.

By Thursday, the Cook Political Report, a nonpartisan election forecaster, moved races in Texas and Iowa from “Lean Republican” to “Toss Up,” citing polling and the economic environment.

The shift grew the core Senate battlefield from four states — Alaska, Maine, Michigan, and Ohio — to six, widening Democrats’ margin for error.

“It’s a 50-50 toss-up,” said Douglas Heye, a Republican strategist. “Republicans are nervous.”

While Republican groups have a vast cash advantage over Democratic ones, individual Democratic Senate candidates are handily outstripping their Republican opponents in most of the key Senate races.

NEW YORK TIMES

Trump’s economic approach worries some Republicans

President Trump’s economic policies drew a fresh round of concern from some Republicans



WIN MCNAMEE/GETTY IMAGES

CONSTRUCTION ZONE — President Trump showed off the White House helipad construction on the South Lawn of the White House after an event in the Rose Garden of the White House Monday. The multimillion-dollar granite helipad is designed to accommodate Marine One helicopters and is slated for completion in September.

this weekend who criticized his trade policies, as others in the party sidestepped questions about his broader approach amid a midterm election that has put consumer prices front and center.

Representative Ashley Hinson, Republican of Iowa, who is running in one of the most competitive Senate races, reiterated her opposition to Trump’s recent announcement that he would lower tariffs for up to 300,000 metric tons of imported ground beef over the next 90 days, which he claimed would push down costs.

“We need to focus on affordability, but I think this isn’t the way to do that,” Hinson told Fox News in an interview broadcast on “Sunday Morning Futures,” arguing it would hurt domestic cattle ranchers. The import taxes, she said, are helping US cattle ranchers restore the US cattle supply, which remains at a 75-year low.

On Saturday, Senator Susan Collins of Maine, considered one of the most vulnerable Republican incumbents, implored Trump to reverse course on Canadian import taxes and “reach a fair agreement” after trade talks between the United States and Canada collapsed.

Texas Governor Greg Abbott, a Republican who is running for reelection, refused to grade Trump on the economy when asked about it on ABC News’ “This Week” on Friday. He said that “people are not talking to me about Trump” on the campaign trail.

The comments from candidates in key races reflected the distance some Republicans have tried to draw from Trump at a moment when polls show that voters have major concerns about the economy and the president’s stewardship of it, in-

cluding cost increases driven by an unpopular war with Iran.

The White House did not respond to a request for comment.

NEW YORK TIMES

In South Carolina, Trump lays it on the line for Graham

President Trump has stuck his neck out for Senator Darline Graham.

In the weeks leading up to South Carolina’s primary election runoff for Senate on Tuesday, Trump traveled to Myrtle Beach to rally supporters and personally called high-level state officials to compel them to endorse Graham. A super political action committee run by his advisers, MAGA Inc., notoriously wary to spend on races this cycle, invested more than \$800,000 on phonecalls on her behalf, according to campaign finance filings released Monday, nearly a third of the total the committee has spent this year.

On the line: The president’s credibility in a state that twice in the past six months has rejected his preferences. In June, voters discarded his first choice for governor, prompting him to make a second endorsement in the final stretch. And earlier this year, the Republican-held state Senate declined to take up a new congressional map backed by Trump and other national Republicans that would have eliminated South Carolina’s lone majority Black district, which is held by a Democrat.

“What I really want you to do is pretend, please, that I’m on the ballot,” Trump said at the rally in Myrtle Beach on Friday. “Just come and vote. It’s so important.”

Graham is facing Representative Ralph Norman, a hardline conservative who has occasionally irked the president, in

the race to serve a full, six-year term following the death of Senator Lindsey Graham in July. The winner in the solidly Republican state will compete in November against Dr. Annie Andrews, the Democratic nominee.

NEW YORK TIMES

Nevada sues Trump over the Colorado River cuts

WASHINGTON — Nevada sued the federal government Monday to block officials from cutting its share of the Colorado River, launching the first major legal fight over the Southwest’s dwindling water supply.

The state asked the US District Court in Nevada to order the Bureau of Reclamation to rescind plans that would cut water allocations significantly for Nevada, California, and Arizona over the next decade if the river basin continues to dry up.

Nevada argued the plans unfairly burden those three states while federal officials did not impose any mandatory water restrictions on four other states — Wyoming, Colorado, Utah, and New Mexico — upstream. It said that the Reclamation Bureau, part of the Interior Department, violated a complex web of laws, agreements, and court cases known as the law of the river, as well as other federal laws governing administrative procedure and environmental regulation.

But Nevada did not name any of those upstream states as defendants, stopping short of an action that Western water officials have long feared. Such a case would go directly to the US Supreme Court, carry significant costs, and raise risks of unpredictable outcomes imposed by the court system.

Negotiations among the seven states that share the river’s water for a new long-term allo-

cation have stalled, but the downstream states had agreed to restrictions on their water use for the next two years.

Interior officials declined to comment on the lawsuit.

NEW YORK TIMES

US must return deported man at risk of torture

A federal judge ordered the Trump administration to immediately bring back a Mexican man who was deported this month despite proving to an immigration court that he would likely face torture in Mexico.

The man, who is in his late 40s and was referred to in court documents only as John Doe, helped US authorities by testifying against Mexican drug cartels.

The man provided information to US law enforcement that put his and his family members’ lives at “significant risk,” according to the order, which was issued by Judge Stephanie Gallagher in Maryland on Friday. The court found that the administration’s revocation of protections barring his removal “likely violated his procedural due process rights,” exceeding the government’s lawful authority.

The head of Immigration and Customs Enforcement moved to reverse his protections after the US State Department received diplomatic assurances from the Mexican government that the man would not be harmed, according to background information on the case included in the judge’s order.

The ruling was the latest legal blow to President Trump’s mass deportation campaign at a time when administration officials are facing pressure from his base to accelerate removals.

NEW YORK TIMES



ANDREEA ALEXANDRU/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Children wore traditional outfits at an event marking Ukraine’s Independence Day in Bucharest, Romania, on Monday.

Burnham reaffirms support for Ukraine

Accuses Russia of ‘starting the fire’ as tensions rise

By Michael D. Shear, Adam Goldman, and Jeanna Smialek
NEW YORK TIMES

LONDON — Just hours after Prime Minister Andy Burnham of Britain arrived in Kyiv, the Ukrainian capital, on Monday for his first foreign trip since taking office, Russia issued yet another darkly-worded statement.

Britain has been “hell-bent on pouring oil on a fire and plotting to prevent any kind of peace process,” Dmitry Peskov, the Kremlin spokesperson, said, as Burnham affirmed his support for Ukraine in a speech and placed red roses at a military cemetery.

Burnham, 35 days into his tenure as prime minister, appeared unfazed. He announced the delivery of technical blueprints that will allow Ukraine to assemble long-range missiles. Asked to respond to Peskov’s comments, he shot back: “Who started the fire? That’s the question, isn’t it?”

Peskov’s comments were the latest in an escalating series of rebukes and threats from Russia aimed at the British government and its new prime minister, Burnham. Last week, Moscow warned Britain that the use of British-made drones in attacks on Russia would lead to “consequences for which it will have to answer.”

Last month, Russia pulled its long time ambassador out of its embassy in London, leaving the diplomatic post in the hands of a career official, saying that rela-

tions with Britain had “deteriorated to an unprecedentedly low level.”

Political officials and military experts say there is little risk that the heated rhetoric will lead to a direct, military clash. But the intensity of the Russian commentary has prompted deep concern about the likelihood that President Vladimir Putin of Russia will order new episodes of sabotage, cyberattacks, maritime harassment, and intelligence operations.

“We’ve bypassed every Russian red line there is,” said Al Carns, a Labour Party member of Parliament who served until recently as Britain’s armed forces minister and is a former Royal Marine officer.

“We need to continue to stand up for what is right,” he told The New York Times on Monday. “What is right is con-

tinuing to defend Ukraine’s sovereignty with everything we have.”

“Russia’s relationship with Britain is shaped by a long history of hostile intelligence activity, sabotage, targeted assassinations, and other forms of gray-zone confrontation,” said Natia Seskuria, a senior fellow at the Royal United Services Institute, a defense research group in London. “By issuing threats, the Kremlin reinforces the narrative that Russia is fighting an existential struggle against the West.”

During the last four years, Britain has repeatedly pushed for a cease-fire in the war, which began when Russia invaded Ukraine in 2022. But those efforts have faltered as the United States seized control of the peace process and then appeared to disengage from it.

Russia deploys drones in Ukraine guided by AI

Critics warn devices may lead to grave mistakes

By Andrew E. Kramer
NEW YORK TIMES

ZAPORIZHZHIA, Ukraine — The young woman ran for her life, but it was too late.

A small Russian drone resembling a model airplane swooped down from the sky last month in the city of Zaporizhzhia in south-eastern Ukraine. As it tried to navigate toward a gas station, it crashed into a wall and exploded in a hail of shrapnel, killing Tetiana Bubynets, 19, a university student, and two others.

They were among the thousands of Ukrainian civilians who have died in Russian airstrikes, but the circumstances of their deaths came with an ominous twist. The drone that killed them was guided by an experimental artificial intelligence system, not a human pilot, according to drone experts, Ukrainian military commanders, and the forensic team that examined wreckage from the deadly strike and others in the city.

The drone was programmed by human operators to travel toward a particular gas station, but once it got close, it chose its exact target on its own, based on its training to recognize such tanks and strike them, the experts and military officials said.

It is a development long watched for in the war in Ukraine, presaging a dystopian future in which killer robots roam the skies.

“This is a risk for the whole world,” said Colonel Serhiy Minaiev, the commander of air defenses in Zaporizhzhia. “In a few years, we will be living in a ‘Terminator’ movie. It’s no joke. Machines are making decisions to strike.”

Analysis of debris from this attack and others in Zaporizhzhia found that the drones had onboard minicomputers, sold commercially by Nvidia, that made their targeting decisions, the experts and military officials said. Nvidia produces a majority of the chips powering the world’s most advanced AI systems.

The presence of Nvidia modules and a lack of antennas on the drones led Ukrainian air defense commanders to surmise that the weapons were guided by an autonomous AI system, which was confirmed on further investigation.

Autonomous AI systems can be trained on thousands of images to recognize categories such as “river,” “military truck,” or “person.” Self-targeting drones use their cameras to hunt for these things with greater precision than a human pilot can provide. But opponents of such weapons argue that, without human intervention, drones may be more prone to mistakes or violations of the laws of war, such as by failing to distinguish innocent civilians from combatants.

The use of self-targeting AI in the gas station attack, on July 6, would be the first documented case in which civilian deaths were caused by a Russian drone outfitted with such a system, said Kateryna Bondar, a senior fellow at the Wadhvani AI Center at the Center for Strategic and International Studies in Washington.

Both Russia and Ukraine were already using AI in multiple drone models before the fully autonomous drones emerged. In those earlier models, AI is used only for what is known as the “last mile” — the final stage of the attack, after a remote human pilot has selected the target. Fully autonomous AI removes humans from the final target selection.

Oceans are hottest ever recorded

Scientists warn temperatures yet to peak globally

By Seth Borenstein
ASSOCIATED PRESS

The world’s oceans simmered to their hottest temperatures on record over the weekend and are likely to warm even further in the next few months, putting stress on life in the water and on land too, the European climate service Copernicus announced Monday.

Spurred by a still-growing but already supersized natural El Niño and human-caused climate change, the world’s ocean temperatures hit 70 degrees Fahrenheit Friday and Saturday, narrowly edging out the average daily record set in March 2024, said Samantha Burgess, strategic climate lead for Copernicus.

“This is yet another sign of our climate system under strain and the ocean under immense pressure,” Burgess said.

Jane Lubchenco, an oceanographer and former chief of the US National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration, called the record “very troubling.”

“An ocean this warm destabilizes weather patterns and threatens food security, economic prosperity and marine life,” Lubchenco said in an email.

When the ocean warms, it becomes more acidic and carries less oxygen, which hurts food industries that rely on the seas, Burgess said. It also changes ocean currents and weather patterns, giving more juice to storms to make them rainier and make storm surge bigger, Burgess said.

“When we have a warmer ocean such as we’ve had in Europe this summer, it amplifies the impact of heat waves because you don’t get the cooler nighttime temperatures with the sea breeze coming off the ocean when the ocean is very warm,” Burgess said.

Normally, because most of the Southern Hemisphere is ocean, the world’s sea surface temperature peaks in March and April, as the southern summer draws to a close. But this year,

the record was set in August, Burgess said. So the oceans will keep getting hotter until the current El Niño — a natural temporary warming of parts of the Pacific that then warps weather and raises temperatures globally — reaches its peak, which is expected sometime between November and January, she said.

El Niño is already as big as recent ones and is still growing, with it expected to reach unprecedented levels at its peak. It’s responsible for a good chunk of the heat in the oceans, and long-term warming from the burning of coal, oil, and gas has warmed the waters by 1.4 degrees Fahrenheit, Burgess said.

“The thing that makes my heart sink is that this starts so early and it’s so out-of-normal that you know when it hits its peak, it’s going to be unprecedented,” said Boris Worm, a biology professor at Canada’s Dalhousie University. “The ocean is not supposed to do this.”

“It’s just that there is no normal anymore,” Worm said.

“It’s frightening,” said University of North Carolina marine ecologist John Bruno. “We’re not even in October yet. You know, usually the Caribbean peaks at like late September, early October. And I think next year in the Southern Ocean, the Great Barrier Reef, yeah, I’m really worried about what’s going to happen in the Southern Hemisphere in February, March.”

The amount of heat-sensitive coral alive today is about one-fifth of 1990s levels, Bruno said. But lately scientists have found that some species of coral — more the “weedy” kinds, not the long-lived iconic kind like staghorn — are adapting to the hotter water and it’s not quite the wipe-out event once feared, he said.

Bruno and Worm warned of fisheries collapse and food shortages.

They both mentioned the largest fishery in the world, the Peruvian anchovy fishery. That usually collapses during El Niño and is especially likely with this heat, Worm said. And that alters the food web because larger fish, marine mammals, and seabirds

feed on them.

When the water gets hot, larger creatures can swim to cooler water, but “anchovies can’t leave so they just don’t reproduce or starve,” Worm said. And the seabirds and even humans who depend on them are affected.

With hotter water, “not everybody is hit equally, obviously, but the whole system collapses,” Worm said. “It’s like when you pull out the rug from underneath an economy. It’s, like, the whole thing collapses. Some sectors may do a little bit better, but overall, everybody suffers.”

Burgess said as the waters warm off Europe, people are seeing more jellyfish and, Bruno said, the same thing could be happening on the US East Coast.

“Jellyfish are often opportunistic, and they like warm waters,” Worm said. “So yes, I would expect them to do a little bit better.”

Another former NOAA chief, Rick Spinrad, said the ocean is the planet’s thermostat, so “as long as we depend on a healthy ocean for our safety, prosperity, and wellbeing, these record-breaking sea surface temperatures portend even greater challenges for us all.”

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Indonesia battles stifling wildfires amid ‘super’ El Nino

Seasonal weather event dries out land, fuels blazes

By Max Kim and Muktita Suhartono
NEW YORK TIMES

The wildfires have been burning in the peatlands for weeks, belching acrid smoke over West Kalimantan province in Indonesian Borneo. In the provincial capital, Pontianak, everyone in Alfian Effendi’s family has developed coughs.

The thick haze, which has also drifted into Malaysia, has forced schools in the area to temporarily suspend classes, including for Alfian’s four children, whose noses are running from the smoke. Local officials have distributed masks and urged people to stay indoors. But that is a luxury that Alfian, 37, the owner of a chicken slaughterhouse, said he does not have.

“We all have to work to earn a living, right?” he said in a phone interview. “We know we are risking our health, but what choice do we have?”

Wildfires are a seasonal occurrence in many parts of Indonesia, a vast archipelagic country, so this trade-off is nothing new for Alfian. But there is reason to fear that this year may be especially bad, according to experts. Indonesia is in the grip of a “super” El Nino that is likely to suppress the rains that would otherwise extinguish the fires.

And the fire season has yet to peak.

“The question now is whether the current acceleration continues through September and October and first two weeks of November,” said David Gaveau, a landscape ecologist and the founder of Nusantara Atlas, a website that tracks fires and deforestation in the region. “New mega fires may appear in southern Sumatra in September,” he added, referring to Indonesia’s third-largest island.

As of Aug. 20, there were more than 224,000 hot spots



ANDRI RIZKY AGUSTIAN/ASSOCIATED PRESS
Firetrucks arrived at a wildfire burning through a peatland field in Sampit, Central Kalimantan, Indonesia, on Monday.

suggesting fire activity across Indonesia, according to Nusantara Atlas’s satellite data. Gaveau said that this was an unusually high number that resembled the trend in 2019, one of Indonesia’s worst fire seasons, in which he said as many as 7.7 million acres burned.

There are other worrying signs. About 230,000 acres burned in July alone, roughly equal to the total area affected between January and June, based on data from Indonesia’s forest ministry.

Many of Indonesia’s most devastating fire seasons have developed during strong El Nino events, in which the warming of the central Pacific Ocean shifts rain patterns, drenching some areas while drying out others.

In 2015, another El Nino year, the government said about 6.4 million acres burned, sending

smoke beyond Indonesia’s borders. A study by researchers from Harvard and Columbia universities later estimated that the haze from the fires contributed to around 100,000 premature deaths across Indonesia, Malaysia, and Singapore.

Climate experts have noted that this year’s El Nino may end up being particularly formidable — the strongest in recorded history, according to some estimates.

Alfian said that he can already sense its effects in Pontianak, where he said the earth has been so hot and dry that it feels like even an errant spark could explode into flames, and the local river has become so depleted that seawater is rushing in, making the tap water salty.

“We can only use it for baths now,” he said. “For cooking or washing our vegetables, we have

to buy extra gallons of water.”

Though El Nino has historically been a major accelerant for fires, experts point to the widespread degradation of Indonesia’s peatlands as the underlying reason for the country’s growing fire risk over the past few decades.

In their natural state, peatlands, a type of spongy wetland that makes up around 10 percent of the country’s total land mass, are resistant to fire because they are composed of waterlogged decaying organic matter. But decades of industrialized agriculture, such as those used for palm oil, one of Indonesia’s biggest exports, have led to the mass draining of them.

“The exposed, dry peat becomes combustible fuel,” said Resti Salmayenti, a tropical peatland researcher at the University of Leeds. “And once ignited,

fires can spread below the surface, where they’re hard to detect and can burn for a long time during prolonged drought, like during El Nino.”

In addition to harming respiratory health, those fires also produce disproportionately large greenhouse emissions because peatland stores far more carbon than forests.

Though Indonesian law requires companies operating within significant peatlands to keep them wet, Bambang Saharjo, a forest fire forensics specialist at IPB University in Bogor, West Java, said that those rules are often ignored, while broader peatland restoration efforts, like using canal blocks to trap water, have also stalled.

“Many canal blocks and boreholes have fallen into disrepair, rendering them ineffective for fire suppression and leading to

‘And once ignited, fires can spread below the surface, where they’re hard to detect and can burn for a long time during prolonged drought, like during El Nino.’

RESTI SALMAYENTI,
tropical peatland researcher

an escalation of increasingly massive fires,” he said.

In nearly all cases, he added, human activity is responsible for causing this damaged peatland to catch fire, such as companies or people burning them to free up usable land. Indonesian authorities have arrested more than 70 people and launched investigations into at least four companies in connection with the ongoing fires.

Officials have also turned to cloud-seeding, a weather modification technique that involves using planes to spray particles like silver iodide and salt in the air to trigger rainfall. But the method is only effective if there is already moisture in the clouds, so experts say the benefits may be limited.

The same scarcity is being felt on the ground in West Kalimantan, where Bimpi Permata Restu, a volunteer firefighter, has been racing across the parched landscape on a motorbike outfitted with a pump and hose, dousing vegetation to keep it from catching fire.

“The challenge for now is the dried-up water sources,” he said.

Bimpi, 25, first started volunteering to fight fires as a teenager. Now he has a 2-year-old child with another on the way. Their home is encircled by hot spots that spew smoke and fill him with anxiety about his family’s health.

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T commuters stuck in another season of detours

►SHUTDOWNS
Continued from Page A1

The T scheduled shutdowns on portions of the Green Line for 78 days through August in 2026, according to data compiled by the transportation advocacy group TransitMatters. That’s about one third of the year so far.

Yet overall, a Globe analysis showed that there were more planned shutdowns across the four primary subway lines at this point in 2025, including 46 days on some part of both the Red and Orange.

Scheduled shutdowns are rare on the Blue Line, but for months, the oft-reliable subway route has been hit by frequent interruptions due to the weather and old equipment breaking down.

It doesn’t end there. The T has made sizable progress on updating the Green Line’s century-old signal system, but only 15 percent of the cabling for the equipment has been installed so far, the T confirmed. That, and other remaining improvements, means huge gaps in Green Line service are coming: Portions of the line will be shut over one weekend in late September, and two more nine-day shutdowns will follow, first from Sept. 26 through Oct. 4 and then again into November.

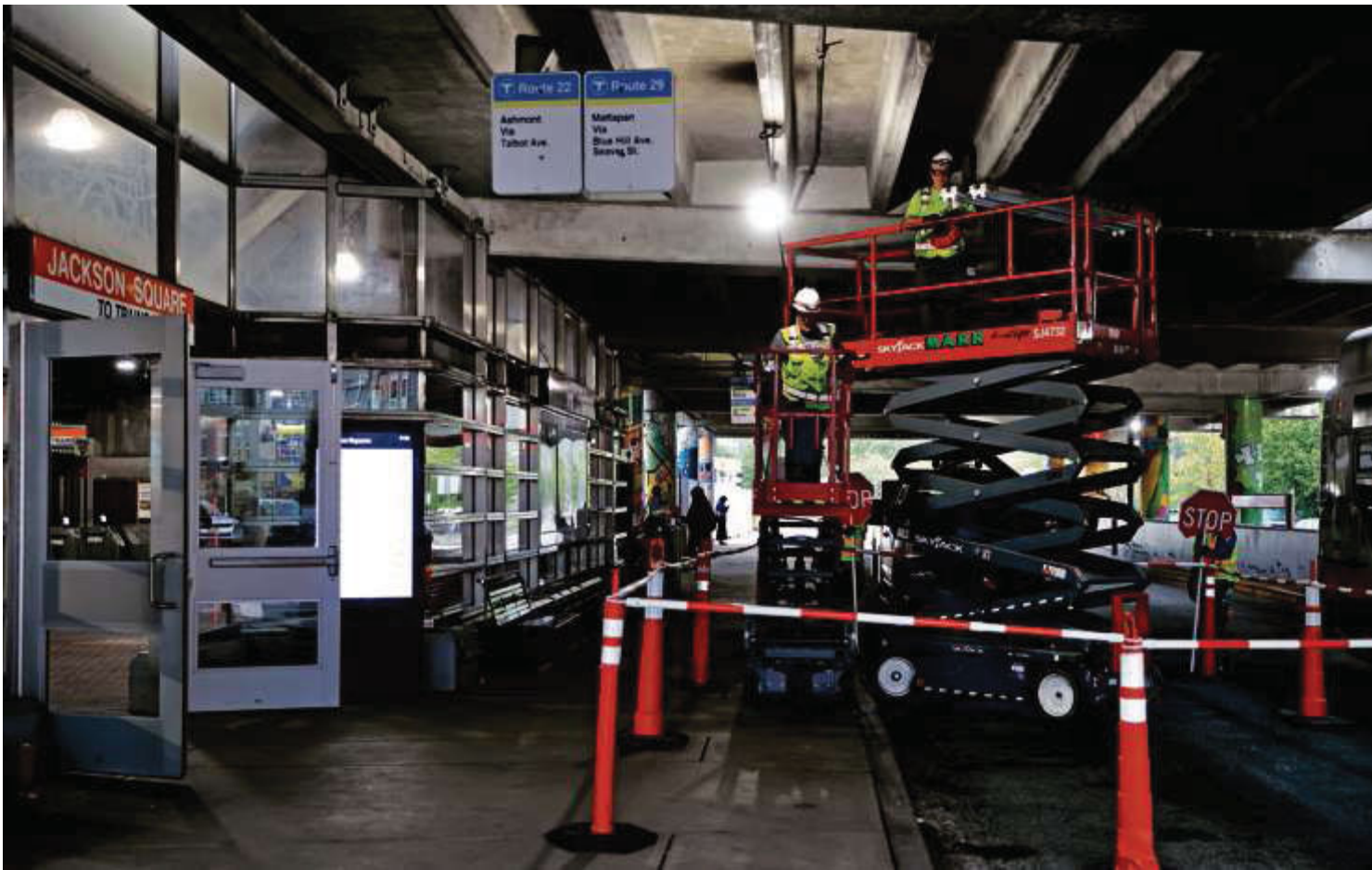
T spokesperson Lisa Battiston said more outages will “likely” follow in 2027 to prepare for the arrival of new train cars.

And that’s just the Green Line. Tourists buzzed around local bars and trains for much of what would typically be construction season, so the T is leaning into shutdowns now. The southern half of the Orange Line, between Back Bay and Forest Hills, will be closed for five days between Sept. 10 and 14. Later in the month, service on the Blue Line will be reduced for three days, with trains running as far apart as 14 minutes, to accommodate what the T called “switch work.”

The Symphony Station on the Green Line’s E Branch is also shuttered for three years for a complete renovation and four new elevators.

Some commuter rail stops are also periodically out of service for accessibility improvements or construction work on bridges along the line.

It never really quite stops. Across the system, the T is not only retiring outdated equipment, but it’s upgrading



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

A construction crew worked on the Jackson Square Orange Line Station late last week.

other infrastructure to tackle a backlog of improvements officials estimate will take \$25 billion in all.

During the longer scheduled shutdown of the Orange Line, the T will complete track work that should allow trains to travel at a record 55 miles per hour and will also continue to upgrade signal systems.

All that said, is there a better way to do the necessary work without a parade of disruptions? Not really, said Mary Skelton Roberts, the Boston representative on the MBTA board and an Orange Line rider.

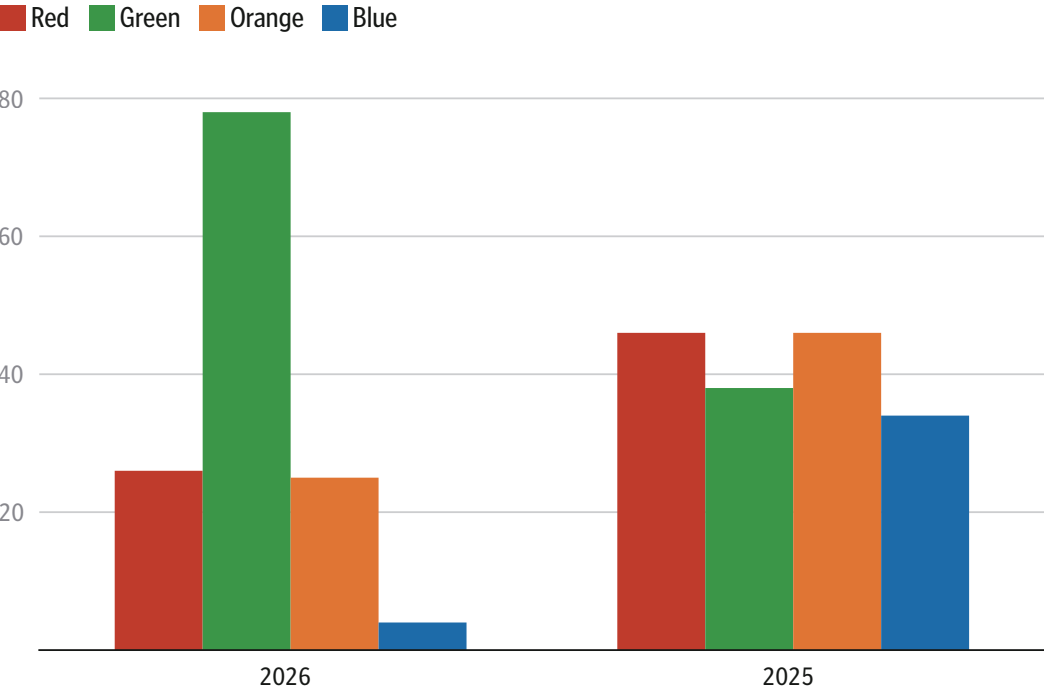
During the current shutdown of the Orange Line, Roberts herself was planning to take the adjacent commuter rail from Jamaica Plain.

“Are we going to go back to the piecemeal progress we had before?” Roberts said. “No, we’re going to have to continue to make repairs. That is the best we can do.”

Caitlin Allen-Connelly, executive director of TransitMatters, said that while shutdowns are annoying, the results have been evident: The Red and Orange Line trains run faster. Slow zones are infrequent. Riders’ safety seems like the priority after years in which federal officials, and other experts, said it

Planned shutdown days by line

Through Aug. 30, only the Green Line has more days during which portions of the route were planned to be shut down compared to last year.



Shutdowns through Aug. 30 of each year. Data includes planned shutdown of Green Line between Oak Grove and Back Bay from Aug. 20 through Aug. 30.

Chart: JOHN HANCOCK/GLOBE STAFF • Source: TransitMatters

wasn’t.

“Have the shutdowns been disruptive? Yes,” Allen-Connelly said. “Have they been disruptive

with results? Also, yes.”

For some riders, the shutdowns generate greater confidence that they’re worth it.

Eoin Jaquith, a Cambridge native, said this is the first time he actually can name the T’s general manager. Sitting shoul-

der-to-shoulder with riders on an Orange Line shuttle to Sullivan Square on Thursday, he said Eng “seems to care about the T.”

“And if we’re all going to be ornery about something,” Jaquith said, “at least it’s 10 days versus forever.”

Still, the interruptions add to traffic on city streets. Shuttle buses for the Orange Line clog up narrow roads around TD Garden and the interchanges between I-93 and Charlestown. One bus on Thursday even took riders to Stoneham, a suburb north of Boston, rather than its intended destination of North Station. The T later apologized.

Not all riders, however, are taking it in stride. When Heba Kaikiba, a nurse-in-training at Massachusetts General Hospital, saw the shuttles Thursday, she thought, not *again*. She usually transfers from the 109 bus to the Orange Line at Sullivan Square every day around 6 a.m.

On her way home from work that afternoon, she had already tired of the added time to her commute.

“The T closes too much,” Kaikiba said.

This Orange Line shutdown also butts against the first days of fall classes at Bunker Hill Community College in Charlestown.

Florence Martin, a freshman who just moved from England, said the service stoppage means it takes her longer to get to class and soccer training from Orient Heights. New to Boston, she also almost got lost during transfers.

“Lots of first-years like me are just trying to get settled in,” Martin said. “It’ll take at least an hour to commute home every day from training now, or I have to spend \$20 on an Uber home.”

Wedged in the aisle of a shuttle toward Boston, Rachel Newby said she finds the shutdowns to be an infrequent but stubborn annoyance in a system that should be reliable. She wishes the T would return to night or weekend closures to spare more people “the inconvenience” of alternate commutes.

“Plus,” Newby said, “I don’t like being late.”

John Hancock of the Globe staff contributed to this report. Diti Kohli can be reached at diti.kohli@globe.com. Follow her @ditikohli.

Amid GOP criticism, governor defends public safety efforts

►PUBLIC SAFETY
Continued from Page A1

spite objections from progressive activists and elected officials. (She finally succeeded earlier this month.) She’s also received outside help from a nonprofit led by a former Healey aide, which ran a weeks-long ad campaign claiming robberies and other crimes are down since she took office.

In a Globe interview, Healey said her recent actions on public safety have no connection to her reelection efforts, nor, she said, does she feel pressure to prove her record.

She spent several months as a special prosecutor in Middlesex County earlier in her career and then led the attorney general’s office for eight years as the state’s top prosecutor. Healey had mixed success in prosecuting public corruption cases, but she targeted corporations including ExxonMobil and Purdue Pharma, sued President Trump nearly 100 times, and secured convictions or reached settlements with State Police troopers for overtime they allegedly did not work.

“Those guys are new on the scene,” Healey said of her two GOP opponents. “I am old. You know, I’ve been around.”

Brian Shortsleeve, a former MBTA official, and Michael Minogue, who ran a medical device company, have consistently claimed Healey’s track record on public safety has made Massachusetts less safe, even as advocacy groups have regularly ranked the state as having some of the strongest gun laws and lowest gun death rates in the country.

The two Republicans point to a series of violent incidents in

Boston this summer that prompted local leaders to hold meetings on safety downtown, and they have knocked the governor for seeking to curb local police cooperation with Immigration and Customs Enforcement.

Shortsleeve argued Healey’s signature on the immigration bill puts “politics over public safety.” Both candidates have hammered the governor over decisions made by the state’s Parole Board, criticism that intensified after a parolee allegedly shot and wounded motorists on Memorial Drive in Cambridge in May.

“When I’m governor, day one, we will fire every single member of that Parole Board,” Shortsleeve said.

Minogue said Healey is like other elected politicians in Massachusetts: “They campaign on problems, but they don’t solve them.” The first-time candidate on Friday also got a boost with the endorsement of the Massachusetts Police Association, which said he’d be a “strong partner for law enforcement” if elected.

“The moment this election is over, I’m going to have a plan,” Minogue said of addressing public safety.

The nonprofit run by the former Healey aide is trying to counter those criticisms. Organized as a “social welfare organization,” the group, Running Point MA, has in practice largely released TV ads designed to tout Healey’s record during the middle of her reelection, all without having to disclose its donors.

In a weeks-long TV ad the group aired this summer, a narrator claimed that a variety of crimes, from car thefts to homicides, have all declined during



STEVEN SENNE/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE

Governor Maura Healey, at a State Police swearing-in ceremony in Worcester in 2024.

Healey’s time in office. Overall crime dropped in Massachusetts between 2024 and 2025, according to state data. Murders, too, have declined, as did aggravated assaults, the data show, though some offenses, such as sexual assaults, rose slightly.

“She did it all while keeping ICE out of our courthouses, hospitals, and schools,” the ad’s narrator says. “Because this former attorney general won’t stop until Massachusetts is safe — for all of us.”

Will Rasky, the former Healey aide leading the group, did not respond to a request for comment.

On Beacon Hill, Healey spent months applying public pressure on the Governor’s Council to approve a prosecutor to the Parole Board, arguing the seven-member panel lacked someone with experience “directly working for, representing victims or prosecuting cases.”

But she faced resistance from the eight-member body of elected officials to her first nominee for a vacancy on the board, and even experienced a rare rebuke despite weeks of lobbying when the Governor’s Council rejected her pick, Vincent J. DeMore III, an ex-prosecutor.

Ultimately, the panel approved Kaitlyn O’Leary, another past prosecutor and Healey nominee, for the post. That confirmation only came after Healey released multiple public statements and even appeared before the council to make an in-person appeal for her nominee.

Council member Tara Jacobs, a North Adams Democrat who voted against both of Healey’s picks, said she could only recall a “couple of times” when the governor has made such a full-court press for a nominee.

Jacobs said Healey could

have reached out to councilors individually to make her case instead of “sharing her thoughts through a speech where it’s not an opportunity to really have a follow-up or a discussion.”

Jacqueline Manning, a spokesperson for Healey, said the governor’s legal office has spoken with council members ahead of every nomination Healey has made.

Healey was steadfast that her looming reelection played no role. She said “hell no” when asked if her push to put a prosecutor on the Parole Board was because of Minogue’s or Shortsleeve’s criticism.

“I just thought that’s a big gap that needed to be fixed,” she told the Globe.

When Healey took to a podium in Chelsea for the immigration bill signing ceremony, she referenced “public safety” at least seven times as she de-

nounced ICE officers and the Trump administration for “making us less safe.”

In addition to banning certain civil immigration arrests in so-called sensitive locations, the law also bars local law enforcement from asking about someone’s immigration status during a routine police stop unless it is necessary for a criminal investigation.

“This is about public safety. Schools, hospitals, courthouses, these are places where people need to go, and they need to be safe in going there,” Healey said in Chelsea.

Michael Brady, executive director of the Massachusetts Chiefs of Police Association, said the immigration law “does have some elements of public safety” because local police can still have exchanges with ICE in some circumstances. Notably, the law bans new deals between the state and federal government known as 287(g) agreements that effectively allow local authorities to act as immigration agents.

But the measure leaves in place the only existing agreement of its kind in Massachusetts between the federal government and the state Department of Correction — which falls under Healey.

Brady, whose group has not endorsed in the governor’s race, said the law could give Healey a talking point as she hits the campaign trail ahead of November’s election.

“I’m sure she would certainly use that to her favor,” he said.

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ENDORSEMENT

David Solet for Middlesex DA

The race for Middlesex district attorney is a race between two seasoned prosecutors. Incumbent Marian Ryan, who took over as top prosecutor in 2013, started her career in that office in 1980. Her challenger, David Solet, who started his career there in 2001, resigned a year ago to run against his former boss and colleague.

Both Ryan, 71, and Solet, 50, have experience and passion for the job. But the Globe editorial board is endorsing Solet because of his exceptional record of advocacy and compassion for long-forgotten victims of crime and his commitment to changing the way an office, long-criticized for its turnover of personnel and lack of transparency, is run.

Solet, who went to work in the Middlesex DA's office after graduating from Harvard Law School in 2001, has prosecuted a broad range of crimes, including murder, domestic violence, organized crime, and public corruption. From 2015 to 2019, during the administration of former governor Charlie Baker, he served as chief legal counsel for the Executive Office of Public Safety and Security.

In 2019, he returned to the DA's office, where he started and led the Cold Case Homicide Unit, which is credited with solving more than a dozen cases. In an interview with the editorial board, he said he was motivated by the desire to speak for "people who did not have a voice." As he also told the board, a prosecutor is "not just there to win cases, but to do justice," and that is what he worked to do for victims whose cases had ended up in the cold case files.

Solet, who was named the Middlesex DA's "Prosecutor of the Year" in 2025, resigned last September over what he said were disagreements with Ryan over priorities and management style. If he wins the Sept. 1 primary and goes on to become DA, he wants to focus, among other things, on stopping illegal gun trafficking and said he would work to close loopholes that prevent prosecutors from asking that suspects be held without bail as a danger to the public in certain cases.

"A critical part of being the district attorney is not just using the laws we have to protect people ... but speaking out when you know the laws we have, have failed," he told the board.

Solet's campaign website touts the more than 40 endorsements he has received from law enforcement and public safety organizations, and Ryan, who told the editorial board that she does not accept endorsements from police unions, has raised that as a point of concern. In a follow-up interview with the editorial board, Solet said the idea "that anybody who accepts support, political or financial, from somebody, means you are

beholden to that person" is misguided. Whether that support comes from a police union or a criminal defense lawyer, "either you trust that somebody knows how to separate political support from doing the right thing, or you don't," he said.

The editorial board believes that Solet can do that — separate political support from doing the right thing if

The Globe editorial board is endorsing Solet because of his exceptional record of advocacy and compassion for long-forgotten victims of crime and his commitment to changing the way an office, long-criticized for its turnover of personnel and lack of transparency, is run.



TAYLOR COESTER FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

David Solet

a law enforcement officer is involved in alleged wrongdoing. Working in the DA's office, he has shown a willingness to take on public officials. In one example he provided to the board, he led the prosecution of an investigator for the Alcoholic Beverages and Control Commission for extortion.

However, that was a while ago. Today, a commitment to taking on the powerful, especially in law enforcement, is even more important.

Under Ryan's leadership, the Middlesex DA's office has been dealing with fallout from the controversy involving the 2023 crash of a State Police cruiser driven

by State Police Sergeant Scott Quigley when he was allegedly drunk, which resulted in the death of a disabled passenger in a wheelchair van. The crash happened while Quigley was working as a homicide investigator as part of the State Police Unit assigned to Ryan's office. But as Ryan told the editorial board, she was never notified about the crash or Quigley's alleged intoxication. After details surfaced when the crash victim's family filed a wrongful death lawsuit and through in an unrelated murder case, she called for an independent investigation into the crash and alleged cover-up. Given Quigley's role investigating homicide cases, there are now questions about whether they are tainted by his own alleged wrongdoing.

In the aftermath of the Quigley controversy, Ryan told the editorial board that she has set a "high bar of police accountability." Yet how she did not know that a homicide investigator in the DA's office was involved in a serious cruiser crash at the time that it happened is difficult to understand.

The Middlesex DA's office serves 54 cities and towns in what is the most populous county in Massachusetts and New England. The office prosecutes approximately 39,000 cases a year in 12 district courts, four juvenile courts, and two superior courts.

Ryan, who was appointed to the job in 2013, has subsequently won election three times. She's considered a progressive prosecutor. She backs criminal justice reform, established an opioid crisis response program, and has taken a strong stand against the anti-immigrant policies of the Trump administration. Ryan, the only female DA in Massachusetts, has been endorsed by Attorney General Andrea Campbell and former Boston Police Commissioner Ed Davis.

But over the years, she has periodically come under fire for a management style that critics contend has led to a high turnover rate. Ryan disputes that characterization of her office and attributes any turnover to salary issues.

When the Globe endorsed Ryan in 2014, the board cited her prosecutorial experience. Still, the Globe endorsement referenced what Ryan "admits is a tough management style," and also cited concerns about a lack of transparency.

Twelve years later, those issues persist.

Solet has been endorsed by Lisa McGovern, a former Massachusetts Lawyer of the Year, who worked with him in Ryan's office and who describes him as "a team leader" who can "inspire people to do better jobs."

Experience, leadership, and the ability to inspire prosecutors to do better jobs. That's what Solet represents and that's why the Globe editorial board is endorsing him.

‘New Hampshire breaks late’: Scott Brown isn’t fazed by long odds

By Alex Beam

Alex Beam is a contributing Globe Opinion writer. Follow him @imalexbeamymrnt.

NASHUA, N.H. — Former Massachusetts senator Scott Brown is pressing the flesh at the Nashua Republican City Committee's Candidates Night, held in a nondescript function room at a local country club. Nattily turned out in a trim blazer and a necktie with an American flag motif, Brown still exudes youthful energy at 66. This is, after all, the fellow whom Cosmopolitan magazine dubbed "America's Sexiest Man" in 1982.

Later, at the podium, Brown evinces a star quality that the other two down-ballot candidates distinctly lack. Born in the Portsmouth Naval Shipyard (his father was serving at the nearby Pease Air Force Base), Brown can jaw about NATO and the War Powers Act and simultaneously project Regular Guy mojo. What's up with the Granite State's lousy phone service, he asks the crowd. "I'm at the Portsmouth traffic circle and my phone dies."

What's missing from this picture? Brown's opponent for the GOP Senate nomination, John E. Sununu. A colorless appendage of New Hampshire's Sununu dynasty (his father, John H. Sununu, is a former governor and served as President George H.W. Bush's chief of staff),

John entered the race last fall when it became clear his more popular brother Chris, who had just finished four terms as New Hampshire governor, wasn't interested.

Even though Brown was already running, the GOP establishment immediately embraced Sununu. President Trump proffered his "complete and total endorsement," even though Sununu supported Trump's opponent Nikki Haley in the last presidential cycle. Last month, the National Republican Senatorial Committee started running pro-Sununu ads.

"He's wealthy and they like self-funders," Brown explains. "Just follow the money. It's the same with almost every candidate they endorse."

The RealClearPolitics poll average has Sununu leading the race by 35 points. The Cook Political Report's "race summary" mentions only Sununu and his presumed Democratic opponent Representative Chris Pappas.

Watching Sununu ads dominate the airwaves, and hearing his opponent droning platitudes about how "The New Hampshire way needs to be the American way," Brown could be forgiven for thinking: Why am I losing to this guy?

I am biased. I think Scott Brown may be the smartest man in North America. Here's why: In March 2020, when the COVID-19 virus paralyzed American life, Scott Brown was in Camperdown, "a palatial estate with a sweeping front lawn," the residence of the American

Ambassador to New Zealand. Trump appointed Brown ambassador in 2017.

In 2020, the Globe's Joshua Miller noted sardonically that "Brown's time as ambassador has not been under duress." Among his scheduled activities: "he hosted a tea this week with dozens of people"; "He went to a rugby game in a packed stadium"; "He hits the pool with a swim team in the 5 a.m. hour, and then the gym."

As it happened, Brown and his family had landed in the safest place on earth. New Zealand's elimination strategy was "one of the most successful in the world," according to The Guardian. So while you were wondering whether to disinfect your mail and quailing at the thought of visiting Star Market, Scott Brown was playing some "rockin' tunes" with his band at the embassy's July 4 celebration.

I repeat: Scott Brown is a genius.

He is also an indelible part of Massachusetts history. After the death of Senator Edward M. Kennedy in 2009, Brown, then a little-known state senator, faced off in a special election against Attorney General Martha Coakley. Brown ran an Everyman campaign, famously posing in a barn coat next to his pickup truck.

He had one talking point, but it was a good one: I'm not running to fill "Ted Kennedy's seat," he would say. "It is the people's seat."

Against all odds, he won. ("GOP Senate Victory Stuns Democrats," wrote The New

York Times.)

That was then. Harvard Law School professor Elizabeth Warren unseated Brown in 2012. Two years later, after moving to Rye, N.H., Brown lost a Senate race to incumbent Jeanne Shaheen.

In 2022 his wife, former Channel 5 reporter Gail Huff Brown, made some history of her own, losing a primary race for a House seat to a shiny-faced, 25-year-old newcomer — future White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt. Completing the circle of political life, Leavitt then lost to Chris Pappas, the expected Democratic nominee for the Senate seat Scott Brown wants.

Things look grim for the Brown campaign. A recent University of New Hampshire survey of likely Republican voters shows Sununu with a 54 percent favorability rating, compared to Brown's 32 percent. More ominously, 35 percent of voters don't like Brown, slightly more than twice Sununu's unfavorability rating. "I bet a fair number of voters, when they hear 'Sununu,' are thinking of John's brother Chris, and not of him," says University of New Hampshire political science professor Dante Scala.

Brown professes to be unfazed. "If I thought I would lose, I wouldn't be in the race," he says. "We will have been at this for 17 months, there's no reason to worry — New Hampshire breaks late."

So can Massachusetts — just ask Martha Coakley.

INBOX

Mass. is part of the prison-psychosis industrial complex

As Latarsha Sanders has been granted a new trial and the Lindsay Clancy trial draws to a close, I am hopeful that these cases have raised awareness of how people with psychosis get caught in the legal system simply because of their mental illness.

More than 1 million people in the US correctional population have schizophrenia or another serious mental illness, making prisons de facto mental health asylums. During a psychiatric rotation last year at the Suffolk County Jail, I met countless inmates with psychosis who had little understanding of their own crimes, their illness, or the ramifications for their future. Many of them were veterans; almost all had a history of foster care or abuse. These men languished in behavioral units akin to solitary confinement, and I witnessed their psychosis deepen.

The circumstances of this jail are not unique. Indeed, they are similar to those at Massachusetts prisons that saw six suicides of inmates last year.

The brief, outpatient-like psychiatric treatment that inmates are offered in jail, with limited pharmacotherapy and no psychotherapy, is simply not sufficient in helping people recover from psychosis.

I urge Governor Maura Healey to continue investing in programs that keep people with psychosis out of prisons, such as mental health diversion programs, which currently face budget cuts.

DR. SARANYA S. KHURANA
Brookline

We can't leave our future up to tech bros and their interplanetary visions

Re “The tech utopianism of Elon Musk and Sam Altman is failing us: How science fiction hijacked our political imagination” by David Albertson and Jason Blakely (Ideas, Aug. 16): Despite their successful business ventures and astounding wealth, members of the Silicon Valley billionaire class appear to be very limited in their assessment of human potential and in their single focus on sci-fi type enhancements.

Physically improving living conditions with technology is a worthy goal, but depending on tech to create new human intelligence or abilities will not, in and of itself, make for utopia. What the tech bros don't appear to understand is that humans have worthy dimensions, such as capacity for love and compassion, that tech doesn't reach. Do we want to live on a barren planet like Mars with machine-merged humans lacking emotional intelligence or on a beautiful verdant Earth with spiritually evolving and caring humans?

We should be seriously thinking about which future to choose before our future is chosen for us by tech billionaires and the politicians who enable them. We still have a choice of which vision to pursue.

MARJORIE LEE
Wayland

One key question Mass. voters should ask themselves before casting Senate primary ballot

Your recent editorial endorsing Seth Moulton over Ed Markey for the Democratic nomination to the US Senate makes points about Markey's age and progressivism vs. Moulton's relative youth, military service, and center-left positions. These points would be relevant given a Senate with two functioning political parties in a real democracy, not a country ruled by a party in thrall to a wildly immoral and corrupt tyrant. The most critical question for disenchanting voters facing a captive legislature during a national authoritarian power grab is: Which candidate is the better fighter?

JEFFREY MICHALS-BROWN
Brockton

Statesman George S. Boutwell's legacy lives on in Groton

I was glad to see a mention of my ancestor George S. Boutwell, the former governor of Massachusetts and the head of the Anti-Imperialist League, in Stephen Kinzer's “Marco Rubio got it wrong” (Ideas, Aug. 16). Kinzer erred in identifying Boutwell as a former US attorney general; he did serve as treasury secretary under Ulysses S. Grant and as internal revenue commissioner under Abraham Lincoln, and, as a member of Congress, was a drafter of the 14th and 15th amendments to the Constitution.

However, Kinzer did rightfully trace the longstanding opposition in American politics to nation-building and imperialism abroad, which so often has led to disaster, both for our country and those nations we've sought to coerce politically and occupy militarily. Think the Philippines, Vietnam, Iraq, and Afghanistan.

Boutwell lived in Groton from 1835 till his death in 1905, and his legacy lives on in the Governor Boutwell House on Main Street.

JEFFREY BOUTWELL
Columbia, Md.

The writer is the author of the biography “Boutwell: Radical Republican and Champion of Democracy.”

As storied Harvard COOP writes a new chapter, memories endure

Re “The COOP takes a page out of its past” (Page A1, Aug. 13): To many of us the Harvard COOP was not just where we once worked — it was also a place to make lifelong friends and meet future spouses (we gratefully met there).

Perhaps from a business point of view the bookstore, which seeks to expand beyond Harvard Square, has changed, but to those of us who were employed there as teenagers and morphed into young adults there, the COOP remains a special place. We haven't been there in a while, but the store still holds dear memories.

Frequent conversation with a customer: COOP employee: “Do you have a COOP number?” Visiting customer: “Huh? What's that?” COOP employee: “Never mind.”

EDWIN AND MARILYN ANDREWS
Malden

MARCELA GARCÍA

Will Massachusetts hold police accountable for Flock camera abuse?

The woman left an abusive relationship about five years ago. She changed her phone number and went quiet on social media, precautions meant to keep Jason Rogers, the man she had escaped, out of her life.

These precautions were not enough. Rogers, a Stow police officer, allegedly used the department's Flock camera network, as well as state criminal databases, to track her movements, running multiple searches with “no legitimate law enforcement reason,” according to a press release from the Stow Police Department.

“He did use [Flock] illegally to try to hunt me ... to see what I was doing,” the woman told Boston 25 News anonymously. “I just don't think somebody like that should be out there with a badge and a gun.”

The good news is that, after an internal investigation, Stow authorities acted swiftly and Rogers is now facing termination proceedings. The town is also pursuing criminal charges against him because some of his searches violated state law.

The bad news is that, unless the Massachusetts Peace Officer Standards and Training Commission strips Rogers of his police certification, nothing would prevent him from wearing a badge somewhere else.

Michael Sallese, the police chief in Stow, forwarded the department's investigation to POST, according to the press release. But the watchdog agency wouldn't confirm or deny that it has received any investigation or complaint related to Flock camera misuse from Stow or any other department, or opened an investigation of its own.

The Stow case is not an outlier. In recent days, similar reports of Flock misuse have surfaced in New Bedford and Lynn. As the Globe noted recently, the Institute for Justice has documented more than 150 cases of abuse of the technology, a tally one of its attorneys called a “massive undercount.”

Roughly 100 police departments in Massachusetts have Flock cameras. Is POST treating abuses with the urgency they demand, given the system's ubiquity?

The commission “can't confirm or deny the existence of an investigation” related to license plate reading technology like Flock's, and “can't comment on matters that might be pending,” Alia Spring, POST's director of communications and community engagement, told me.

Spring directed me to the commission's online database of officer disciplinary records, where I couldn't find any reports mentioning license plate readers, Flock, or misuse of any surveillance network. What I did find was a handful of cases involving misuse of law enforcement databases.

Just last week — as another Massachusetts police department was putting officers on leave for allegedly abusing Flock cameras — POST permanently decertified a former Boston Police officer for 91 sustained counts of unauthorized searches on the Massachusetts Criminal Justice Information System, the same database that Rogers allegedly tapped in Stow, along

with other violations. The commission cited a “pattern of unprofessional police conduct that [the] [C]ommission believes may escalate.”

Spring told me the commission has issued no guidance on automated license plate readers or how to audit their use. Nor does POST track such misuse as its own category in complaint data. Generally speaking, she said, “a credible complaint regarding misuse of surveillance technology would fall under the category of unprofessional conduct.”

Even if POST is investigating the cases, the wheels of police accountability grind slowly. The former Boston Police officer's decertification came nearly 16 months after his department completed its first internal affairs report on him.

“POST is not necessarily the panacea that we think it is, or we wish it could be,” Tom Nolan, a former Boston police lieutenant and criminology professor, told me. “We ought not to let the individual departments off the hook” when it comes to imposing discipline.

As for Stow, the police department terminated its Flock contract as a result of

Rogers's misuse of the technology and, in early August, removed the final Flock license plate reader in town, according to Sallese. The department also acknowledged that Flock cameras had been used to solve crimes and locate missing persons, but said it “feels it must evaluate the safeguards, policies and oversight” needed before considering reinstating the technology.

Consider how Rogers's conduct actually came to light. It was the woman he allegedly tracked who filed the complaint with the Stow Police Department, after she looked up her own license plate on HaveIBeenFlocked.com, an independent website born of the national license plate reader backlash that lets anyone check whether police have run their plates through Flock's network.

None of this is an argument against license plate readers; that debate will go on. Instead, it's about who watches the officers using them. Stow's Flock cameras came down, but Rogers's certification — his license to carry a badge and a gun anywhere in Massachusetts — is still POST's call.

The commission has previously decertified other officers for abusing state databases; abusing license plate cameras deserves the same unambiguous treatment. The woman Rogers allegedly tracked did everything right: She escaped, she hid, and when a police officer turned Flock cameras on her anyway, she caught her own stalker. The least Massachusetts can do, if the allegations hold up, is make sure he — and every officer tempted to follow his example — never wears a badge again.

Marcela García is a Globe columnist. She can be reached at marcela.garcia@globe.com. Follow her on X @marcela_elisa and on Instagram @marcela_elisa.

JOAN VENNOCHI

Why Adam Deitch is Karen Read's candidate for Norfolk DA

Karen Read showed up at the grand opening of Adam Deitch's campaign office, and she, her parents, and two of her lawyers have collectively contributed \$9,000 to his campaign to become the next Norfolk County district attorney.

Yet, as Deitch puts it, “I do object to the premise that I am the Karen Read candidate.”

Objection overruled. Deitch is Read's candidate, not only because his campaign accepted money from her but also because he agrees with her contention that Boston police officer John O'Keefe did not die because Read's car hit him.

As Deitch told the Globe editorial board during a recent interview, “Based on the evidence that has been made public, what's clear is that John O'Keefe's death has an explanation that is not being hit by Karen Read's car.”

He could be right, but that judgment is exactly what Read wants to hear — and exactly what the O'Keefe family doesn't, as they pursue a wrongful death civil lawsuit against Read, who was charged with second-degree murder in O'Keefe's death but acquitted after two trials.

On Monday, O'Keefe family members endorsed Greg Connor, who has worked for more than two decades in the Norfolk DA's office. In a statement, the O'Keefe family said Connor, who rose from line prosecutor to head of the homicide division, is “a seasoned prosecutor” who “brings the experience, integrity, judgment, and dedication necessary to be an excellent District Attorney and to lead the office with fairness and accountability.”

Deitch, a former federal prosecutor, is one of seven Democrats who is promising to restore public faith in that office. But with his expertise comes entanglements with the Read case that raise potential conflicts of interest if he wins election as DA.

Deitch led the federal investigation into the handling of the police investigation into O'Keefe's death. That inquiry did not lead to indictments. But it did end up disclosing a trove of sexist and racist texts authored by

former State Police trooper Michael Proctor, the lead investigator in the Read case, that destroyed Proctor's credibility and helped Read's defense.

Deitch's role in that federal inquiry also put him in a position of knowing what witnesses who were called before the grand jury said under oath about the circumstances surrounding O'Keefe's death. Since grand jury proceedings are secret, Deitch can't dis-

Asked if he believes someone other than Read is responsible for O'Keefe's death, he told the editorial board that based on what is public, “the only conclusion we can draw definitively is that Karen Read's SUV ... did not break on John O'Keefe's body.”

close any of it. But it's clear whose side he's on.

Asked if he believes someone other than Read is responsible for O'Keefe's death, he told the editorial board that based on what is public, “the only conclusion we can draw definitively is that Karen Read's SUV ... did not break on John O'Keefe's body.”

Asked if he thinks the investigation into O'Keefe's death should be reopened, he said, “I think so. I don't think an investigation was ever completed by the State Police or the DA's office. I don't think John O'Keefe's family has honest answers from the DA's office.”

He added: “I think there needs to be a completed investigation and I think my insights from the federal investigation are super relevant.”

Deitch said he would recuse himself from anything having to do specifically with Read, such as the matter of whether her cell-phone should be returned. As for other matters relating to O'Keefe's death, he said he would name a “dedicated senior prosecutor” to rule on any ethics questions that arise.

Asked about a suggestion in a recent Boston Magazine piece that if he won, he would drop witness intimidation charges against Aidan Kearney, the blogger known as Turtle-boy, who played a key role in promoting the-

ories put out by Read's defense team about O'Keefe's death, Deitch said, “I've never spoken to him. ... It's not based on anything I've ever said. ... As with any other pending case in the DA's office, I'm going to take a fresh look.” (Kearney has denied all the charges, some of which have already been dropped.)

Taking a fresh look at the alleged actions of a Read ally would be less concerning if the Deitch campaign hadn't taken money from

Read or those close to her.

Deitch could have given back that money. But Read has legions of supporters, many of whom are also Norfolk County voters. Being seen as one of them is a boost for Deitch's campaign.

Deitch also has backing from the family of Sandra Birchmore, a 23-year-old woman whose death was initially ruled a suicide before a federal investigation identified it as an alleged homicide by a former Stoughton police officer.

Deitch also speaks eloquently about the loss suffered by the O'Keefe family and his commitment to transparency and accountability.

The O'Keefe family, he said, “has never been told anything with an open mind about other possibilities. They've been told it was an intentional homicide by Karen Read and that's, I think, what they believe and I think that's really unfortunate.”

Those are comforting words — especially to Read, since they are likely to raise doubt in any future juror's mind about any civil liability on her part for O'Keefe's death.

No wonder Deitch is Read's candidate.

Joan Vennoch is a Globe columnist. She can be reached at joan.vennoch@globe.com. Follow her @joan_vennoch.

Biotech jobs fall in Mass., but outlook brightens

► **JOBS**
Continued from Page A1

covery, said Bradford and industry experts. And after a years-long slump, biopharma has come roaring back in 2026, as much of the more recent data in the report illustrates.

“Biotech is back and in a strong up cycle,” said Alexis Borisy, cofounder and chairman of the venture firm Curie.Bio and a serial entrepreneur. “We went through a big downturn from ‘21 and ‘22, and the boom that had led up to that is what I called the seventh cycle of biotech since biotech began in the 1970s. It’s now clear we are in the eighth up cycle.”

The MassBio report contains plenty of evidence suggesting Borisy is right.

Venture funding for biotech startups surged to \$3.45 billion in the first half of 2026, up 25 percent over the same period last year and the strongest opening half since 2023. Eight Massachusetts companies went public in the first half of this year, matching the combined total of 2024 and 2025.

Eleven Massachusetts biotech firms were acquired for a reported \$18 billion in the first half of this year, well above the \$7.6 billion reported at the same point last year for mergers and acquisitions.

At least eight Massachusetts biotech firms made their own acquisitions in the first half of this year, including Biogen’s purchase of Waltham-based immunology company Apellis Pharmaceuticals for about \$5.6 billion. The deal was among the largest under Biogen chief executive Chris Viehbach.

“I love seeing the M&As, the IPOs, and the venture capital

flowing,” said Bradford. “The hope is that we’re on the upswing again.”

Even one of the companies that shed the most employees in Massachusetts last year has had good news recently.

Moderna, which helped develop one of the two messenger RNA vaccines that tamed the pandemic, shrank from 4,434 employees in 2024 to 3,042 in 2025, a decline of nearly a third, according to the MassBio report. (In fact, the plunge has been even steeper: Moderna spokesperson Christopher Ridley said last week that the company now has a Massachusetts workforce of about 2,600.)

But last Wednesday, Moderna’s stock almost tripled after the biotech reported the first successful results of a personalized mRNA vaccine in a late-stage trial to treat melanoma, which experts said could foreshadow its use against other cancers. Ridley said that the company is “constantly rebuilding” but he had no specifics to share on whether Moderna will start hiring again.

The recovery is hardly limited to Massachusetts. The XBI, biotech’s most-watched stock index, is up more than 34 percent for the year. At \$164, the index is approaching its peak of \$175 set in February 2021 during the pandemic-era growth bubble.

Among the industry veterans hoping that the recovery continues is Joe Newman, 60, a microbiologist who was laid off twice last year from jobs leading drug development teams at two companies.

The first time was in February, when he lost his job at Omega Therapeutics, which filed for bankruptcy. After several weeks,



KEN MCGAGH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Microbiologist Joe Newman has lost jobs at two drug development firms last year.

he landed a position at Generation Bio but was laid off in October when that struggling company shed 90 percent of its staff.

“It’s hard” getting laid off twice in eight months, said Newman. He has worked as a consultant from his Sudbury house since he became unemployed, but, he said, “I still have the energy to lead a team or build a team.”

Fortunately, he said, the job market appears to be improving. He’s had eight job interviews

this year, including six in the second quarter.

“I think Boston [biotech] will come back. There are too many good universities and scientists for it not to,” said Newman, who completed two postdoctoral fellowships at MIT and Tufts University’s school of medicine.

Rahul Dhanda, chief executive of a 4-year-old Boston startup, Syntis Bio, said he’s optimistic that the state’s biotech hub is rebounding. The small company is developing medicines to treat

obesity and has about 20 employees, more than twice as many as it had a year ago.

“I’m very upbeat about the sector,” he said. “Between IPOs, the rising XBI, and massive M&A activity, the indicators are all very positive.”

The state’s biotech hub is resilient, Bradford, of MassBio, said, but it needs to be nurtured with funding from public and private sources.

Fortunately, he said, Governor Maura Healey and the Legis-

lature in late 2024 earmarked \$1 billion over 10 years for the life sciences industry, reauthorizing an initiative begun by Governor Deval Patrick and continued by Governor Charlie Baker.

“It took 40 years to build this industry,” Bradford said, “but just because it’s here, doesn’t mean it’s always going to be here if we don’t support it.”

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‘She only experienced it for the 18 minutes or so that it took to kill the children. And to put it mildly, that would be a very, very unusual pattern or manifestation of how this kind of thing comes about.’

KIRK HEILBRUN, forensic psychologist

Psychologist rejects Clancy psychotic episode claim

► **CLANCY**
Continued from Page A1

of their Duxbury home on Jan. 24, 2023. And she never heard it afterward.

“She only experienced it for the 18 minutes or so that it took to kill the children,” Heilbrun testified in Plymouth Superior Court. “And to put it mildly, that would be a very, very unusual pattern or manifestation of how this kind of thing comes about.”

Heilbrun also told jurors that Clancy did not report making any attempts to stop the voice or distract herself from it, steps often taken by people experiencing auditory hallucinations in the throes of psychosis.

Heilbrun was the second witness called by prosecutors to rebut defense mental health experts who testified last week that Clancy should not be held criminally responsible for the slayings because she couldn’t resist the voice in her head commanding her to kill during a postpartum psychotic episode.

Last week, the other witness, Dr. Avram Mack, a psychiatrist, recounted that Clancy had revealed that as she strangled each child, she said, “Go to God.”

On Monday, Heilbrun, who accompanied the psychiatrist during the meeting, echoed those statements, saying Clancy’s final words to each child were “Go to God, baby.”

Clancy, 36, has admitted killing her children, then slashing her wrists and neck and jumping out a second-story window in a suicide attempt.

She remains paralyzed from the waist down and appears in court each day in a wheelchair.

However, she has pleaded not guilty to three counts of first-degree murder, asserting an insanity defense in a case that has drawn international attention for its focus on women’s postpartum mental health.

On Monday, Heilbrun spoke about Clancy’s failure to tell anyone she heard a voice until after the slayings, when she was hospitalized, recovering from her serious injuries.

He added that it “provides a convenient way of lessening your own culpability.”



PHOTOS BY GREG DERR/THE PATRIOT LEDGER/POOL

Defense attorney Kevin Reddington and Lindsay Clancy listened to testimony by forensic psychologist Kirk Heilbrun (below), a prosecution rebuttal witness, in Plymouth Superior Court on Monday.

He said that Clancy told her husband, “I tried to kill myself,” when he asked her what she had done after finding her lying outside the house after jumping from the window.

Someone in psychosis, he said, would likely be more vague, saying something to the effect of “I did what I had to do.”

Heilbrun also said Clancy offered inconsistent accounts about the hallucination.

He said Clancy indicated the voice repeatedly told her it was her “last chance” to kill her kids and herself during the slayings, but told a hospital staffer the voice had said additional things.

During the trial, now in its fifth week, Clancy has been described as a devoted and loving mother. Many witnesses, including her former husband,



Patrick, described her desperate efforts to get help for anxiety, depression, and insomnia in the months leading up to the slay-

ings.

She received various medications, but complained they made her feel worse.

Heilbrun, who interviewed Clancy at Tewksbury Hospital in April of this year, said his evaluation showed her motive was “suicide combined with altruistic filicide,” or “killing your kids out of love.”

He described a “highly lethal and very serious suicide attempt” that followed months of thoughts and impulses about harming herself.

Heilbrun testified that Clancy and her husband never spanked their children and “both felt bad when they yelled at the kids.”

He said Lindsay Clancy was known to worry about leaving her children. “whether that was for date night or school or going back to work or anything.”

While it could be “a possibility” for someone to have command hallucinations only once,

it would be “very rare,” he said.

Heilbrun said his theory was that Clancy had been having intrusive thoughts for months about committing suicide, and was “in pain,” suffering, and “even desperate” when she decided to kill herself and her children.

Heilbrun told jurors Clancy had an expectation that she and her children “would go to heaven and be together with God.”

However, Heilbrun’s testimony ignited a swift response from Judge Walter F. Sullivan as he began describing the teachings of the Catholic faith, noting that he asked Clancy if suicide was considered a “mortal sin.”

Clancy’s attorney, Kevin Reddington, objected to the line of questioning, and jurors were escorted from the courtroom before a brief hearing after Reddington asked the judge to declare a mistrial.

Last week, one of the prosecutors, Shanan Buckingham, asked Lindsay Clancy’s mother-in-law if she was aware that murder is a mortal sin. The judge immediately called a sidebar before the witness could answer and later told jurors to disregard the question.

Reddington accused prosecutors of intentional misconduct, but Assistant District Attorney Jennifer Sprague noted that it was the witness, Heilbrun, who raised the issue of mortal sin and Catholicism.

The judge ordered Heilbrun’s references to mortal sin and Catholic teachings stricken from the record and told jurors to disregard that testimony. He refused to declare a mistrial.

Heilbrun will resume on the stand Tuesday.

Afterward, prosecutors are expected to call one more expert before resting their case. Closing arguments are expected Wednesday.

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Tram Nguyen gets late boost in open primary

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

US representatives Ayanna Pressley and Lori Trahan on Monday endorsed state Representative Tram Nguyen in the Sixth Congressional District's crowded Democratic primary, offering Nguyen a late boost against her better-funded opponents in the final days of the six-way race.

Pressley and Trahan are the first members of the state's congressional delegation to pick a side in the state's only open US House primary this year, which has developed into

Pressley, Trahan offer endorsements in crowded 6th District congressional race

►Congressional candidate admits he had a past OUI. **B4**

a litmus test of whether safe-blue district voters want to send an insider, an outsider, or someone in between to Washington.

"She's a fighter who's earned everything she has," Trahan said of Nguyen in an interview, pointing to her background as a refugee, the

first person in her family to graduate college, and a former legal aid attorney. "Congress needs more women like her — people who have overcome real adversity and know how to fight for working families."

The Democrats' endorsement of the Andover state legislator — announced two days after early voting began and many others voted by mail — is also something of a rejection of the primary's five other can-

didates, including its leading fundraiser and one of its perceived front-runners, Dan Koh.

Koh, a former Biden White House aide, narrowly lost to Trahan in the Third District's open primary in 2018, and considered challenging her two years later. His hometown of Andover was later redistricted into the Sixth, where Koh has touted national support, including from Biden, in his bid to replace Representative Seth Moulton.

Koh has put his federal work front and center, pitching to voters
NGUYEN, Page B4

Body found near pond is wife of slain officer

Worcester police sought spouse in domestic incident

By Nick Stoico
GLOBE STAFF
and Bryan Hecht
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

WORCESTER — A body found in the woods here Monday is believed to be Karen Solomon, a prominent mental health advocate for first responders and a suspect in the death of her husband, a veteran police officer, found dead at their home nearly a week ago.

The body's discovery near Coe's Pond ended the intense search for Solomon, who police allege killed her husband, Kurt Solomon, a 31-year member of the city's police department.

Police Chief Paul Saucier said officers responded shortly before 1 p.m. to 189 May St. after two employees of Fairlawn Rehabilitation Hospital, found a deceased body in the woods.

"Upon further examination, we believe this person to be Karen Solomon," Saucier said during a news briefing late Monday afternoon.

Investigators believe her death is part of a murder-suicide. A wake and funeral for Kurt Solomon is scheduled for Tuesday and Wednesday at Our Lady of the Angels Church on Main Street.

The body's identification is preliminary and will need to be confirmed by the state medical examiner's office, Saucier said.

Police had been searching for Karen Solomon, 58, since her husband was found dead outside the couple's Wildwood Avenue home early on Aug. 18.

Police also recovered a handgun in the area of the body Monday. Saucier said it was not a police service weapon, and investigators were working to determine the owner, but he said Kurt Solomon was "probably the owner."

Authorities previously said that Kurt Solomon, 57, suffered injuries caused by a sharp object.

"We believe this case is a tragic murder-suicide that occurred, and we still have plenty of work to do as far as wrapping up all the pieces to this," Saucier said.

A person who answered the phone at Fairlawn Rehabilitation Hospital Monday said they had no comment.

At the hospital Monday evening, three police cruisers sat with their lights flashing as a large section of lawn in front of a wooded area was roped off with yellow caution tape.

A van from the medical examiner's office arrived just after 5 p.m. and backed up to the tree line. Investigators could be seen entering a thick patch of woods. The van departed at about 5:30 p.m.

On Friday, police said an arrest warrant had been issued for Karen Solomon on a charge of assault and battery with a dangerous weapon causing serious bodily injury.

Saucier also sought to clarify authorities' previous characterization of the case as a domestic incident. He said that designation was based on state law because the case involved members of the same household.

It was not an indication that the couple had a
WORCESTER, Page B4

INSIDE

Fatal crash

The suspect in a fiery crash that killed a father and daughter in North Reading on Saturday appeared in Woburn District Court Monday. **B4**

Tompkins trial

Jury selection in the federal corruption trial of Suffolk Sheriff Steven W. Tompkins started Monday. **B2**



PHOTOS BY DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Volunteers at Bakers Island have been beautifying and doing repairs at the lighthouse grounds and buildings.

A lens to the past

After 50 years away, the historic Fresnel lens returns to Bakers Light Station in Salem

By Madyline Swearing
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

SALEM — After more than 50 years away, a historic Fresnel lens has returned to Bakers Island Light Station as the centerpiece of a new museum.

The glass and bronze lens guided mariners through Salem Sound from 1926 until 1972, when it was replaced by an automated light.

Its return in June marked a homecoming for the light that spent the last 50 years displayed at the Maine Lighthouse Museum in Rockland.

The Essex National Heritage Commission worked with the Coast Guard to have the lens brought back to the island where it was installed 100 years ago.

The 123-year-old lens is part of a new exhibit about the light station, its keepers, and the region's rich maritime history.

The public can now view the lens at Bak-



The Fresnel lens is now on display at Bakers Light Station, where it guided mariners from 1926 until 1972.

ers Light during the summer season (June to September) through guided boat tours, volunteer workdays, and overnight stays at the Assistant Keeper's House and campground.

"Getting out here isn't easy. A ton haven't seen [the lens] yet, but a lot want to," Ryan Conary, Essex Heritage program event manager, said in an interview at the light station.

The 10-acre light station is only accessible aboard the Essex Heritage's landing craft, Naumkeag. The rest of the 50-acre island, including Bakers Island Wharf, is privately owned by seasonal residents.

Conary said visitors are thrilled to see the lens back at Bakers Light, especially those who remember seeing its bright beam as young children.

"This is their history," he said.

The homecoming was no small feat.

LENS, Page B3

Judge rejects bid to block \$2b Springfield courthouse deal

By Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

A Hampden County judge on Monday ruled that a \$2 billion courthouse project in downtown Springfield can continue, rejecting a request from a group of losing bidders to temporarily block the state from moving forward with a team that includes well-known Boston figures.

Superior Court Judge David M. Hodge wrote in a 29-page decision that "there is no legal or logical support for the plaintiffs' convoluted theory" that the state's Division of Capital Asset Management and Maintenance violated the state's conflict of interest law in awarding the contract to a team known as Liberty Junction.

The group had included John Barros, the interim head of the Massachusetts Convention Center Authority. Barros has since stepped away from the project.

Hodge denied the losing bidders' request for a temporary restraining order and preliminary injunction, effectively allowing Liberty Junction and the state to continue with lease negotiations, which could take several months.

The ruling punctuates weeks of high drama, finger-

pointing, and allegations of conflicts of interest.

In the Monday ruling, Hodge wrote that "there are myriad difficulties" with the losing bidders' argument that there was a conflict of interest, in part because they brought the lawsuit against the capital asset management division, "which is not a state employee, and which therefore cannot be liable for violating" the law.

He added that the problems with the current outdated courthouse are "well known" and that stopping the state from proceeding with these negotiations would harm the public interest by delaying an already protracted process required for the Commonwealth to build, as expeditiously as possible, a sorely needed new courthouse in Springfield."

The current Springfield courthouse was built in 1971, and has drawn years of complaints that it is mold-infested and making people sick. The state solicited proposals for a new building in 2025, and ultimately received 10, including one led by Springfield auto magnate Jeb Balise and another led by real estate investor and developer Dinesh

COURTHOUSE, Page B3



MASS.GOV

The current Springfield courthouse, built in 1971, has drawn years of complaints that it is mold-infested and making people sick.

Man fatally shot by Cambridge police previously arrested

A '23 charge for having illegal gun was dropped

By **Spencer Buell**
GLOBE STAFF

The man fatally shot by police in Cambridge on Friday had been arrested three years earlier in the same neighborhood for allegedly having an illegal gun, only for the charges to be thrown out because police didn't have a warrant to search the car he was driving, court records show.

It was among the new information that came to light Monday as authorities identified William Woodworth, 64, of Wattertown, and elected officials eagerly awaited the release of crucial evidence that was sorely missed here the last time a person was fatally shot in this city by police: footage, captured via body-worn camera, that may show what happened.

Authorities say Woodworth had exited his car Friday night and "pointed a firearm at officers" in the moments before police fatally shot him, and that

they later recovered a loaded firearm at the scene.

The shooting is now under investigation, and the Middlesex District attorney's office, per its policy in police-involved fatalities, is launching a judicial review.

Investigators may not have to rely on the word of police alone as they probe the case. In a statement over the weekend authorities said that "responding Officers were all equipped with body worn cameras" and that footage from the devices is "being reviewed."

It was not yet clear if or when any footage of the incident might be released publicly. But there is broad agreement among elected leaders in Cambridge that the sooner footage of the incident can be released, the better.

Officials said they hope that video of the incident — the first since officers in the city were equipped with body-worn cameras last year — can soon be made available to everyone, and can lend clarity to the way in which the shooting unfolded.

"The City Council pushed for body-worn cameras for a rea-

son," said Sumbul Siddiqui, Cambridge's mayor and city councilor, in an interview. "I think they're an important tool for transparency and accountability, and I think in a case where a person has died following any kind of encounter with police, there is a public interest in seeing that footage."

She and Cambridge City Manager Yi-An Huang said in a joint statement over the weekend that they "recognize the importance of providing a full and transparent accounting of what happened."

Court records show Woodworth was arrested in January 2023 after police pulled him over and said they found a loaded, unregistered firearm in his car.

Charges against Woodworth were dropped in December of that year, though, after a court found that officers searched his car without a warrant.

An official confirmed that the Woodworth arrested in 2023 was the same man fatally shot Friday. Cambridge police did not respond to questions about the apparently botched 2023 search.

The details of Friday's shoot-

ing are still being investigated, but police and the district attorney said in a press release they responded shortly after 8 p.m. Friday to reports of "suspicious individuals" in a parking lot on Temple Street, which is a short, narrow road between businesses in Central Square.

"The preliminary investigation suggests that a man in his 60s, who was seated in a vehicle when the police arrived on scene, allegedly exited his vehicle and pointed a firearm at officers. Cambridge Police Officers attempted to physically disarm the individual and multiple shots were fired striking the individual," the release from over the weekend said.

Police said they took a loaded gun from the man, who died at the scene, and that several officers were taken to the hospital, where they were treated and released. Police did not describe whether or how those officers were injured.

Fatal police shootings in Cambridge are rare, but this case comes after another from three years ago that still weighs heavily on the city.

Body cameras were notably

not in use in the moments leading up to the death in 2023 of Sayed Faisal, a 20-year-old college student. That shooting predated the city's body-worn camera program and was not recorded.

A judicial inquest that year found the shooting was justified, but observers have long said the lack of available footage of the shooting left lingering questions about the events that led to the man's death.

It also was top of mind for Cambridge leaders as they launched a body-worn camera program in the city beginning in May of 2025.

"We wanted to make this investment so that if an incident happened again, we would have the evidence," said Patricia Nolan, a city councilor. Nolan said she has asked for any footage of the encounter to be released "as quickly as possible."

"We shouldn't have to wait months for this," Nolan said.

The Faisal case has also reverberated in neighboring Somerville, where officials just last month voted to launch the city's first body-worn camera program, despite some concern

among elected leaders who aired skepticism about whether the devices were worth their longterm costs of using them.

Supporters of the fledgling Somerville body camera program, including its mayor, Jake Wilson, had argued the uproar over Faisal's death showed how valuable it is to have the measure of clarity the devices can provide.

In Cambridge this week, the local police union has declined to comment on the role body cameras will play in the investigation, but said that it stands by the actions of its members.

"[S]everal of our members performed heroically in a rapidly evolving lethal encounter with an armed and dangerous individual," the Cambridge Police Patrol Officers Association said in a statement Sunday. "No officer ever wants to encounter a situation where lethal force is necessary. But police sometimes have no other option in the protection of citizens and themselves."

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Federal jury selection begins in Suffolk sheriff corruption case

Official charged with extorting cannabis retailer

By **Danny McDonald**
GLOBE STAFF

Jury selection in the federal corruption trial of Suffolk County Sheriff Steven W. Tompkins started Monday in a case that will be closely watched in local political circles.

In August of last year, federal authorities unsealed an indictment charging Tompkins with two counts of extortion under color of official right. The US attorney's office alleges he used his position as sheriff to extort a cannabis company twice — once for early access to purchase \$50,000 worth of stock in the company and later to get his money back after the stock value tanked.

On Monday at the John Joseph Moakley Courthouse in Boston's Seaport, scores of jurors filled out a questionnaire before a multitude of them were called into a courtroom and questioned by Judge Myong J. Joun and lawyers from both sides.

The inquiries were aimed at a juror's impartiality. Did they have strong feelings about cannabis, and would that bias their judgment, given that case hinged on Tompkins's alleged dealings with a cannabis company? Would they value the word of a police officer over that of a civilian? Could they be fair, given their connections or experiences with the criminal justice system? What was their prior understanding of the case?

Multiple jurors suggested that there must be substance to the government's claims if the matter had landed in federal court. One even proclaimed: "I don't trust the government any-



PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

Suffolk Sheriff Steven W. Tompkins (left) emerged from the John Joseph Moakley Courthouse with his attorney Martin G. Weinberg after his arraignment on extortion charges in 2025.

ways ... I'd say he's guilty."

That man was excused from jury duty.

Tompkins sat mostly stoically next to two defense attorneys throughout the day, as the judge went through the jury pool.

The jury selection process is slated to continue Tuesday morning.

Tompkins, 69, is a well-known local politician, a ubiquitous and glad-handing presence in Greater Boston, who as sheriff oversaw the Nashua Street Jail and South Bay House of Correction for years.

He has maintained his innocence. Earlier this summer, Tompkins's attorney, Martin G. Weinberg, said in a trial brief that "the government's proof will be insufficient to establish a

quid pro quo bribery agreement, as required to support conviction for extortion under color of official right."

In that brief, which is essentially a roadmap of Tompkins's legal defense in the case, Weinberg said his client's dealings with Ascend Mass, part of Ascend Cannabis, a multistate retailer, represented "a business transaction, at full market value, with a longtime friend that had nothing to do with Mr. Tompkins's official position."

The federal indictment alleges he pressured the owners of Ascend Mass by threatening to revoke a partnership between the sheriff's office and the company, which was central to its licensing application.

While applying for a neces-

sary license, Ascend needed to show how the business would have a "positive impact," especially on communities adversely affected by the nation's war on drugs, according to the indictment in the case. For Ascend, that requirement was allegedly met through its partnership with Tompkins on a program to train and hire people recently released from jail, prosecutors said.

This partnership allegedly gave Tompkins leverage; without it, according to prosecutors, company officials feared they would not have their license renewed to operate a shop downtown.

Prosecutors allege that Tompkins forced company official Frank Perullo to sell him

stock for \$50,000 before the venture went public, then demanded he be repaid after the value of his shares sank below his initial investment. Tompkins had not signed any agreement that would have guaranteed a refund on his initial investment, according to the indictment, but the official paid him back anyway.

Specifically, Tompkins's defense says that the stock purchase between Tompkins and Perullo was "simply not a part of any exchange for Mr. Tompkins's official acts" as Suffolk sheriff.

"Maintaining an existing agreement with Ascend, entered over a year before, that is aligned with the policies of the Suffolk County Sheriff's Department, does not constitute an official act," wrote Weinberg in his brief.

Additionally, Weinberg asserted that prosecutors will not be able to establish that Perullo, the cannabis company official, "harbored any reasonable fear of economic loss."

Each extortion charge carries a maximum sentence of 20 years in prison; however, it's unclear how much time Tompkins would face under federal sentencing guidelines, if convicted.

After his indictment last year, Tompkins said he would

go on leave and designated Mark Lawhorne as the "special sheriff" who would fill his seat on an interim basis.

Tompkins's federal court case is among the controversies to batter the Suffolk sheriff's department recently.

Earlier this summer, the state's office of the chief medical examiner ruled that an in-custody death that followed a fight between an inmate and staff at South Bay late last year was a homicide. No criminal charges have been filed in connection with that case.

Separately, a Suffolk County sheriff's correction officer was arrested last year for allegedly trafficking methamphetamine. Another employee for that office was fired last year for allegedly smuggling hundreds of thousands of dollars' worth of a synthetic cannabinoid to an inmate.

In another case filed last year, a former Suffolk correction officer was accused of raping an inmate. He pleaded not guilty. The case is ongoing, with a jury trial slated for this fall.

Sean Cotter of the Globe staff contributed to this report.

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7-day home delivery	\$70.00	70.00	70.00
Sunday-only home delivery	\$22.50	22.50	22.50
Daily single copy	\$4.00	4.00	4.00
Sunday single copy	\$6.00	6.00	6.00

Lottery

MONDAY MIDDAY 4371
Payoffs *(based on a \$1 bet)*

EXACT ORDER

All 4 digits \$5,260
First or last 3 \$736
Any 2 digits \$63
Any 1 digit \$6

ANY ORDER

All 4 digits \$219
First 3 \$123
Last 3 \$123
MONDAY NIGHT 3601

Payoffs *(based on a \$1 bet)*

EXACT ORDER

All 4 digits \$6,188
First or last 3 \$866
Any 2 digits \$74
Any 1 digit \$7

ANY ORDER

All 4 digits \$258
First 3 \$144
Last 3 \$144

MILLIONAIRE FOR LIFE
Aug. 23 **15-28-32-55-57**

Millionaire Ball 1

Jackpot: \$1 million per year

MASS CASH

Aug. 24 **2-18-21-30-34**
Jackpot: \$100,000

MEGABUCKS

Aug. 24 **1-18-22-35-42-43**
Jackpot: \$28,300,000

PREVIOUS DRAWINGS

	Midday	Night
Sunday	5474	8859
Saturday	9358	7319
Friday	9134	2073

MONDAY NUMBERS AROUND NEW ENGLAND

Maine, N.H., Vermont

Day: 3-digit 451	4-digit 1241
Eve: 3-digit 804	4-digit 1338
Rhode Island	0700

Connecticut

3-digit 390	4-digit 4884
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This day in history

Today is Tuesday, Aug. 25, the 237th day of 2026. There are 128 days left in the year.

Birthdays: Actor Tom Skerritt is 93. Former US Poet Laureate Charles Wright is 91. Film director John Badham is 87. Baseball Hall of Famer Rollie Fingers is 80. Rock musician Gene Simmons (Kiss) is 77. Rock singer Rob Halford (Judas Priest) is 75. Musician Elvis Costello is 72. Film director Tim Burton is 68. Country musician Billy Ray Cyrus is 65. Actor Blair Underwood is 62. NFL Hall of Famer Cornelius Bennett is 61. DJ Terminator X of Public Enemy is 60. Television chef Rachael Ray is 58. Country singer Jo Dee Messina is 56. Model Claudia Schiffer is 56. NFL Hall of Famer Marvin Harrison is 54. Actor Alexander Skarsgard is 50. Actor Blake Lively is 39. Actor China Anne McClain is 28.
►In 1875, Matthew Webb became the first person to swim

across the English Channel, crossing from Dover, England, to Calais, France.

►In 1916, President Woodrow Wilson signed the National Park Service Organic Act, establishing the National Park Service as an agency of the US Department of the Interior to maintain the country's natural and historic wonders and "leave them unimpaired for the enjoyment of future generations."

►In 1928, an expedition led by Richard E. Byrd set sail from Hoboken, N.J., on its journey to Antarctica.

►In 1944, Paris was liberated by Allied forces after four years of Nazi occupation during World War II.

►In 1948, in the House Un-American Activities Committee's first televised congressional hearing, Alger Hiss denied charges by Whittaker Chambers that Hiss was a communist involved in espionage. (Hiss was

later convicted of perjury and sentenced to five years in prison; he maintained his innocence until his death in 1996.)

►In 1981, the US spacecraft Voyager 2 came within 63,000 miles of Saturn's cloud cover, sending back pictures of and data about the ringed planet.

►In 2001, R&B singer Aaliyah was killed with eight others in a plane crash in the Bahamas; she was 22.

►In 2009, Senator Edward M. Kennedy, the liberal lion of the Senate, died at age 77 in Hyannis Port after a battle with a brain tumor.

►In 2010, North Korea welcomed Jimmy Carter back to Pyongyang as the former US president arrived to bring home Aijalon Mahli Gomes, a Boston native jailed in the communist country since January 2010 for entering the country illegally from China.

►In 2017, Hurricane Harvey, the

fiercest hurricane to hit the United States in more than a decade, made landfall near Corpus Christi, Texas, with 130 mph sustained winds; the storm would deliver five days of rain totaling close to 52 inches, the heaviest tropical downpour that had ever been recorded in the continental United States.

►In 2020, two people were shot to death and a third was wounded as 17-year-old Kyle Rittenhouse opened fire with an AR-15-style rifle during a third night of protests in Kenosha, Wis., over the police shooting of a Black man, Jacob Blake. (Rittenhouse was acquitted on all charges, including homicide.)

►In 2022, regulators approved California's plans to require all new cars, trucks, and SUVs to run on electricity or hydrogen by 2035. (President Trump signed a resolution in June 2025 blocking California's plan, prompting a court challenge by the state.)



PHOTOS BY DAVID L RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Lens returns to Salem lighthouse

► **LENS**
Continued from Page B1

A certified lampist, Kurt Fosburg, was flown from Michigan to disassemble, inspect, and package the lens for transportation from Maine. After a two-day journey, and plenty of volunteer assistance, Fosburg reassembled the lens in the station's Assistant Keeper's House.

The return is part of ongoing restoration efforts at Bakers Light since management was transferred from the Coast Guard to preservation nonprofit Essex Heritage Commission in 2014.

Rotating teams of volunteers visit each week to help with landscaping, beautification, and small improvement projects.

Some volunteers, such as retired Coast Guard civil engineer Joe Tully, said they've been helping out for decades at the island that lies about 4 miles off Salem.

On a recent hot, sunny day, Tully worked to replace the ceiling in the Lantern House — formerly the station's gift shop, but soon to be an educational center, Conary said.

Down a winding, grassy path, longtime volunteer Nancy Weston spent the day clearing the glade of rocks and debris.

"I was looking for something to do since retiring, so I've been volunteering here for the past few years," said Weston, a retired machine worker who said she's only missed one volunteer day this season.

Weston said she remembers seeing the Fresnel lens during a regular visit to the museum in Maine, years before she considered volunteering at Bakers Light.

Up a path, and across a sprawling lawn with picnic tables and white picket chairs, volunteer Teagan Pratt repainted the Keeper's House.



Above: Volunteers walked up the stairway after arriving by boat to help with repairs at the lighthouse buildings and grounds. Top: Summertime lighthouse keeper Wendy Pomerantz cleaned the glass on top of the lighthouse.

The last time Pratt was on the island was for bird conservation. On the boat ride over, she said she was excited to see how things have changed over the years.

"I heard an American Oystercatcher while working, so it's cool to know they're still here," said Pratt, her hands covered in paint.

Others volunteers, such as coworkers Ryan Griffin and Jim Balentine, were first-time volunteers who work at Vermont Mutual. In lieu of a workday, Griffin and Balentine spent the afternoon helping Weston clear rocks and tree branches.

"It beats the office," said Griffin, pointing out Boston's skyline visible in the distance.

Wendy and David Pomerantz have served as the station's summertime keepers for three years. While volunteers help upkeep

the station weekly, the pair are responsible for daily tasks.

For five weeks each summer, they oversee the visitors lodge, give tours, and clean the lighthouse glass.

David, who sits on the board of directors of the American Lighthouse Foundation, said conservation efforts like those at Bakers Light can play a role in marine conservation.

This summer, the light station joined 10 other Massachusetts sites to feature a Station-Keeper — an Automatic Identification System that alerts passing vessels to slow down in protected whale habitats.

"I think lighthouses, their history and preservation, can open conversations about climate change to larger communities," David said.

While volunteers handle routine upkeep, larger restoration

efforts require experts. Last July, the lighthouse's 1820s brick interior and three brick chimneys on the keepers' houses were repaired. Next, Conary said, are plans to install iron railing in the lighthouse, and paint its interior.

The Fresnel lens is on display as a long-term loan from the Coast Guard's Heritage Asset Collection. More than \$30,000 was raised to coordinate its return, and ensure its preservation.

The goal is to keep it accessible to the public for interpretive and educational purposes.

"We treat it as a museum piece," Conary said. "This is a place I want more people on the North Shore to be aware of"

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Second Mass. case of West Nile virus this year reported in Middlesex

By Shannon Larson
GLOBE STAFF

A man in his 60s is the second person to test positive for West Nile virus in Massachusetts this year after he was exposed in Middlesex County, public health officials said Monday.

On Thursday, officials announced the state's first human case of the season — a man in his 90s who was also exposed in Middlesex County. As a result, officials have raised the risk level for contracting the mosquito-borne virus to high in Boston, Brookline, Cambridge, Everett, Newton, Somerville, and Watertown, according to the state's Department of Public Health.

"We are currently in peak season for [West Nile virus] in mosquitoes, and the risk for many across Massachusetts is high," Public Health Commissioner Robbie Goldstein said in a statement.

"Those who are older or have compromised immune systems are especially at risk," he noted.

No further information was released about when or where the men were exposed to the virus.

The virus is most commonly spread to humans when mosquitoes feed on infected birds and then bite people, according to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention.

Mosquitoes in Massachusetts began testing positive for the virus in mid-June. So far, 184 positive samples have been detected in a number of counties, officials said.

On Wednesday, officials said Eastern equine encephalitis virus was confirmed in two mos-

quito samples collected in Kingstons in Plymouth County. No human or animal cases have been reported this year.

Officials said mosquitoes will be around until the first hard frost and urged people to take precautions.

Between 2001 and 2025, 273 people across the state were reported with a West Nile virus infection, according to state officials. Twenty of those people died.

The virus can cause illness ranging from a mild fever to more serious disease, such as encephalitis or meningitis. Most people who are infected have no symptoms. Those who do have symptoms, however, may have a fever, headache, body aches, nausea, or vomiting. They may develop a rash. Symptoms usually appear two to six days after being bitten by an infected mosquito, according to state officials.

People can protect themselves by applying an insect repellent with an EPA-registered ingredient, such as DEET and permethrin, when outdoors. Officials said people should also consider rescheduling outdoor activities that occur in the hours from dusk to dawn — peak biting times for many mosquitoes — in areas of high risk. Wearing long sleeves, long pants, and socks when outdoors can also help prevent mosquito bites.

More information about West Nile virus and how to prevent an infection can be found here.

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State names new interim commissioner of higher education

By Michaela Towfighi
GLOBE STAFF

and Audrey Tomlin
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

José Luis Santos will serve as the new interim Massachusetts commissioner of higher education, the state department announced on Monday.

Santos, currently the department's senior deputy commissioner and special adviser, will take the helm Oct. 1 when Noe Ortega, the current commissioner, is set to step down.

The state hopes to announce a permanent commissioner by early 2027, said Chris Gabrieli, the chair of the Massachusetts Board of Higher Education.

Santos said his immediate priority will be to provide stability for the department.

"During this time, one principle will guide me," Santos said. "Students must remain at the center of every decision we make."

Santos joined the department early in Ortega's tenure and has worked there for just over three years. Ortega credited his leadership with the expanded state investments in financial aid and the launch of the state's Innovation Hub, which used a \$2.1 million grant to pilot ways to increase access to college, affordability and student opportunities.

Ortega said Santos is a "known commodity with all our partners," at a special meeting to confirm the appointment.

"He has the trust and respect of our team, and understands both what work is going into what we've done and what it takes to get even more done," said Ortega.

Santos was the first in his family to attend college, born to migrant farm workers who immigrated from Mexico. He took community college classes while enlisted in the Marines. Later, he used the GI Bill, Pell grants, and an ROTC scholarship to pursue further degrees.

"I know firsthand what happens when higher education and the support that makes it possible opens a door that might otherwise remain closed," he said. "Our work here is to help people pursue those educational goals at every stage of their life."

Ortega oversaw the depart-

ment through a precarious period for higher education both in Massachusetts and across the country. As the Trump administration launched attacks against elite universities, with a keen eye toward Harvard, protections for international students were also at risk and many began to question the value of a four-year degree.

In April, both Hampshire and Anna Maria colleges revealed they would close, succumbing to financial woes.

But amid the challenging landscape, enrollment returned to pre-pandemic levels and the state implemented several measures to make college more affordable.

Attending community college became free regardless of age or income, schools have introduced three-year degree programs, and state spending on financial aid doubled.

Enrollment at the state's 15 community colleges increased by nearly 20,000 students from 2023 to 2025, to just over 86,000 students.

Nate Woodard, a student at Greenfield Community College, said he is excited to work with Santos. Woodard is one of two executive officers for the department of higher education's student advisory board and appreciates that both their higher education journeys began at community colleges.

After attending community college, Santos went on to become a triple graduate of the University of Arizona, with a bachelor's degree in Mexican American studies, a master's in educational psychology, and a PhD in higher education economics and finance policy.

"I think having somebody who is now a doctor and now the interim commissioner who went through the community college system, went through different schools, is a big thing," said Woodard. "I'm just super excited to meet with him, work with him, and show him that community colleges are strong and better now and in the future."

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\$2b Springfield courthouse deal upheld

► **COURTHOUSE**
Continued from Page B1

Patel. Their teams filed the lawsuit in a bid to overturn the state agency's award.

The state awarded a \$2 billion contract to Liberty Junction, which is made up of a real estate firm from Virginia, FD Stonewater, and CoJo Real Estate, which was owned by Barros and Conan Harris, the husband of US Representative Ayanna Pressley.

The general contractor for the team is Suffolk Construction, whose chief executive, John Fish, is a political heavyweight in Boston and prominent business leader.

The losing bidders alleged that state officials had not been forthcoming with all public documents about the bid process. The capital asset management division earlier in July posted online what it said were all the documents. The agency had defended the bidding process as "fair, thorough and competitive" and resulted in "the selection of the bid that was the lowest cost to taxpayers."

The plaintiffs asked that the

project be halted and wanted the court to rule that the state violated the conflict of interest law, making the Liberty Junction team ineligible for the contract.

Part of their argument centered on Barros' appointment to the MCCA. One of the members of the convention board who voted for his appointment is Governor Maura Healey's budget secretary, whose office also oversees the capital asset management division.

But Hodge said the plaintiffs "presented no legal or factual support for their contention" that the state's selection of Liberty Junction broke state conflict of interest Law "due to what the plaintiffs assume to be a conflict of interest by Barros."

"The plaintiffs have offered no evidence that Barros ever acted in a manner that would cause a reasonable person to conclude that any person could improperly influence him or unduly enjoy Barros's favor" as the MCCA's interim director, Hodge wrote. "Nor is there evidence that Barros, through his position at MCCA, ever attempted to influence

anyone at DCAMM on matters pertaining to Liberty Junction's proposal or the Springfield courthouse project, or that Barros exercised improper influence in the procurement process."

In a statement Monday, the Liberty Junction group said that "what is most important . . . is that the too-long-awaited replacement of the County Courthouse gets underway."

Balise and Patel, the losing bidders, said in a statement Monday that despite the denial of the preliminary injunction, "their claims remain very much alive."

"The people of Springfield deserve a full airing of the facts and circumstances surrounding this procurement, and they deserve a process that is fair, complete, and complies with the law. We remain fully committed to that goal," they said. "Our confidence is complete, and our commitment to this community is unwavering, which is why we will continue to pursue every available legal avenue, completely and without hesitation."

Barros's attorney said last month that his client "did every-

thing right and complied fully with the law," but that he would divest from the project because he "determined that the significant public benefits that will come from the Liberty Junction Team's project . . . outweigh his personal interests."

The Liberty Junction group submitted a 266-page proposal to DCAMM in October 2025, proposing a six-story building on the site of a former medical office, across from the Hampden County Sheriff's Office.

In a statement last month, state Trial Court leadership said the Liberty Junction project had a "thoughtful" layout, would allow natural light into the courtrooms, and could be accessed by both public transportation and nearby highways. The plan also offered "the most competitive price," trial court leaders wrote.

Healey called the Liberty Junction bid "high quality," and argued it was \$300 million below the next-lowest bid.

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Congressional candidate admits past OUI

Whalen accuses Neal of leaking sealed record

By Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

A Western Massachusetts congressional candidate challenging 19-term US Representative Richard Neal acknowledged in a social media post that he had a past drunken driving arrest, calling it evidence that “newfound independence and alcohol, as many of us know, don’t mix well at a young age.”

In a Facebook post, Jeromie Whalen, a 39-year-old high school journalism teacher running in the sprawling First Congressional District, wrote that “every incident came [with] accountability and taking responsibility for my actions.”

Whalen posted the lengthy response after he said he received a call from the New York Post inquiring about his past conduct. The Post later published a story Sunday detailing

the charges, including a 2010 incident in which Whalen crashed a car in Amherst, citing “police reports.”

The South Hadley Democrat and political newcomer said the incidents happened 16 years ago “before most of my students were even born.” He said he “received” an OUI and lost his license while attending college at the University of Massachusetts Amherst, and faced a battery charge after refusing medical services and trying to leave a hospital “after drinking too much.” He said he also got slapped with a noise complaint for a house party.

In an interview with the Globe Monday, Whalen said he sought to have the records sealed in 2016 to avoid stigma and “social perceptions.” State law lets people with misdemeanor convictions seal their records three years after completing their sentences, as long as they stay out of trouble.

Whalen said the charges represent “a younger version of myself who was trying to navigate how to be independent, just as a

lot of us do in our college years.”

Then, he told himself: “Some of those things you are doing are really selfish.”

Whalen, in his social media post, accused Neal of being the source of and leaking the documents. Neal, through a spokesperson, declined to comment.

The Globe could not find a record of the Massachusetts charges in the state courts database. Court documents for the January 2006 battery charge were more revealing.

According to an arrest report filed in Osceola County, Fla., Whalen refused medical care in a Kissimmee hospital after arriving “extremely intoxicated and unable to care for himself.” The report alleges he ripped out an IV and “used profanity” before “pocking” a hospital security officer in the chest.

He spent the night in the Osceola County jail.

In his Facebook post, Whalen said he took accountability: he paid a fine for the noise complaint and lost his license for the OUI.

“Trust me, it sucks,” he said.

“Don’t ever do it.”

In the post, Whalen also attached copies of his Criminal Offender Record Information — a so-called CORI check — which state law requires school employees to renew every three years.

Whalen, who launched his campaign last year at Arcpoint Brewing Company in Belchertown, has also fundraised at Bright Ideas Brewing in Westfield, and attempted to collaborate with a Pittsfield brewery to raise campaign cash. (The idea was quashed when experts questioned its legality, the Globe reported.) Whalen said Monday that his relationship with alcohol “has definitely changed.”

“When I was in college, binge drinking was the norm. It was something everyone was partaking in,” he told the Globe. “You become desensitized to it. And then you grow up.”

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Alleged drunk driver charged in fatal North Reading crash

By John R. Ellement
GLOBE STAFF
and Bryan Hecht
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

WOBURN — An Andover father and his 8-year-old daughter have been identified as the victims of a fiery fatal crash in North Reading on Saturday night, allegedly caused by a drunk driver speeding at 100 miles per hour, records show.

At 10:46 p.m., Samir Naili, 35, and his daughter Kashmira Naili were stopped at a traffic light on Route 28 when a white Acura MDX smashed into the back of their Honda HR-V, officials said.

The Honda burst into flames, and despite efforts by emergency responders and a good Samaritan, Naili and his daughter were pronounced dead at the scene, Middlesex District Attorney Marian Ryan’s office said Monday.

Matthew R. Sweeney, 21, of Paxton, appeared in Woburn District Court Monday on five charges, including two counts of motor vehicle homicide while drunk and speeding, records show.

Kevin Mahoney, a lawyer for Sweeney, told Judge Jane D. Prince that his client has no memory of the crash. He said Sweeney has “a history of lost time and blackouts” linked to ongoing mental health issues.

Mahoney said Sweeney was diagnosed with bipolar disorder in September 2024 while in a UMass hospital, where he was involuntarily committed at his mother’s request.

In December, he was involuntarily hospitalized for a second time at his mother’s request, spending three days at St. Vincent’s Hospital in Worcester, Mahoney said.

Sweeney was prescribed antipsychotic medications but stopped taking them after they caused chest pains, Mahoney said. It’s unclear when he stopped taking the medication, Mahoney said.

At Mahoney’s request, the judge ordered Sweeney to undergo a 15-day mental health evaluation at Bridgewater State Hospital to determine his competency to stand trial. He was held on \$250,000 cash bail and is due back in court on Sept. 11, records show.

When Sweeney was being booked at the North Reading police station Saturday night, he reportedly asked officers “Who did I kill?”

“You don’t come back from a thing like that,” he said, according to a police report filed in court.

Sweeney initially told police his last name was “Gonzalez” and started to ask about the level of criminal trouble he was facing.

“Sir, have I [expletive] up big or bad, yes or no?” Sweeney asked at one point, the report said. “So am I in like hella deep [expletive] or no?”

Sweeney refused medical attention at the scene, refused to take chemical breath or field sobriety tests, and asked for an attorney.

Sweeney was charged with driving under the influence based on the “overwhelming”

smell of alcohol, slurred speech, eyes that were “blood shot and glossy,” and the difficulty he had answering routine questions, the report said.

Police found two open alcoholic beverages and a third Chick-Fil-A cup smelling of alcohol inside the car, the report said.

Earlier Saturday night, police in Methuen reported they were searching for a white SUV involved in a hit-and-run crash. Details of that incident were not immediately available on Monday.

A police officer in Andover, who had been alerted to the Methuen crash by a State Police notice, spotted the white SUV speeding at more than 100 miles per hour on Route 28, according to a police report.

While following the SUV, the officer saw the vehicle stray over a double-yellow line, nearly rear-end a vehicle, and then drive into North Reading.

The officer slowed down when he crossed into North Reading and saw the car crash into the Honda at high speed, police said. The Andover officer took Sweeney into custody and tried to help the victims in the burning car, police wrote.

In May 2025, East Brookfield District Court records show Sweeney was arrested for allegedly punching his mother in the head and trying to grab the steering wheel while she was driving.

Courtney Sweeney, who later dropped the charges, told police she had been trying unsuccessfully to get her son to attend therapy and “he occasionally uses drugs, which leads to instances such as this,” according to a police report.

Included in that arrest report were various alleged red flags Paxton Police had previously logged regarding Sweeney after responding to the September 2024 incident at his home that led to his first hospitalization, records show.

Police wrote that Sweeney had “violent tendencies,” including showing knives to officers, was “suicidal,” and had allegedly said, “Police will not take me alive.”

The superintendent of the Andover Public Schools, Keith Taverna, said in a statement that Kashmira Naili was entering the third grade at South Elementary School.

“It is with deep sadness and with the family’s permission that we inform you about a recent loss to the South School community,” Taverna wrote. “An incoming 3rd grade South School student was a passenger in a fatal car accident in North Reading on Saturday night.”

“We extend our deepest condolences and support to the victims and their family,” he wrote. “We understand that this loss may bring a range of emotions, concerns, and questions for our entire school community.”

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Pressley, Trahan endorse Tram Nguyen

►NGUYEN
Continued from Page B1

that it would help him deliver for the North Shore-anchored district. But Trahan, a former congressional chief of staff before she won her seat, said she doesn’t “think it’s necessary that you understand the D.C. ecosystem” going into Congress, pointing to others who, like Nguyen, “cut their teeth in state legislatures.”

Trahan and Pressley, both of whom first won their House seats in 2018, are two of only three women in the state’s nine-person House delegation. (House minority whip Katherine Clark is the other.) Either Nguyen or Koh would be the first Asian American to represent Massachusetts in Congress, if elected.

“Tram Nguyen is a barrier-breaker, table-shaker, and exactly the kind of progressive leader this moment demands,” Pressley said in a statement.

“I’ve known Tram for almost a decade now,” she added, “and what inspires me most about her is her contagious optimism and how she believes deeply in what our Commonwealth and our country can achieve when we demand more from our leaders and government.”

Nguyen, in a statement, said she has “deeply admired” Trahan and Pressley’s work “fighting for a stronger, more inclusive future built on progressive values.”

“I am honored to have them standing with us and look forward to working alongside them in Congress to build a powerful movement ready to challenge the status quo,” she said.

The endorsements come at a critical time for Nguyen. Her campaign launched its first TV advertisement late last month, emphasizing her background as an immigrant and that in 2018, she ousted a conservative Republican state representative to win a seat on Beacon Hill.

But Nguyen and her campaign have lagged others in fund-raising, and urged sup-



JOSH REYNOLDS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

State Representative Tram Nguyen, of Andover, is running to replace Representative Seth Moulton in the Sixth Congressional District.

porters in a recent social media post to “chip in today to help us keep our ad on the air.” Her latest financial report shows she spent \$325,000 from the beginning of July through Aug. 12, and had about \$190,000 on hand entering the final three weeks ahead of the Sept. 1 primary.

That number pales in comparison to her better-funded opponents. Koh, who spent about \$1.8 million during the same period and still had nearly \$2 million on hand, also reported pouring in \$150,000 more of his own money late last week. John Beccia, a Lynnfield fintech executive who is largely self-financing his campaign, spent about \$2.3 million during the same timeframe and had \$750,000 on hand.

Still, Nguyen is getting a boost from at least two outside groups: Save America Fund, a Rhode Island-based super PAC that reported shelling out almost \$88,000 this year on Nguyen’s behalf. In recent days, Pro-Choice Majority Action, a PAC

that focuses on helping Democrats, has reported pouring \$450,000 into digital ads backing Nguyen.

Nguyen, like Koh and other candidates this cycle, has given messaging cues to outside groups using a tactic known as “red-boxing,” in which candidates publicly post suggestions to follow. The discrete instructions allow them to flout rules preventing coordination with super PACs, which can raise and spend unlimited amounts of money.

She’s also nabbed endorsements from unions, including United Auto Workers International, and liberal activist groups like Progressive Massachusetts, and touted the backing of at least 50 sitting state representatives and senators.

There hasn’t been any independent public polling in the race. The other Democrats running include Bethany Andres-Beck, a Middleton software engineer; Jamie Belsito, Topsfield town moderator and a former state representative; and Mariah

Lancaster, a Salem veterinarian and former congressional aide.

Trahan didn’t directly address whether her endorsement of Nguyen was, in part, a bid to block Koh from Congress. But she said she knows “something about being outspent in races like this” — Koh also out-raised her by more than \$500,000 in their 2018 race — and plans to knock doors for Nguyen to reach voters in the primary’s final stretch.

“This has been a really interesting election cycle, where candidates with the most money have not necessarily won in these primaries,” said Trahan, who co-chairs the House Democratic Policy and Communications Committee and has campaigned for other Democrats across the country. “So I think people are paying attention to the candidates and how they’re going to be different.”

Kelly Garrity of the Globe staff contributed to this report.

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Body found in Worcester believed to be wife of slain officer

►WORCESTER
Continued from Page B1

history of domestic abuse.

“At no time did the Solomon family have any history of domestic abuse,” he said.

“I want to make myself absolutely clear at this point that has nothing to do with this case.”

Last week, police released Ring security footage showing Karen Solomon walking near the Westside Animal Clinic on Mill Street shortly after 5:40 a.m. on Aug. 18. She was wearing pajama shorts, a tank top, and flip-flops.

That location is about six-tenths of a mile from where Solomon’s body was found Monday.

Police had concentrated much of their search on Coe’s Pond and its surrounding 90-acre area, Saucier said.

Saucier said police have been expanding the search area and eventually planned to search the area where the body was discovered.

The discovery brings some measure of closure to an investigation that has taken a toll on the police department, Saucier said.

“Now that we have somewhat closure, this is when it’s going to really affect the men and women of the police department,” he said.

Saucier said the department has mental health and wellness resources available to officers.

The Solomon family released a statement Monday describing the last week as a “nightmare” that has left them “heartbroken and rudderless.”

The family thanked Worcester police and the numerous lo-



KEN MCGAGH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

The medical examiner’s van left Fairlawn Rehabilitation Hospital in Worcester, where a body was found Monday.

cal, state, and federal agencies that have assisted in the investigation and search, saying their “compassion, dedication, and empathy ... have given us light

in the face of darkness.”

“You men and women have taken time out of your lives to help us find answers, if there ever will be any,” the family said.

“You have given us comfort knowing that you were working on our behalf, FOR us. God Bless you all.”

The family also thanked people in Massachusetts and around the world who have offered prayers and sympathies.

“They have helped us through each minute of the day,” the statement said. “Thank you for your basic human compassion.”

The case has stunned people who knew the couple. Kurt Solomon grew up in the neighborhood where they lived and was remembered by neighbors as a fixture in the community.

Karen Solomon founded First H.E.L.P., a nonprofit focused on reducing stigma around mental health and helping families affected by emergency responder suicide.

In a phone interview Monday, Officer Thomas Duffy, president of the Worcester police union, also stressed that the family had no domestic violence history.

“There’s no history of domestic incidents or violence involving our officer or his wife,” Duffy said.

He said members of the department will celebrate the life of Kurt Solomon, while supporting his family.

“We’re going to focus on the way he lived his life in a tremendous, giving, caring way,” Duffy said.

“His two sons, in all likelihood, lost both their parents this week, and it’s unspeakable.”

Bryan Hecht can be reached at bryan.hecht@globe.com.

TELEVISION



MARTIN MEISSNER/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Dara from Bulgaria held the trophy after winning the 2026 Eurovision Song Contest in May.

Dutch broadcaster to boycott Eurovision for a second year, calling it a ‘platform for division’

By Mike Corder
ASSOCIATED PRESS

THE HAGUE, Netherlands — A Dutch broadcaster announced Monday it is boycotting the Eurovision Song Contest for a second year, calling it a “platform for division” because of tensions over Israel’s involvement.

The decision by AVROTROS comes after broadcasters in the Netherlands, Iceland, Ireland, Slovenia, and Spain refused to take part in this year’s contest because of Israel’s participation.

“AVROTROS will not participate in the Eurovision Song Contest in 2027 because the event can no longer be considered neutral, with a participating country still involved in a large-scale military conflict,” it said.

The Dutch broadcaster, which has a long history of involvement with the competition, said it was leaving it up to the public network NPO to decide on any Dutch involvement.

“The Eurovision Song Contest was originally created to bring people and countries together. It is undeniable that international conflicts are increasingly affecting the contest, undermining its neutral character,” AVROTROS director-general Taco Zimmerman said in a statement. “The Eurovision Song Contest has therefore become a platform for division.”

Eurovision Song Contest director Martin Green said in a statement that the organization regretted the move, but respects the views of member broadcasters. The contest is run by the Geneva-based European Broadcasting Union

(EBU) — a group of public broadcasters from 56 countries.

“The Eurovision Song Contest has always been a place to bring people together, celebrate diverse communities, and show that a better world is possible even in the most difficult times,” Green said in a statement sent to the Associated Press.

“We will now continue our dialogue with NPO, the umbrella organization for Dutch public service media, regarding the opportunities for another broadcaster to participate. We very much hope that audiences and artists in the Netherlands can continue to be represented in the Eurovision Song Contest,” he added.

In a statement, the NPO said it recognized that “geopolitical tensions are having a divisive effect. That’s why this hasn’t been an easy decision for our colleagues. We will reflect on the upcoming edition and will come back to this at the right moment.”

NPO said it was “too early to comment on the next steps at this point; we’re currently deliberating on that.”

The contest was founded in 1956, in part to help unite a shattered continent after World War II. It pits acts from dozens of countries against one another for the continent’s musical crown. Bulgarian singer Dara won the event this year with her infectious party anthem “Bangaranga.”

A number of performers and countries have called for the exclusion of Israel, which has taken part in Eurovision since 1973, one of a few non-European countries to compete.

LOVE LETTERS

BY MEREDITH GOLDSTEIN

Will he want to have kids?

Q. I know a man who loves me, and I truly love him back. He’s going through a difficult situation, getting a divorce. We have a 20-year age gap, and I’m very scared about what the future holds.

My question is: Should I give it a try anyway? I’m not sure how he’s going to handle the age gap in the future (I’m 25 and he’s in his 40s).

I don’t know if I would be able to have kids with him or not. He already has kids. I don’t know if he would have the energy to really want to have kids with me five to seven years from now.

So, should I continue with this? I’ve never been more in love with someone in my life, and that’s the truth, and I feel like he loves me back 100 percent.

I’m scared of missing out on dating people who are my age. But honestly, I’m not interested. I’m also not sure if I’m making the best decision to follow my heart and be with this man.

THE FUTURE

A. I’m wondering if you can enjoy your time with this man for a while without thinking about the future.

You’re in love with him. He feels the same about you. *Fantastic.* Does every love need to turn into *forever*? You could stay with this man for an intense and wonderful year, and then move on.

I know it’s difficult to orchestrate that — to fall out of love when it’s best to part ways — but I

An honest conversation about an uncomfortable topic might help you make decisions as this romance continues.

want you to consider that this could be perfect *and* temporary. You don’t say how long you’ve been together, but I suspect it’s still early in the relationship (I mean, he’s not even fully divorced). Maybe the two of you could just be there for each other and see what happens.

Feel free to ask him if he’d ever be open to kids with you, and if so, when. An honest conversation about an uncomfortable topic might help you make decisions as this romance continues.

But the point is you don’t have to make any big choices right now. If you feel too *in love* to do anything but experience it, great. That seems to be where you are — smitten and determined to enjoy it.

That’s OK. Just pay attention to how your priorities change as you continue.

MEREDITH

READERS RESPOND:

Have you asked the only person who could possibly know his intentions regarding children? Not Meredith, the guy himself.

ZEPTEMBER-

I dated a couple of guys who were “going through a divorce.” ... One, I think, went back to his wife, the other had already broken up with me by the time his divorce was final, so in the end I was nothing more than a rebound (even though I definitely did not see that when we were together). I’m also hoping you weren’t the reason he is getting a divorce (i.e. an affair), as that almost never bodes well for relationship stability.

THEGOODPLACE20

It’s easy enough to ask him how he would feel about having more children, giving you more information to go on. The thing that’s harder to assess is how *you* are going to feel when you are older.

SEENITTOO

I would also suggest that you don’t date a man 20 years older than you, with children. Just don’t. Find someone your own age.

OUTOFORDER

I’ve seen a lot of second marriages with the characteristics you mention. It’s really not so much the age difference that makes the men not want kids with the affair partner; it’s the fact that they already have them and feel that phase is over in their life.

My sister’s ex had two kids with the much younger woman he left my sister for. My sister is happy about this because her alimony stops when he retires — and he can’t retire for 20 years

EXPENDABLESOCKPUPPET06262023

It’s way too soon for you to be making big future plans. But having fun and living in the moment? Sure. Just be sure you have your realistic glasses on.

EACB

Send your own relationship and dating questions to loveletters@globe.com. Catch new episodes of Meredith Goldstein’s “Love Letters” podcast wherever you listen to podcasts. Column and comments are edited and reprinted from boston.com/loveletters.

Tuesday August 25, 2026

	7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30
2	WGBH PBS	BBC News	R. Steves	Finding Your Roots Lizzo, Flea	American Masters (N)		Iconic America: Our Symbols & Stories		Aman-pour (N)	
4	WBZ CBS	Wheel of Fortune	Jeopardy!	NCIS "Gone Girls"	NCIS: Origins "The Gambler"		NCIS: Origins "Homeward Bound"	News (N)	(:35) Comics	
5	WCVB ABC	News (N)	Chronicle	Jeopardy! Masters (N) (SP)	Celebrity Nicole Byer, Margaret Cho		Celebrity Fam. Shad "Bow Wow" Moss	NewsCenter 5 (N)	(:35) J. Kimmel	
6	WLNE ABC	Videos		Whose	Whose		Saturday Night Live	Saturday Night Live		
7	WHDH	Inside (N)	Extra (N)	Family Feud	Family Feud	7 News at 9PM (N)	7 News at 10PM (N)	7 News at 11PM (N)	(:35) Inside	
9	WMUR ABC	Chronicle	News (N)	Jeopardy! (N) (SP)	Celebrity Fam.		Celebrity Fam.	News (N)	J.Kimmel	
10	NBC Boston	Boston News (N)	Hollywood (N)	America's Got Talent (N) (Live)	"Quarterfinals 2"		Password Karamo Brown	Boston News (N)	(:35) J. Fallon (N)	
10	WJAR NBC	News (N) (Live)	Extra (N)	America's Got Talent (N) (Live)	"Quarterfinals 2"		Password Karamo Brown	News (Live)	(:35) J. Fallon (N)	
11	WENH PBS	Week-ends	In the America	Finding Your Roots Lizzo, Flea	American Masters (N)		Gregory Maguire		Aman-pour (N)	
12	WPRI CBS	Wheel of Fortune	Jeopardy!	NCIS "Gone Girls"	NCIS: Origins "The Gambler"		NCIS: Origins "Homeward Bound"	12 News at 11 (N)	(:35) Comics	
25	WFXT FOX	ET (N)	TMZ (N)	Kitchen Nightmares "Cafe Notte" (N)	Shazam "8th Time's a Charm!" (N)		Boston 25 News at 10PM (N) (Live)	News (Live)	(:35) News (N)	
27	WUNI	Rosa "En silencio" (N)		Tan cerca de ti, nace el amor (N)	Guardián de mi vida (N)		Corazón de oro (N)	Noticias Univisión	(:35) Noticiero	
36	WSBE PBS	Last-/Wine	Served?	As Time Goes By	Waiting for God	Upstart Crow	Keep-Appear	Doc Martin	PBS News Hour	
38	WSBK	Big Bang	Big Bang	WBZ News 8p (N)	48 Hours (N)		Perfect	Perfect	Flip Side	Flip Side
44	WGBX PBS	Test Kitchen	Antiques	Miss Fisher and the Crypt of Tears ('20) Miriam Margolyes, Essie Davis.			Downton Abbey on Masterpiece		PBS News Hour (N)	
50	WWJE	48 Hours		Heartland Homicide	Homicide "Hunt"		Crime Stories		Unusual Suspects	
56	WLVI CW	Young Sheldon	Young Sheldon	WWE NXT (N) (Live)			7 News at 10PM on CW56 (N)	Modern Family	Modern Family	
64	WNAC FOX	Family Feud	Family Feud	Kitchen Nightmares "Cafe Notte" (N)	Shazam "8th Time's a Charm!" (N)		12 News on Fox Pr (N)	Seinfeld	Seinfeld	
68	WBXP ION	Chicago Fire "Don't Hang Up"		Chicago Fire "What Comes Next"	Chicago "A White-Knuckle Panic"		Chicago Fire "No Survivors"	Chicago Fire "Mayday"		
PREMIUM CABLE										
Cinemax	(5:45) Beiruts	(:35) ★★ Black Adam ('22) Aldis Hodge, Pierce Brosnan, Wayne Johnson.		(:40) ★★ The Flash ('23) Sasha Calle, Michael Shannon, Ezra Miller.						
Flix	(5:55) An Officer and a Gentleman	★★ Indecent Proposal ('93) Demi Moore, Woody Harrelson, Robert Redford.		★★★ Frankie & Johnny ('91) Michelle Pfeiffer, Héctor Elizondo, Al Pacino.						
HBO	(6:25) ★★ ★★ The Dark Knight ('08) Heath Ledger, Christian Bale.		Train Seahawks (N)	Lanterns			(:55) Hard Knocks: Seattle Seahawks			
HBO 2	(6:35) ★★ ★★ Bleed for This ('16) Aaron Eckhart, Katey Sagal, Miles Teller.		(:15) Lanterns	(:10) ★★ ★★ Battle of the Sexes ('17) Steve Carell, Emma Stone.			(:10) ★★ Normal ('25) Bob Odenkirk.			
Paramount-Sho	★★★ Bleed for This ('16) Aaron Eckhart, Katey Sagal, Miles Teller.		Brave the Dark ('25) Jared Harris, Sasha Bhasin, Nicholas Hamilton.				★★★ Scream ('96) Neve Campbell.			
Showtime 2	(6:00) ★★ You've Got Mail ('98)	★★★ The Friend ('24) Bill Murray, Ann Dowd, Naomi Watts.		Here and Now ('18) Sarah Jessica Parker.			(:35) Don Jon			
Starz!	★★ Jack Reacher: Never Go Back ('16) Cobie Smulders, Tom Cruise.		Beast ('26) Bren Foster, Mojean Aria, Daniel MacPherson.				★★ The Housemaid ('25)			
TMC	(6:10) Day of the Fight ('23)	The Dead Don't Hurt ('23) Viggo Mortensen, Solly McLeod, Vicky Krieps.		(:10) ★★ ★★ True Grit ('10) Matt Damon, Josh Brolin, Jeff Bridges.						
SPORTS										
CBSSN	APP Tour Chicago Open, Part 5 (N)	APP Tour Pickleball Chicago Open: Part 6 (N)		APP Tour Chicago Open, Part 5			APP Tour Chicago Open: Part 6			
ESPN	2026 Little League Baseball World Series Game 28: Teams TBA (Live)		SportsCenter Special Fantasy Football Draft (Live)				SportsCenter (N) (Live)			
ESPN2	Fantasy Focus	2026 US Open: Roger Federer, An Icon Returns to New York (N) (Live)		APP Tour Pickleball Detroit Open (N)						
Fox Sports 1	EWC Paris:	MotoGP Racing BWIN Grand Prix of Austria (Live)		LIV Golf Highlights Indianapolis (N)			IndyCar Racing Freedom 250 Grand Prix of Washington, D.C.			
Golf	Payne (N) (Live)	Big Break x		Big Break x (N) (Live)			Big Break x Good Good			
NBA	(6:00) W.. Pregame	Basketball Portland Fire at Dallas Wings		Postgame (N) (Live)			Basketcast			
NBC Sports	WNBA Basketball Chicago Sky at Connecticut Sun (N) (Live)		Best of Zolak and Bertrand	Boston Sports (N) (Live)			Boston Sports			
NESN	(6:30) Baseball Boston Red Sox at Miami Marlins	Extra (N)	Red Sox	Chat (N)			Batting			
FAMILY										
Cartoon	Burgers	Burgers	Burgers	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	RickMorty	RickMorty
Disney	Big City Greens	Big City Greens	Phineas and Ferb	Phineas and Ferb	Vampirina	Phineas and Ferb	Phineas and Ferb	Kiff	Ladybug	Ladybug
Encore Family	(6:25) Against the W...	★★ Daddy's Home ('15)		(:35) ★★ Star Kid ('97)			(:20) Running Free			
Nickelodeon	Friends	Friends	Friends	Friends	Friends	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang
Nick Jr.	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..

Content Ratings: TV-Y Appropriate for all children; TV-Y7 For children age 7 and older; TV-G General audience; TV-PG Parental guidance suggested; TV-14 May be unsuitable for children under 14;

TV-MA Mature audience only Additional symbols: D Suggestive dialogue; FV Fantasy violence; L Strong language; S Sexual activity; V Violence; HD High-Definition; (CC) Close-Captioned

News Specials

	7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30	
BASIC CABLE											
A&E	Customer Wars	Customer Wars	Customer Wars	Customer Wars	Customer Wars	Customer Wars	Customer Wars	Customer Wars	(:05) Customer	(:35) Customer	
AMC	★★★★ Goodfellas ('90) Ray Liotta, Joe Pesci, Robert De Niro.					★★★ My Cousin Vinny ('92) Joe Pesci.					
Animal Planet	Louisiana Lockdown "Hunger Strike"		Louisiana Lockdown "Bones"		Louisiana Lockdown "Escape!"		Louisiana Lockdown "Death Ride"		Louisiana Lockdown "After Midnight"		
BBC America	(5:15) Red Dawn		★★★★ A Few Good Men ('92) Jack Nicholson, Tom Cruise.					Law & Order			
BET	Celebrity Megan Thee Stallion, Ne-Yo		Celebrity Family Feud (N)		Ms. Pat (N)	Comic-View (N)	Martin	Martin	Martin	Martin	
Bravo	The Real Housewives		The Real Housewives (N)		(:15) The Real Housewives of London (N)			Housewives/OC "All Bets Are Off"			
CMT	Mama's	Mama's	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Gold Girls	Gold Girls	
CNN	OutFront (Live)		Cooper 360		The Source With		CNN NewsNight		Laura (Live)	(Live)	
Comedy Central	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	
CSPAN	(6:00) Public Affairs		C-SPAN Primetime				C-SPAN Primetime				
CSPAN2	(6:00) Public Affairs		Public Affairs Events				Public Affairs Events				
Dest. America	Log Cabin	Log Cabin	Log Cabin	Log Cabin	Log Cabin	Log Cabin	Log Cabin	Log Cabin	Log Cabin	Log Cabin	
Discovery	(6:00) Homestead		Homestead Rescue: Intervention (N) (SF)			Homestead "Bee Stings and Better Days"					
Discovery Life	About Face		About Face		About Face		About Face		About Face		
E!	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	Cocktail	Cocktail	How I Met	How I Met	
Encore	★★ The Girl in the Spider's Web ('18)		Jesse (N) (Live)			★★★ Shaft Samuel L. Jackson.		(:45) ★★ 3 Days to Kill ('14)			
Food	Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby	Bobby's "Titans vs Alex Stupak" (N)		Kitchen Undercover (N)		Triple Threat "Titans vs. Jet Tila"		Bobby's "Titans vs. Manneet Chauhan"		
Fox News	Ingraham (Live)		Jesse (N) (Live)		Hannity (Live)		Gunfile!		Fox News (Live)		
Freeform	★★ Elemental ('23)		Leah Lewis.		★★★ Inside Out ('15) Amy Poehler.			The 700 Club			
FUSE	Elvis: Death		Elvis Presley: The Final Hours			Elvis & Priscilla		Cheaters	Cheaters	Cheaters	
FX	(5:30) Bad Boys for ...		★★ Bad Boys: Ride or Die ('24) Will Smith.			★★★ Coming to America ('88)					
FXM	(5:50) ★★ Alien 3		(:10) ★★ Alien Resurrection ('97)				(:05) ★★ Alien vs. Predator ('04)				
Hallmark	(6:00) October Kiss		Notes of Autumn ('23) Ashley Williams.				Gold Girls	Gold Girls	Gold Girls	Gold Girls	
Hallmark Myst.	(6:00) Mystery 101		Mystery 101 "An Education in Murder"				Murder, She Wrote		Murder, She Wrote		
HGTV	Love It or List It "Tightly Squeezed"		Love It "Worth The Risk?" (N)		Extreme "A Place to Land" (N)		Totally '90s (N)	Totally '90s (N)	House Hunters	House Hunters	
History	The Proof Is Out There		The Proof Is Out There		The Proof Is Out There (N)		(:05) The Proof Is Out There (N)		(:05) The Proof Is Out There		
HLN	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	
HSN	Gabor Wigs		Emryn House			Tuesday (N) (Live)		Tuesday (N) (Live)		Gabor Wigs	
ID	Murder in the Heartland		Evil Lives Here		Psycho-path (N)	Psycho-path (N)	48 Hours (N)		Lethally Blonde "Killing King Cobra"		
IFC	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	
Lifetime	Castle		Castle		Castle		(:05) Castle		(:05) Castle		
LMN	(6:00) Pregnancy Sc...		Swindler Seduction ('22) Colton Haynes.				Switched Before Birth ('21)				
MAGN	Beachfront Reno		Lakefront Barg		Lakefront Barg (N)		Lakefront Barg		Lakefront Barg		
MSNBC	The Weeknight		All in (Live)		Briefing (Live)		Last Word (Live)		The 11th (Live)		
MTV	Caught in Act		Caught in Act (N)		Caught in Act		Caught in Act		Caught in Act		
National Geographic	Conquistadors "A New World"		Conquistadors: The Rise and Fall		Conquistadors "The Aztec Conquest"		Conquistadors "The Inca Conquest"		Conquistadors: The Rise and Fall		
NatGeoWild	The Incredible		The Incredible		The Incredible		The Incredible		The Incredible		
NECN	News	NBCYOU	Dateline		Dateline		Rescue	OpenHou...	1st Look	Rescue	
NewsNation	Vargas Report		Cuomo		On Balance		Katie Pavlich		Jesse Web		
Ovation	Murder Myste...			Leverage		Leverage		Leverage		Leverage	
OWN	Deadline: Crime		Deadline: Crime		Deadline: Crime		20/20 on OWN		20/20 on OWN		
Oxygen	(6:00) Dateline		Forensic		Forensic		Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	
Paramount	(6:00) ★★ Couples Retreat ('09)				★★ The Intern ('15) Anne Hathaway, Robert De Niro.						
QVC	bareMinerals		HairMax (N) (Live)		Home (N) (Live)		Inspired Style (N) (Live)				
Science	Phantom Signals		Phantom Signals		Phantom Signals		Phantom Signals		Phantom Signals		
Sundance	Law & Order "By Perjury"		Law & Order "Pledge"		Law & Order "Lucky Stiff"		Law & Order "Illegitimate"		★★★ The Karate Kid ('84)		
SyFy	(6:30) ★★ ★★ Troy ('04) Eric Bana, Brad Pitt.				★★ Transformers: Dark of the Moon ('11)						
TBS	Baseball Los Angeles		Dodgers at Atlanta		Braves (Live)		MLB Close		Office	Office	
TCM	(6:45) Truth About ...		★★★ These Three ('36)			(:45) ★★ Beloved Brat ('38)		Nancy Drew, Detecti...			
TLC	Baylen Out Loud		Baylen Out Loud (N)		Baylen Out Loud (N)		1000-lb (N) (SP)		(:05) Last Resort		
TNT	(5:30) Road House		Dunkman		★★ Jurassic World ('15) Chris Pratt.					Movie	
Travel	Paranormal		Paranormal		Paranormal			Paranormal		Paranormal	
TruTV	Baseball Los Angeles		Dodgers at Atlanta		Braves (Live)		MLB Close		★★★ Moneyball ('11)		
TV Land	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	(:20) Raymond		Raymond	Raymond	King	King	
TV One	CosbySh..	CosbySh..	Lv Single	Lv Single	Lv Single	Lv Single	Lv Single	Lv Single	Lv Single	Lv Single	
USA	Law & Order: SVU "Truth Embargo"		Law & Order: SVU "Jumped In"		Law & Order: SVU "Soldier Up"		Law & Order: SVU "Blood Out"		Law & Order: SVU "Zone Rouge"		
VH-1	My Wife		★★ Poetic Justice ('93) Janet Jackson.				★★★ Baby Boy ('01)				
WE	Criminal Minds		Criminal Minds		Criminal Minds		Criminal Minds		Criminal Minds		

LivingArts



HILARY SCOTT/THE BOSTON POPS

“Wicked” star Cynthia Erivo performed with the Boston Pops at Tanglewood on Friday night. Anthony Parnther conducted in his Pops and Tanglewood debut.

By A.Z. Madonna
GLOBE STAFF

LENOX — Actor and singer Cynthia Erivo was two verses or so into a song on Friday evening at Tanglewood’s Koussevitzky Music Shed when she seemed to notice something had gone sideways. She signaled the show’s music director, Mark Meadows, who was seated at a piano. She hailed the conductor on the podium, Hollywood workhorse Anthony Parnther. The orchestra stopped playing. She caught her breath. Let’s take that one from the top, she said to her collaborators. Parnther cued clarinetist Christopher Elchico for the opening solo, and on went the show.

I’d be lying if I said I noticed anything out of place. I wasn’t familiar with the song, “What Are You Doing the Rest of Your Life?” as made famous by Barbra Streisand. Erivo herself said that it was a new addition to her repertoire, and it was “for those who know” — in contrast to the other Streisand signature with which she opened the evening, the much more famous “Don’t Rain on My Parade.” Maybe it was a minor stumble. Maybe it had all been about to unravel. Erivo wasn’t shrugging it off. Mulligan, please, she said. She got the mulligan, and nailed take two, and

Cynthia Erivo dazzles with Pops at Tanglewood, leaving crowd feeling good

the crowd loved her even more for it, if that was even possible.

How bright a star is Erivo at the moment? Earlier last week, she caused a London arena’s worth of ecstatic fits when she made a surprise guest appearance at a show by her “Wicked” co-star, Ariana Grande, where they sang the show’s tender eleven-o’clock number “For Good” together. And then, she spent two hours onstage with the Boston Pops and her backing combo while singing exactly zero songs from that blockbuster musical-turned-film, and making no apologies for that decision.

After all, the songs were all her choice; this is what she sings when she’s not in costume. “You’re indulging me,” she said to the audience with a sly smile, warning everyone that there’d be audience participation later.

Erivo’s indulgences of choice were mostly from the American songbooks of the ’60s through early ’90s. Some

MUSIC REVIEW

CYNTHIA ERIVO
With the Boston Pops.
At Tanglewood, Friday

tunes, such as “Ain’t No Way” and “Feeling Good” (a la Nina Simone, a cappella first verse, scatted ornaments and all), were also on the setlist at her Pops debut at Symphony Hall last year. She’d brought some new tunes too — well, new to her, including Sting’s “Fields of Gold,” which will be transcendent once she’s solidified her intentions for it, and Whitney Houston’s “I Have Nothing,” which arrived fully formed. She’s probably been singing that one into her hairbrush since she was in grade school.

She started at center stage with the mic on the stand, but she’s more comfortable in motion. Five-foot-one

in bare feet, her wiry marathon runner’s frame compulsively stalked around the stage, lunging and crouching into the money notes. Her almost three-octave vocal range spanned from a practically subterranean low D to an explosive high C, and her voice has a startlingly girlish and sweet cadence — which is why she was able to play a convincing young 20-something as Elphaba while Idina Menzel was not.

But that unique softness also meant that her “Feeling Good” a la Simone came off like cosplay, despite the vocally and visually stunning performance. By contrast, her “At Last” wasn’t trying to mimic Etta James, and so no one was anticipating James’s steely vocal mannerisms. I was drifting on Erivo’s pink cloud, lost in the moment and wishing my fiancé could have shared it with me.

If she returns to the Shed — and I hope she does — she might be more intentional about scale. She indulged

in a few extended improvisations without her microphone, which she cutely referred to as “misbehaving,” singing “can you hear me now” at one point. I’m not sure if the mics around the stage sent her voice out to the lawn (let me know!), but section 5 of the Shed heard much less of her sung banter, and much more ambient grumbling about not being able to hear her sung banter.

But she knew when to go for broke, and duly left nothing on the table at the end of the night. “(You Make Me Feel Like) A Natural Woman,” which started with that audience participation she’d teased earlier and ended with her whirling through the aisles, barefoot in the dust; then a one-two punch of songs penned by Prince, with “Purple Rain” bringing out a sea of cellphone lights and “Nothing Compares 2 U” pulling in the full forces of the Pops. Then as the one and only encore, “Let it Be,” one part Beatles, one part Aretha, all Cynthia.

If she’s reading this: If you’d like to add to your list of marathon finishes, we have a pretty famous one in Boston too, and the 3:21:40 time you clocked in London this spring means you already qualify. Just saying.

A.Z. Madonna can be reached at az.madonna@globe.com.

Lynyrd Skynyrd and Foreigner bring all of their hits (but no original members) to the Xfinity Center

By James Sullivan
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

MANSFIELD — In Foreigner’s song “Juke Box Hero,” a major hit from 45 years ago, a boy stands outside of a sold-out rock concert, hears a guitar, and resolves to devote his life to rock ‘n’ roll.

That fist-pumping anthem was the centerpiece of Foreigner’s 90-minute tour de force at the Xfinity Center Saturday, when the classic rock band — minus any of its original members — opened for another band that fans of a certain age grew up with, Lynyrd Skynyrd.

There were no original members in that group, either, but no matter. Like the above-mentioned song implies, classic rock fans of all ages just want to hear the hits.

On Saturday, they got what they paid for. Foreigner, which weathered the departure of frontman Lou Gramm to feuding and health concerns in the early 2000s and guitarist Mick Jones to Parkinson’s disease in recent years, played almost all of their biggest hits, from “Hot Blooded” and “Cold as Ice” to the 1984 ballad “I Want to Know What Love Is.”

Skynyrd, taking the headline slot, was led as usual by Johnny Van Zant, younger brother of Ronnie Van Zant, the frontman who died in a plane crash in 1977. That band swaggered through

MUSIC REVIEW

LYNYRD SKYNYRD + FOREIGNER
With Six Gun Sally.
At the Xfinity Center, Saturday

most of their own best-known songs, including “Sweet Home Alabama” and the epic that has become a punchline for the church of rock ‘n’ roll, “Free Bird.”

While both groups have long been part of the canon (Foreigner was finally inducted into the Rock and Roll Hall of Fame in 2024), the double bill provided some stark contrasts. Foreigner’s new singer, Luis Maldonado, was a dynamic presence — a wiry crowd-pleaser with the lungs of an opera star.

Born in Mexico, he grew up in Arizona and came to prominence when he joined the San Francisco band Train. A few years ago, he said, he was thinking about taking a break from the music world. While camping somewhere on Mount Kilimanjaro, he got a call to join Foreigner. He seemed genuinely thrilled to sing the band’s songs.

On “Urgent,” keyboardist Michael Bluestein, who grew up in Brookline and studied jazz at Berklee, celebrated his birthday by trotting out a keytar.

Midway through the band’s set, Maldonado joined guitarist Bruce Watson



DOLTYN SNEDDEN

Lynyrd Skynyrd, pictured in 2025, delivered their Southern rock guitar classics at the Xfinity Center on Saturday night.

at center stage for an “American Idol”-esque rendition of Simon & Garfunkel’s “Bridge Over Troubled Water.” The choice was intended, he said, as an antidote to the “noisy” times we’re living in.

Lynyrd Skynyrd have embraced some of that noise in recent years, but they mostly set aside their jingoism to give the people what they wanted — their patented Southern rock guitar ar-

my. Opening with a video tribute to “Hell House,” the swampland cabin in Florida where the original band woodshedded (also the name of the band’s new whiskey brand), a voiceover noted that the musicians worked out the parts of their songs “like a jigsaw puzzle.”

“Every note played was a tip of the hat to the ‘Simple Man,’” the voice intoned solemnly.

When the group launched into “I

Know a Little,” a hillbilly romp written by the late guitarist Steve Gaines, Van Zant asked the crowd if they were ready to put on their dancing shoes.

He, however, remained flat-footed. He’s a literal interpreter of the band’s lyrics — raising three fingers on “Gimme Three Steps,” and aiming two like a .22 on “Saturday Night Special.”

“You guys still love our country?” Van Zant asked with a wry smile as he dedicated “Simple Man” to America’s military and first responders. Earlier, after wrapping up “Don’t Ask Me No Questions” (“and I won’t tell you no lies,” as the full lyric says), he mentioned how much he loves singing that one.

Guitarist Rickey Medlocke, who sang and played drums for Skynyrd briefly in the early 1970s, rejoined the group on guitar in the 1990s. He played slide on “The Ballad of Curtis Loew,” an affectionate tribute to a composite character who was “the finest picker to ever play the blues,” and he took the forefront on the inevitable encore.

For that, Van Zant perched a symbolic gambler-style hat on his microphone stand and gave way to vintage black-and-white footage of his late brother singing the famous “Free Bird” verses. But the band’s best moment may have come a few songs earlier, when they played their invigorating cover of J.J. Cale’s “Call Me the Breeze.”

“Ha-HA!” Van Zant crowed. “Nothing in the world like a Lynyrd Skynyrd crowd, baby.”

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TV HIGHLIGHTS

Baseball: Red Sox-Marlins, 6:40 p.m., NESN
WNBA: Sky-Sun, 7 p.m., NBCSB
Baseball: Dodgers-Braves, 7:15 p.m., TBS
WNBA: Fire-Wings, 8 p.m., NBA
Listings, C6

Sports

C

THE BOSTON GLOBE TUESDAY, AUGUST 25, 2026 | BOSTONGLOBE.COM/SPORTS

In rare start, Seigler drives in winning run

By Peter Abraham
GLOBE STAFF

Red Sox 4
Marlins 2

MIAMI — That Anthony Seigler’s debut with the Red Sox in late June coincided with the team’s season-saving surge was no coincidence. The 27-year-old infielder contributed a number of big hits and held down second base in the weeks after he was called up.

But his playing time had sharply decreased recently with Nick Sogard earning the trust of interim manager Chad Tracy.

When Seigler returned to the lineup against the Marlins on Monday night, it was for only the second time since Aug. 10.

“Things happen over the course of the season,” he said. “When you get a chance, you have to

make the most of it.”

That opportunity came in the ninth inning, and Seigler was prepared. His first career triple drove in the go-ahead run, and the Sox went on to a 4-2 victory.

A Sox-centric crowd of 16,247 at loanDepot Park went wild when Seigler drove a curveball down the line in right field and into the corner. Pinch runner Eli White scored from first.

Sogard followed with an RBI single and the Sox had their fourth consecutive victory.

At 72-59, they are now only 2½ games behind the Yankees for the first American League wild card. The Sox are an incredible 40-13 since June 25.

Until Seigler’s game-winner, the teams were a

RED SOX, Page C4



CARMEN MANDATO/GETTY IMAGES

Nick Sogard (right) was excited Eli White crossed the plate in the ninth inning for a 3-2 lead.

FIRST STEP ON ROAD TO SUPER BOWL



WINSLOW TOWNSON FOR THE GLOBE

The high school sports season kicked off Monday with Day 1 of practice for MIAA football teams across the Bay State. While Brian Aylward (above) began his 30th season at the helm of Tewksbury, Brockton’s Andrew Moreno (right) listened to new coach Mike Norman Jr. deliver instructions for the Boxers. **C6**



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Sampson says the Celtics are an ideal fit for Cenac

By Adam Himmelsbach
GLOBE STAFF

University of Houston coach Kelvin Sampson has been around the recruiting trail long enough to identify the flaws that accompany the summer basketball circuit.

It can be challenging to evaluate players because games tend to devolve into glorified pickup games. And when top prospects with little to prove are on rosters, they often spend as much time on the sidelines in street clothes as they do in basketball uniforms.

It can all make it easy for a coach such as Sampson, who has amassed 829 wins during his storied career, to roll his eyes.

But when Sampson attended the NBPA Top 100 Camp in Orlando two summers ago, an event that featured the

top two picks of this year’s draft (AJ Dybantsa and Darryn Peterson), he could not take his eyes off lesser-known big man Chris Cenac Jr.

“A lot of these players play one or two games, then sit,” Sampson said in a recent telephone interview. “Chris played every single game, including the last day, when not many kids were left. Chris’s best days might have been the last two days. He rebounded, he ran the floor, he competed, and he tried to win. I just loved his attitude.”

Cenac, a New Orleans native who was about to begin his senior year of high school, averaged 18.6 points and 11.4 rebounds and was named the camp’s most valuable player. His subsequent ascension was rapid.

He became a McDonald’s All-Amer-

CELTICS, Page C5



FILE/DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

The Celtics selected Houston forward Chris Cenac Jr. with the 27th pick of the NBA Draft on June 23.

Patriots trade receiver Boutte to the Texans

Safety Reed, seventh-round pick the return from Houston

By Nicole Yang
GLOBE STAFF

FOXBOROUGH — The Patriots finally found a trade partner for wide receiver Kayshon Boutte, sending him to the Houston Texans, a league source confirmed Monday.

In return, the Patriots will receive safety Jaylen Reed and a 2028 seventh-round draft pick.

After the Patriots beefed up their receiver room, signing Romeo Doubs and trading for A.J. Brown, trade rumors swirled around Boutte. Given New England’s depth at the position, and the fact that Boutte was entering the final year of his rookie contract, it seemed plausible that the two would part ways ahead of the start of the season.

The 24-year-old Boutte said all the right things throughout training camp — that he wants to take advantage of the opportunity in front of him, that he doesn’t focus on the outside chatter. But he also seemed open to playing elsewhere, saying that he needs to do what’s best for him.

By moving on from Boutte, the Patriots may have solved their logjam at receiver. The room, as of now, looks to be Brown, Doubs, Mack Hollins, Kyle Williams, De-Mario Douglas, and Efton Chism.

If Boutte had stayed, Chism likely would have been the odd man out. The cutdown deadline for 53-man rosters is set for Sunday.

Boutte’s three seasons in New England will be remembered as a developmental success story. A five-star recruit out of high school, Boutte was once considered a first-round talent. But a serious ankle injury that required two surgeries, along with off-the-field character concerns, marred his college career at LSU and dropped his draft stock. The Patriots ended up taking Boutte in the sixth

BOUTTE, Page C2

Star cornerback Gonzalez back on practice field

By Nicole Yang
GLOBE STAFF

FOXBOROUGH — Notes and observations from Day 21 of Patriots training camp:

1. Cornerback Christian Gonzalez returned to practice Monday, marking his first appearance in uniform in two weeks. He was a full participant in the session, indicating he has fully recovered from the injury he suffered at the end of practice Aug. 10.

The fact that Gonzalez decided to practice, even as negotiations for his potential contract extension remain ongoing, is a positive sign for the Patriots. His teammates have praised him for his conduct amid the uncertainty regarding his future.

“I think he’s honestly handling it as best as I can imagine anyone in his situation is handling it,” said safety Kevin Byard, who is Gonzalez’s locker neighbor. “He’s still having regular conversations in the locker room. Obviously, he spent a lot of time in the training room, trying to get back healthy. But, honestly, I’ve been seeing him be his normal self. We all know Gonzalez’s not the biggest talker.”

Gonzalez is set to carry a salary-cap hit of \$4.8 million in 2026, and \$18.1 million in 2027. The five highest-paid cornerbacks are making at least \$30 million per year.

Executive vice president of player personnel Eliot Wolf is scheduled to speak to the media Tuesday. Wolf said during the television broadcast of Saturday night’s preseason game that the organization is going to “continue working with [Gonzalez’s] representation to try to get something done.”

Asked if he has any concern about Gonzalez’s availability for Week 1, coach Mike Vrabel would not share a definitive answer.

“I’m going to focus on today,” Vrabel said. “I’m not ready to talk about Week 1.”

2. The Patriots brought in a new punter, Matt Haack, because Bryce Baringer is dealing with an injury he suf-

PATRIOTS CAMP, Page C2

Pro football

Maye, Morton share one special connection

Fathers of the Patriots quarterbacks were once training camp teammates in Tampa

By Christopher Price
GLOBE STAFF
FOXBOROUGH — Thirty-eight years ago, a story of football and family — specifically, the Mortons and Mayes — began.

“Sports is a small world,” Mark Maye said with a chuckle. “It’s amazing how a lot of things circle back.”
In the summer of 1988, Maye, who had just completed his college career at North Carolina, found himself as a backup quarterback in training camp with the Buccaneers. One of his teammates? James Morton, a fullback out of West Texas State.
Neither would make an imprint on the Tampa Bay roster. But now, 38 years later, their sons are teammates with the Patriots — with Drake Maye as the NFL MVP runner-up starting quarterback, and Behren Morton as the No. 3 signal-caller on the depth chart.
And the two families — who first made a connection in 1988, and again in 2020 during the college recruiting process — are teammates again.
“Two football families who just love

the game,” said Drake Maye. “It’s a small world, isn’t it?”

‘Like-minded guys’
Mark Maye looked to go pro after a college career in which he was a two-year starter who finished with 3,459 passing yards and 20 touchdowns for the Tar Heels. James Morton was a fullback who rushed for 1,201 yards in three seasons at West Texas State. Both went undrafted and signed with Tampa Bay as free agents.
“First rookie camp, we’re all in there together, and I just remember him being a really good guy, who was easy to talk to, and always with a smile on his face,” Mark Maye said of James Morton. “I remember him being really talented. He was quick and could run, he could catch the ball well. But he was just a really easy guy to get along with.”
“We were somewhat like-minded guys trying to make a name for ourselves,” Morton said. “We were both quiet, kind of shy guys who weren’t real outgoing. I remember the quarterback room had Vinny Testaverde, and

then they brought in Joe Ferguson from the Bills, who I saw play when I was like 6 years old when Texas played Arkansas.
“But I remember Mark; I remember having conversations with him. I knew he was a very grounded person with a good head on his shoulders. He was very studious and always on top of the game and what he had to do as a quarterback.”
Morton and Maye didn’t play a snap for that Tampa Bay team, which finished 5-11 and third in the NFC Central behind the Bears and Vikings. Neither father shared much about their careers with their sons. Behren Morton said his father didn’t tell him he was with the Buccaneers until the son found a Buccaneers T-shirt in the closet.
“He doesn’t like to boast about himself. He doesn’t like talking about himself,” said the younger Morton. “I was like, ‘I’m in fifth grade, Dad. Like, I would have loved to know that.’ But you know, it was quick. He was just there for the training camp part of it.”
The two sons ended up becoming highly regarded high school prospects, and they met as Elite 11 finalists in the 2020 recruiting class. That’s when the

fathers reconnected, 32 years after they were teammates.
“I Googled who Drake Maye’s dad was,” said James Morton. “I was sure at that point that was the guy I was with the Buccaneers with. So I went up and said hi to Mark.”
The younger quarterbacks quickly built a bond.
“I really got to know Behren at Elite 11,” said Maye. “You know, he’s a great player, a great dude. I kind of kept up with him here and there a little bit throughout college. I saw him some different places, and then you know he had a great career at Texas Tech, and he stayed home.”
“Then we found out our dads were both in training camp down in Tampa for a year, and that was pretty cool. It’s just a cool story.”

Lessons still resonate
After following in his father’s footsteps to UNC, Maye was selected by the Patriots in the first round of the 2024 NFL Draft, while Morton was a seventh-round pick this year out of Texas Tech. The two families haven’t had a chance to reconnect in New England but are eager for the opportunity.
“I’m really looking forward to see-

ing James again,” said the elder Maye. “That’s a great family. I know Drake was really excited to have Behren as a member of the Patriots. He’s a really good guy.”
Maye and Morton say their father’s guidance — which included a training camp together one hot summer in Tampa — played a sizable role in their development as rookies, and continues to shape their growth, on and off the field.
“Just playing the game growing up and falling in love with it ourselves, and our dads being able to give us a few extra tips and reminders that can help [us] get to where they were at . . . to have the benefit of that, it’s awesome,” Maye said.
“Being a Texas high school football coach for 32 years, he’s seen a lot of football. He’s played a lot of football,” Morton said. “He told me before I came up here, just take it one day at a time, embrace the opportunity, and enjoy the process. That’s what I think of every day.”

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Patriots trade Boutte to the Texans

►BOUTTE
Continued from Page C1
round (No. 187).
As a rookie under Bill Belichick in 2023, Boutte played 55 snaps in Week 1 but failed to get two feet down on a potential winning drive. He then played just 61 snaps over the rest of the season. During the offseason between his first and second seasons, Boutte was arrested on illegal gambling charges. The charges, which stemmed from actions while Boutte was at LSU, were later dropped.
When the Patriots fired Belichick and hired Jerod Mayo, Boutte was not a lock to make the roster in 2024. But he built a strong chemistry working on the second team with rookie quarterback Drake Maye. Boutte not only earned a spot on the team, he played significant snaps (69.5 percent of the offense’s total) and caught 43 passes for 589 yards and three touchdowns.
Last season, after another coaching change, Boutte continued to build off his breakout Year 2. He finished with 33 receptions for 551 yards and six touchdowns, flashing his ability as a deep threat.
In the playoff run to the Super Bowl,



FILE/LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

This summer, Kayshon Boutte seemed open to playing elsewhere.

he had nine grabs for 168 yards and one score — a highlight-reel one-handed grab of a perfect Maye pass for a 32-yard touchdown to ice the 28-16 win over, now ironically, the Texans.
Coach Mike Vrabel and executive vice president of player personnel Eliot Wolf applauded him for his growth and maturity.
“The person I came in when I got drafted in 2023, I’m a whole different person now,” Boutte told the Globe. “I finished three seasons in the NFL. I learned how to be a professional. Grow

as you go on, and it will be a successful career. Just steadily improving every day, not getting back to my old ways.”
Amid the growing trade speculation, the Patriots continued to praise Boutte for his professionalism. Wide receivers coach Todd Downing referred to him as “an example [he] will use for the rest of [his] coaching career.”
The Texans are a sensible landing spot for Boutte, after they lost 2025 second-round pick Jayden Higgins to a torn ACL. Boutte, who has acknowledged his extra motivation in a contract year, should have opportunities for targets behind Nico Collins.
The 23-year-old Reed can provide secondary depth. The Texans drafted him in the sixth round out of Penn State in 2025. Last season, he appeared in seven games, playing 73 snaps on defense and 113 on special teams.
The Patriots have a strong starting safety tandem with Kevin Byard and Craig Woodson. Reed now rounds out the room, with Dell Pettus, Mike Brown, John Saunders, and Peter Manuma.

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KIRK IRWIN/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Todd Monken said he chose Deshaun Watson (above) to start because the QB gave the Browns “the best chance to move the ball and score points.”

NFL NOTEBOOK

Browns pick Watson over Sanders at QB

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Not many thought **Deshaun Watson** had a chance of reclaiming the starting quarterback job with the Browns over the past 22 months.
Since Watson ruptured his right Achilles tendon the first time in a Week 7 game in 2024, owner **Jimmy Haslam** had said during last year’s owners meetings that the Browns “took a big swing and miss” when they sent three first-round picks to Houston for the controversial quarterback in 2022.
After **Shedeur Sanders** had a solid first half in last Saturday’s 31-7 loss to Buffalo, a frustrated Watson said the boos from the crowd were “personal” and showed “disrespect” after he took the field in Cleveland for the first time in 22 months.
Despite the hurdles and a close competition with Sanders, Watson will be the Browns starting quarterback for their Sept. 13 opener at Jacksonville.
Coach **Todd Monken** made the announcement Monday after informing Watson and Sanders.
“I took in the full body of work over the course of the offseason to training camp to the games, the joint practice, and ultimately felt like to start the season on the road, Deshaun gave us the best chance to move the ball and score points. I mean, that’s really what it’s about,” Monken said.
Watson and Sanders will not play in Thursday’s final preseason game against the visiting Patriots.
The decision to start him will not be popular with Browns fans, who have booed Watson repeatedly, and have put a lot of support behind Sanders since he was drafted last year.
Watson has started only 19 games for Cleveland since being acquired from Houston and signing a fully guaranteed \$230 million contract. He is 9-10 with the Browns, with 19 TD passes, 12 interceptions, and an 80.7 passer rating.
In 2022, Watson missed the first 11 games because of a league suspension resulting from his alleged sexual misconduct during massage therapy sessions. He made six starts in 2023 before a season-ending shoulder injury, and started seven in 2024 before the first of two Achilles tendon injuries.
49ers’ York arrested
Jed York, owner of the 49ers, was arrested over the weekend in Ohio and pleaded no contest to misdemeanor

charges of disorderly conduct and possessing criminal tools.
Court records show that York initially was charged with engaging in prostitution, but prosecutors amended that to disorderly conduct. York was charged with possessing criminal tools for using his phone to respond to an undercover online prostitution advertisement, according to prosecutors.
York was arrested Sunday morning at a mobile home community in East Palestine, Ohio, near where he was born and raised in Youngstown. He was released after posting a \$5,000 bond.
He was sentenced to one day in jail for both offenses to be served concurrently and was credited with one day served when he pleaded no contest Monday morning. He also was fined \$1,150.
Records also show that York had his cellphone returned to him and that \$160 that was seized was to be given to the Mahoning Valley Human Trafficking Task Force as part of the plea agreement. York also completed an online course.
Columbiana County Prosecutor **Vito Abruzzino** said most of these prostitution cases typically end in plea agreements.
NFL cuts may go to college
After a stop in the NFL, former Mississippi tight end **Dae’Quan Wright** could be heading to LSU thanks to a court order that is allowing Wright and 15 others an unexpected fifth year of eligibility. Wright’s agent, **Drew Rosenhaus**, told The Associated Press that the tight end had been waived by the Browns and, if he clears waivers, will join **Lane Kiffin’s** roster at No. 11 LSU. Running back **Anthony Hankerson**, who was released by the Seahawks after playing Sunday, could enter the transfer portal after he clears waivers . . . Seahawks coach **Mike Macdonald** said Sunday night that rookie linebacker **Bud Clark** will miss months with a broken right ankle, while offensive lineman **Mason Richman** suffered his own “long-term injury” in the Seahawks’ 19-16 preseason loss at Tennessee . . . Coach **Mike McCarthy** said the Steelers and fourth-year cornerback **Joey Porter Jr.** are at an impasse as the sides try to work out a new deal. Porter is in the final season of the four-year deal he signed after being the Steelers’ first pick of the second round in 2023.

Cornerback Gonzalez returns to practice

►PATRIOTS CAMP
Continued from Page C1
fered during Saturday’s game. The 32-year-old Haack has plenty of NFL experience, playing for nine teams over nine years. He served as the Cardinals’ punter for the final seven weeks of last season, averaging an impressive 51.3 yards per kick. The Patriots also have third-string quarterback Behren Morton available as an emergency punter. Morton, who punted in high school and at his Texas Tech’s Pro Day, filled in for Baringer on Saturday.
3. The Patriots practiced on the lower field, adjacent to the New Balance Athletics Center, for the first time this summer. The surface appeared a bit slick, with several players losing their footing. Running back TreVeyon Henderson left practice early because he slipped while cutting and needed trainers to look at his right ankle/foot.
“I know we were all slipping,” running back Rhamondre Stevenson said. “We need to find our footing down there.”
4. In addition to Haack, there was another new (and also familiar) face at practice: offensive lineman Jack Conley. The Patriots first signed Conley as an undrafted rookie out of Boston College in April 2025. They kept him on the practice squad for a brief period before releasing him last September. At BC, Conley played multiple positions (right tackle and right guard), so he brings versatility and depth to the offensive line room.
Elsewhere on the O-line, Greg Van Roten took some first-team snaps at both guard spots and center. He should step up as the top interior backup with Ben Brown sidelined indefinitely.
5. Edge rusher Harold Landry (physically unable to perform list) still has yet to practice this summer. The same goes for Brenden Schooler (non-football injury list).
Other noteworthy absences Monday included safety Craig Woodson, who got banged up last Thursday, and linebacker Khalil Jacobs, who suffered an injury on a kickoff in the second quarter Saturday.



FILE/LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

Patriots cornerback Christian Gonzalez appeared to be recovered from the injury he suffered at the end of a practice session Aug. 10.

6. Vrabel clarified that his postgame comment regarding the team’s “lack of depth” was not a shot at the front office. The remark, Vrabel said, was intended to stress the importance of using the preseason games to build depth at certain positions, and identify areas where the Patriots could look to add to the roster.
“We’re all on the same page,” Vrabel said. “There is no front office. There is no back office. There is the Patriots. There is me, there is Eliot, there is [vice president of player personnel] Ryan [Cowden], there is [vice president of football operations and strategy John Streicher]. I told you those are the people that we rely on to make decisions.

So, there is no message.”
7. The Patriots have earmarked two of their home games for celebrations this season. The team will celebrate the 25th anniversary of Super Bowl XXXVI on Oct. 11 against the Raiders, and the 10th anniversary of Super Bowl LI on Nov. 8 against the Packers.
Former tight end Rob Gronkowski will be inducted into the Patriots’ Hall of Fame on Saturday, Nov. 7. (Tom Brady is also scheduled to return to Gillette Stadium that weekend as part of the Fox broadcast team.)

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The Boston Globe

POWER PLAY



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2025 FILE/DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

On the final day of the 2025 FM Championship, Miranda Wang took the lead on the 17th hole for her only LPGA win.

Plenty for golf fans at LPGA’s Boston stop

By Cam Kerry
GLOBE STAFF

New England’s lone LPGA Tour event returns for its third go-round.

The FM Championship has established itself as a can’t-miss event on the ladies’ golf circuit. This year, the purse is even higher and the field is the most competitive it’s ever been.

The tournament, held at TPC Boston in Norton, begins Thursday and the final round is Sunday. Golf Channel will provide coverage all four days.

Here’s everything you need to know about Massachusetts’ premier pro golf event.

Tickets

Single-day and weekly passes are available on SeatGeek. Daily tickets for Thursday and Friday begin at \$59, while admission for Saturday and Sunday opens at \$64. Weekly passes go for \$124. Admission is free for children ages 17 and under when accompanied by a ticketed adult. Also, veterans and military personnel receive free admission.

Boston Common Golf will have a mobile golf simulator, where fans can participate in a closest-to-the-pin challenge.

The driving range will host the LPGA lesson zone, where LPGA teaching professionals give free 10-minute lessons. Fans also can put their mini golf skills to the test at the FM resilience challenge course.

The broadcast of the FM Championship will receive a pair of upgrades for the first time. Putt tracing will be available, highlighting the ball’s path to the hole. There also will be technology to track a player’s ideal swing, pinpointing different parts of a golfer’s motion to identify what the world’s best do to get the most out of their ball-striking.

Prize money, perks

The FM Championship has become one of the biggest tournaments on the LPGA calendar outside of the majors.

In the tournament’s first year, a \$3.8 million purse created waves. It was increased to \$4.1 million last year, and now has received another bump to \$4.4 million.

The new purse represents the sixth largest on this year’s LPGA schedule. It trails only the JM Eagle LA Championship (\$4.75 million) as the highest outside of the majors.

Aside from the purse, the FM Championship has separated itself by providing amenities that are far from the norm at a typical tournament. Every player receives a complimentary hotel room, flight vouchers, a car for the week, and Uber gift cards.

It doesn’t stop there.

Laundry service, dinners provided on two nights for athletes and their families, and a hospitality suite with massage chairs are more examples of the tournament’s commitment to going the extra mile.

FM also provides a \$1,000 stipend to golfers who miss the cut.

Golfers to watch

The field for this year’s FM Championship is the strongest it’s ever been. Every golfer in the top 10 of the Rolex world rankings will be in the field.

World No. 1 Nelly Korda has posted four of her 19 career wins this season. Korda, 28, has finished in the top 10 in 10 of the 13 events she’s entered. She captured two majors this year (US Women’s Open, Chevron Championship), and has earned \$6.2

FM Championship

SCHEDULE

Thursday: First round, 7 a.m. (morning wave), 12:15 p.m. (afternoon wave)
Friday: Second round, 7 a.m. (morning wave), 12:15 p.m. (afternoon wave)
Saturday: Third round, 9:10 a.m.
Sunday: Final round, 8:45 a.m.

TV DETAILS

Where: TPC Boston, Norton
How to watch: The Golf Channel will have coverage of all four rounds.

million in winnings this season.

Haeran Ryu, who won the inaugural FM Championship in 2024, is ranked No. 3 and returns this week. Miranda Wang, who narrowly beat No. 2 Jeeno Thitikul to win last year’s tournament by a stroke, will aim to defend her title.

Thitikul has been on fire, winning the most recent tournament she entered, the Standard Portland Classic, at 22 under for her third win of the season. The Thai star has placed in the top 10 of the last four events she’s played, and ranks second in greens in regulation on tour.

Lottie Woad, No. 5 in the rankings, is now sponsored by FM and will command plenty of attention. The 22-year-old Brit, who won the Kroger Queen City Championship earlier this season, has made 14 cuts in 17 appearances.

Two athletes that call Massachusetts home will be in the field. Rockland’s Megan Khang, a 28-year-old who joined the LPGA Tour in 2016, will certainly draw a crowd throughout the week. Westborough’s Alexa Pano, a 22-year-old who has been on tour since 2023, has advanced to the weekend in nine of 15 events she’s started this season.

The 2025 event

Wang enjoyed the highlight of her career in Norton. Prior to last year’s tournament, the then-rookie had never held a lead in her career. Suddenly, she was holding the trophy high and showered in champagne.

It was a great duel between Wang and Thitikul, who distanced themselves from the field yet were interlocked with one another Sunday afternoon.

Wang took the lead on the par-4 17th hole, calmly hitting a short birdie putt after sticking a 9-iron close. Thitikul’s lead unraveled on the same hole, as she came away with a bogey. Both Wang and Thitikul reached the par-5 18th hole in regulation and two-putted for par, sealing Wang’s only career win.

About TPC Boston

TPC Boston, an iconic New England course, was designed by Arnold Palmer in 2002 and modified by Gil Hanse and Jim Wagner in 2007. The nearly 4,000-acre course features natural terrain, woodlands, and wetlands. Despite being a par-71, 7,297-yard test for the men on the PGA Tour, the course will be set as a 6,598-yard, par-72 for the FM Championship.

Prior to hosting the FM Championship, TPC Boston hosted The Northern Trust (now named the FedEx St. Jude Championship) in 2020 and 2022. It also hosted the Dell Technologies Championship (previously the Deutsche Bank Championship) from 2003-18.

FM announced that TPC Boston will host the tournament again the next two years.

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RED SOX NOTEBOOK

Whitlock to throw Wednesday

By Peter Abraham
GLOBE STAFF

MIAMI — The Red Sox should get one of their best relief pitchers back just in time to face the Yankees this weekend.

Righthander **Garrett Whitlock**, who has been on the injured list since Aug. 10 with elbow inflammation, traveled here with the team and is set to face hitters at loanDepot Park on Wednesday afternoon.

“We’ll see how that goes and if we’re able to activate him,” interim manager **Chad Tracy** said Monday before a 4-2 victory against the Marlins. “Obviously getting on the field and facing some hitters, even if it’s not a [minor league] rehab game, is important.”

Whitlock, who has a 2.05 ERA in 45 games, has been in a throwing program for more than a week and felt fine. But all sides felt it would be best for him to get a tuneup before returning to the roster.

“This is what I expected, to take care of what was going on and come back as soon as I could,” Whitlock said.

Whitlock has a 1.67 ERA in 24 appearances against the Yankees.

Righthander **Justin Slaten**, who also is dealing with elbow inflammation, stayed back in Boston and is increasing the intensity of his throwing, according to Tracy.

Slaten has been on the IL since Aug. 13.

Three to rehab with WooSox

Roman Anthony, **Isiah-Kiner Falefa**, and **Trevor Story** are set to play for Triple-A Worcester at Polar Park on Tuesday against Scranton/Wilkes-Barre.

Anthony was 3 for 11 with two extra-base hits, two walks, and four strikeouts for Double-A Portland last week. He has not played in a major league game since May 4 because of a sprained right wrist.

Story is 2 for 21 with five strikeouts, no walks, and no extra-base hits in six games for the WooSox. He is recovering from sports hernia surgery done in May.

Kiner-Falefa is 1 for 13 in four games for Worcester with two walks and four strikeouts. He has not played for the Red Sox since June 18 because of a bone bruise



LYNNE SLADKY/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Since being recalled on Aug. 16, Mickey Gasper (right) is 8 for 19 (.421) with 10 RBIs. He was 2 for 2 and walked twice in the Red Sox’ series-opening 4-2 victory.

on his left forearm.

Tracy characterized Story as being the closest to a return, with Anthony expected to play at least two more minor league games and Kiner-Falefa more than that.

Tracy said the Sox are less interested in statistics from the rehab assignments and more in how the players are physically as they return from long layoffs.

“It’s more about game load,” he said. “Accumulation on the legs, back-to-back [nine-inning games] and getting tested for whatever the specific injury is.”

For Story, it’s how he moves laterally and runs the bases. For Anthony and Kiner-Falefa, the focus is on how they feel after swinging the bat.

“You’re trying to build enough to where you see them get through stretches of games and come out of it healthy. That’s the most important thing,” Tracy said.

Looking ahead

Payton Tolle, who is scheduled to pitch Tuesday, is 3-0 with a 2.37 ERA last five



CARMEN MANDATO/GETTY IMAGES

Anthony Seigler takes off after ripping a triple that scored the go-ahead run in the ninth.

Seigler delivers in the clutch

► **RED SOX**
Continued from Page C1

combined 2 for 27 with runners in scoring position.

“He’s a ball-in-play hitter,” Tracy said. “You feel pretty good about it if you get him up in spots with people on.”

Aroldis Chapman worked around a leadoff single to record his 30th save, something he has now done 10 times.

But the critical relief work came in the eighth inning.

In a 2-2 game, Erik Miller allowed a one-out single by Leo Jiménez that Jarren Duran bobbled to allow the runner to take second base. Otto Lopez’s infield single moved Jiménez to third.

Heriberto Hernández chopped a ball back to Miller, who snagged it over his head and fired to the plate. Adley Rutschman chased down Jiménez for the second out, then Miller struck out Kyle Stowers.

Miller came off the mound shouting. The lefthander has not allowed an earned run over 9½ innings since being acquired from the Giants.

“There was a lot of execution late in the game that helped us win that game,” Tracy said.

Ranger Suarez came into

the game 7-2 with a 3.07 ERA in 22 career appearances against the Marlins. That included a seven-inning, one-run performance for the Phillies at loanDepot Park last season.

Monday was much more of a slog for the lefthander, even though he allowed only one run over five innings. Suarez allowed four hits, walked four and hit two, throwing only 57 of 93 pitches for strikes.

Suarez consistently fell behind the Miami hitters and was ineffective even when he got ahead. Seven Marlins hitters faced 0-and-2 counts against Suarez and five reached safely.

But Miami was 0 for 9 with runners in scoring position against him.

“Thankfully today I was able to throw five. It wasn’t my day,” Suarez said via a translator. “I was able to throw strikes.”

The Marlins stranded four runners in scoring position against Suarez, whose next start is expected to be against the Yankees this weekend.

The Red Sox were equally inept with their scoring chances against Marlins starter Sandy Alcantara.

The righthander allowed

six hits and two walks over seven innings, but the Sox were hitless in eight at-bats with runners in scoring position.

Mickey Gasper had an RBI double in the fifth inning as Caleb Durbin raced around from first base. But Gasper never advanced as Alcantara retired Seigler and Sogard on fly balls.

Brayan Bello worked two innings in relief of Suarez, allowing a run in the seventh but leaving the bases loaded. It would have been worse had first baseman Willson Contreras not knocked down a line drive off the bat of Jakob Marsee and got a force at the plate as Rutschman stretched to take the throw.

Wilyer Abreu doubled to right field and advanced to third on a fly ball to center field by Rutschman. He then scored on a wild pitch by rookie righthander Josh Ekness.

“Huge win,” said Gasper, who was 2 for 2 with two walks and an RBI. He is 8 for 19 with 10 RBIs in six games since being recalled from Triple-A.

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AL wild card

	W	L	Pct.	GB
New York	74	56	.569	—
Boston	72	59	.550	—
Houston	65	66	.496	—
*Cleveland	65	66	.496	—
Toronto	64	68	.485	1½
*Minnesota	63	68	.481	2
Baltimore	63	68	.481	2
*Seattle	62	68	.478	3
Detroit	61	70	.463	4
Kansas City	58	74	.439	7½
*Los Angeles	52	79	.397	13
*Athletics	51	80	.389	14

* — Not including late game

Red Sox 4, Marlins 2

At loanDepot park, Miami												
BOSTON	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.					
Sogard ss	5	0	1	1	0	2	.283					
Rafaela cf	5	0	1	0	0	1	.289					
Abreu rf	4	1	1	0	1	2	.256					
Contreras 1b	4	0	0	0	0	0	.280					
Rutschman c	5	0	0	0	0	1	.236					
Durbin 3b	4	0	1	0	0	0	.255					
Duran lf	4	2	2	0	0	1	.229					
Gasper dh	2	0	2	1	2	0	.270					
a-ElWhite pr-dh	0	1	0	0	0	0	.250					
Seigler 2b	3	1	1	1	1	0	.254					
Totals	36	4	9	3	4	7						
MIAMI	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.					
Lopez ss	4	1	2	1	0	0	.307					
Hernández lf	4	0	2	0	0	1	.222					
Stowers 1b	4	0	1	0	1	2	.242					
Ramírez dh	2	0	0	0	1	1	.237					
b-Caissie ph-dh	1	0	1	0	1	0	.228					
Edwards 2b	5	0	1	0	1	1	.284					
Marsee cf	3	1	0	0	1	1	.210					
Sanoja 3b	4	0	0	0	1	0	.276					
Ruiz rf	1	0	0	0	0	0	.242					
c-Conine ph-rf	2	0	0	0	0	0	.261					
Mack lf	3	0	1	0	0	1	.458					
d-Jiménez ph	1	0	1	0	0	0	.211					
Navarreto c	0	0	0	0	0	0	.129					
Totals	34	2	9	2	6	7						

Boston.....000 010 012 — 4 9 1
Miami.....000 000 100 — 2 9 0
a-run for Gasper in 9th, b-walked for A.Ramirez in 7th, c-grounded out for Ruiz in 6th, d-singled for Mack in 8th. E—Duran (2). **LOB**—Boston 10, Miami 14. 2B—Abreu (28), Duran (14), Gasper (8). Lopez (30), Stowers (22). 3B—Seigler (1). **SF**—Lopez. **Runners left in scoring position**—Boston 9 (Sogard, Rafaela 4, Rutschman 3, Duran), Miami 8 (Hernández, Stowers, Edwards, Marsee, Sanoja 4). **RISP**—Boston 1 for 14, Miami 2 for 18. **Runners moved up**—Rafaela, Contreras 2, Rutschman, Seigler, Edwards. **GDP**—Lopez. **DP**—Boston 1 (Suarez, Sogard, Contreras).

Boston **IP** **H** **R** **ER** **BB** **SO** **NP** **ERA**
Suarez 5 4 1 1 4 4 93 3.35
Bello 2 2 0 0 0 0 16 1.69
Miller W 1-0 1 2 0 0 0 1 16 0.00
Chapman S 30 1 1 0 0 0 1 18 1.81

Miami **IP** **H** **R** **ER** **BB** **SO** **NP** **ERA**
Alcantara 7 6 1 1 2 6 102 3.38
Ekness BS 2 1 1 1 0 1 16 1.69
Fairbanks L 4-5 ½ 2 1 1 0 0 12 3.62
Gibson ½ 0 0 0 1 0 15 5.30

Fairbanks pitched to 1 batter in the 9th. **Inherited runners scored**—Zuber 1-1, Gibson 1-0. **HBP**—by Suarez (Marsee, Ruiz), by Ekness (Contreras). **WP**—Ekness. **Umpires**—Home, Ron Kulpa; First, David Rackley; Second, Manny Gonzalez; Third, Tom Hanahan. T—3:05. A—16,247 (37,446).

HOW THE RUNS SCORED

SECOND INNING

MARLINS — Marsee was hit by a pitch. Sanoja walked on a full count. Marsee to second. Ruiz was hit by a pitch, Marsee to third, Sanoja to second. Mack struck out. Lopez hit a sacrifice fly to center fielder Rafaela. Marsee scored. H.Hernández flied out to center fielder Rafaela.

FIFTH INNING

RED SOX — Durbin singled to left. Duran grounded into fielder’s choice, second baseman Edwards to shortstop Lopez. Durbin out. Gasper doubled to center, Duran scored. Seigler flied out to left fielder H.Hernández. Sogard flied out to center fielder Marsee.

NINTH INNING

MARLINS — Lopez doubled to left. H.Hernández walked on four pitches. Stowers struck out. Caissie pinch-hitting for A.Ramirez. Caissie walked on a full count. Lopez to third, H.Hernández to second. Edwards singled to right. Seigler scored. H.Hernández to third, Caissie to second. Marsee grounded into fielder’s choice, first baseman Contreras to catcher Rutschman, H.Hernández to second. Edwards singled to right. Sanoja grounded out, shortstop Sogard to first baseman Contreras.

EIGHTH INNING

RED SOX — Caissie in as designated hitter. Ekness pitching. Abreu doubled to right. Contreras was hit by a pitch. Rutschman flied out to center fielder Marsee, Abreu to third. On Ekness’ wild pitch, Abreu scored. Contreras to second. Durbin flied out to right fielder Conine. Duran struck out.

RED SOX — Navarreto in as catcher. Fairbanks pitching. Gasper walked. White pinch-running for Gasper. Zubler pitching. Seigler tripled to right. White scored. Sogard singled to right. Seigler scored. Rafaela grounded out, second baseman Edwards to first baseman Stowers. Sogard to second. Gibson pitching. Abreu walked on a full count. Contreras grounded out, second baseman Edwards to first baseman Stowers. Sogard to third, Abreu to second. Rutschman grounded out, shortstop Lopez to first baseman Stowers.

Baseball

AL

EAST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Tampa Bay	78	53	.595	—	—	4-6	W 2
New York	74	56	.569	3½	—	6-4	W 1
Boston	72	59	.550	6	—	7-3	W 4
Toronto	64	68	.485	14½	1½	5-5	L 1
Baltimore	63	68	.481	15	2	5-5	L 1
CENTRAL	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Chicago	68	63	.519	—	—	5-5	L 1
*Cleveland	65	66	.496	3	—	6-4	W 4
*Minnesota	63	68	.481	5	2	4-6	L 3
Detroit	61	70	.466	7	4	1-9	L 6
Kansas City	58	74	.439	10½	7½	9-1	W 8
WEST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Texas	66	66	.500	—	—	6-4	W 2
Houston	65	66	.496	½	—	4-6	L 2
*Seattle	62	69	.473	3½	3	6-4	L 1
*Los Angeles	52	79	.397	13½	13	5-5	L 1
*Athletics	51	80	.389	14½	14	4-6	W 2

NL

EAST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Atlanta	76	55	.580	—	—	3-7	W 1
*Philadelphia	73	58	.557	3	—	9-1	W 9
Miami	67	65	.508	9½	4½	5-5	L 1
Washington	62	71	.466	15	10	2-8	W 1
New York	59	72	.450	17	12	6-4	L 1
CENTRAL	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Milwaukee	81	50	.618	—	—	7-3	L 1
*Chicago	75	56	.573	6	—	4-6	W 1
St. Louis	66	66	.500	15½	5½	5-5	L 3
*Pittsburgh	63	69	.477	18½	8½	5-5	L 3
*Cincinnati	62	69	.473	19	9	3-7	L 1
WEST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Los Angeles	80	51	.611	—	—	7-3	W 6
*San Diego	71	60	.542	9	—	7-3	W 3
*Arizona	69	62	.527	11	2	5-5	W 1
*San Francisco	52	78	.400	27½	18½	2-8	L 4
Colorado	50	81	.382	30	21	2-8	L 7

* — Not including late game

RESULTS									
MONDAY									
Boston 4	at Miami 2	Chi. Cubs	at Arizona						
Tampa Bay 4	at Detroit 1	Minnesota	at Athletics						
At Washington 13	Colorado 3	Philadelphia	at Seattle						
Texas 11	at Chi. White Sox 2	Pittsburgh	at San Diego						
Cleveland	at LA Angels	Cincinnati	at San Francisco						

SUNDAY									
At Boston 5	San Francisco 4	At Texas 5	LA Angels 3						
At Philadelphia 6	St. Louis 4	Cleveland 7	at Colorado 2						
Tampa Bay 3	at Baltimore 1	Chi. Cubs 19	at Seattle 2						
At NY Yankees 8	Toronto 3	At San Diego 8	Minnesota 1						
At Miami 6	Washington 2	At LA Dodgers 4	Pittsburgh 0						
Athletics 7	at Houston 6	At Arizona 5	Cincinnati 3						
At Kansas City 11	Detroit 7	Atlanta 4	at Milwaukee 2						
At Chi. White Sox 2	NY Mets 1								

TUESDAY'S GAMES									
.....2026..... Team2026 vs. opp..... Last 3 starts.....									
Odds	W-L	ERA	rec.	W-L	IP	ERA	W-L	IP	ERA
BOSTON AT MIAMI, 6:40 p.m.									
Tolle (L)	-160	8-6	3.08	11-10	0-0	0.0	0.00	2-0	19.0
TBA	+135	—	—	0-0	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-0	0.0
TAMPA BAY AT DETROIT, 6:40 p.m.									
Seymour (L)	-135	9-4	4.17	6-5	0-0	2.0	13.50	1-1	17.0
Jobe (R)	+115	1-1	4.50	1-2	0-0	0.0	0.00	1-1	14.0

COLORADO AT WASHINGTON, 6:45 p.m.									
Freeland (L)	+130	4-10	6.37	9-14	0-1	6.0	6.00	1-0	16.0
Alvarez (L)	-150	2-5	3.60	4-7	0-0	4.1	6.23	0-2	16.0
HOUSTON AT NY YANKEES, 7:05 p.m.									
Pecko (R)	+125	0-0	4.91	1-0	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-0	3.2
Warren (R)	-145	8-6	4.43	16-8	1-0	6.0	3.00	0-1	13.1

KANSAS CITY AT TORONTO, 7:07 p.m.									
Lugo (R)	+110	5-7	4.71	13-13	0-0	0.0	0.00	1-0	16.2
Scherzer (R)	-130	1-6	7.40	3-8	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-2	14.1
MILWAUKEE AT NY METS, 7:10 p.m.									
Harrison (L)	-165	10-3	2.84	14-6	0-0	0.0	0.00	2-1	14.2
Thornton (L)	+140	3-4	3.04	3-6	1-0	6.0	0.00	1-2	16.0

LA DODGERS AT ATLANTA, 7:15 p.m.									
Glasnow (R)	-160	3-0	2.72	6-1	0-0	0.0	0.00	1-0	14.2
Elder (R)	+135	8-7	3.92	14-10	1-0	5.2	0.00	1-1	18.0
TEXAS AT CHI. WHITE SOX, 7:40 p.m.									
deGrom (R)	-115	9-8	3.77	13-11	0-1	4.2	9.64	2-1	13.0
Kay (L)	-105	9-6	3.96	14-10	1-0	5.0	3.60	1-1	17.1

BALTIMORE AT ST. LOUIS, 7:45 p.m.									
Bassitt (R)	+105	4-4	5.08	6-6	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-1	14.0
Liberatore (L)	-125	5-11	5.04	13-12	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-3	16.1
CLEVELAND AT LA ANGELS, 9:38 p.m.									
Williams (R)	-140	12-7	3.72	15-11	0-0	0.0	0.00	1-1	15.2
Ureña (R)	+120	8-9	2.80	10-11	0-1	5.0	3.60	1-2	13.1

CHI. CUBS AT ARIZONA, 9:40 p.m.									
Holmes (R)	-110	5-6	2.49	6-6	0-1	5.2	3.18	1-2	16.0
Praadt (R)	-110	7-1	3.39	11-2	0-0	2.1	7.71	1-0	19.2
MINNESOTA AT ATHLETICS, 9:40 p.m.									
Bradley (R)	-150	9-5	3.90	15-10	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-1	14.0
Jump (L)	+130	5-8	4.83	7-9	0-0	0.0	0.00	1-1	15.1

PHILADELPHIA AT SEATTLE, 9:40 p.m.									
Nola (R)	+100	5-9	5.12	12-14	0-0	0.0	0.00	2-0	17.0
Kirby (R)	-120	8-10	4.18	11-13	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-1	13.0
PITTSBURGH AT SAN DIEGO, 9:40 p.m.									
Skenes (R)	-105	9-11	3.95	10-16	1-0	6.1	1.42	0-2	14.1
King (R)	-115	8-9	3.38	11-15	1-0	6.0	3.00	2-1	18.2

CINCINNATI AT SAN FRANCISCO, 9:45 p.m.									
Singer (R)	-105	9-11	4.72	9-16	1-0	6.0	1.50	0-1	18.0
Roupp (R)	-115	7-13	4.34	7-18	1-0	6.0	0.00	0-3	16.1

Team rec. — Record in games started by pitcher this season



GREGORY SHAMUS/GETTY IMAGES

Javier Báez tries to execute a first-inning double play around the slide of the Rays' Jonny DeLuca in the Tigers' 4-1 home loss Monday.

NOTEBOOK

Astros' Brown to step down as GM

ASSOCIATED PRESS

General manager **Dana Brown** and the Astros have mutually agreed to part ways, the team announced Monday, while it was tied for first place in the AL West.

Brown's contract was set to expire at the end of the season. Senior adviser **Jeff Bagwell** and assistant general managers **Charles Cook**, **Gavin Dick-ey**, and **Connor Huff** will take over Brown's responsibilities, while team owner **Jim Crane** will oversee baseball operations during the transition.

The move comes after the Astros went 3-6 on a homestand that ended Sunday to fall into a tie with the Rangers for the AL West lead.

Brown had been the team's general manager since January 2023.

Brown came to Houston after four seasons as vice president of scouting for the Braves to replace **James Click**, who was not given a new contract and left the Astros just days after they won the 2022 World Series.

Rays down Tigers

Jonathan Aranda homered and **Drew Rasmussen** gave up three hits in six strong innings as the visiting Rays beat the slumping Tigers, 4-1.

Tampa Bay had lost seven of its last 10, but never trailed against the Tigers, who have lost six straight and nine of 10 to fall behind in the race for the final AL wild card.

Rasmussen (14-5) allowed one run to win his seventh straight start. It is the second-longest streak in franchise history, trailing only **Blake Snell's** nine-start streak in 2018.

Rangers regain lead

Corey Seager had three hits and three RBIs, and **Jake Burger** and **Wy-att Langford** homered to lead the Rangers to an 11-2 victory over the host White Sox.

Ezequiel Duran drove in two runs and Texas outhit the AL Central lead-ers, 14-5, to move a half-game ahead

of idle Houston and take sole possession of first place in the AL West for the first time since July 30.

Kumar Rocker (5-10) pitched 5½ innings for the win, allowing two runs on five hits with eight strikeouts and three walks.

Rockies' skid at seven

CJ Abrams had the go-ahead RBI in a five-run fifth inning and **Cade Cavalli** won his fourth consecutive start as the host Nationals defeated Colorado, 13-3, to send the Rockies to their seventh consecutive loss.

Daylen Life homered and drove in five runs for the Nationals, who had dropped three games in a row and seven of eight.

Abrams, who missed the previous four games with a sprained ankle, went 1 for 4 with two stolen bases as Washington's designated hitter.

Cavalli (12-5) struck out seven and allowed two runs in six innings. He is 7-1 with a 1.98 ERA in eight outings since the All-Star break and has started Washington's last three victories.

Surgery for SS Emerson

Mariners rookie shortstop **Colt Emerson** will have season-ending surgery Wednesday to repair a partially dislocated tendon in his left wrist and is expected to be ready for the start of next season, general manager **Justin Hollander** said. Emerson, 21, who has been bothered by the injury since before spring training, signed a \$95 million, eight-year contract April 1 — the biggest commitment at the time for a player who had yet to appear in the big leagues . . . Reds utilityman **Michael Toglia** will undergo season-end-ing surgery Tuesday on his right shoulder after he was injured Friday making a diving catch against Arizona . . . The Diamondbacks hope three-time All-Star **Ketel Marte** will return to their lineup Aug. 31, roughly two weeks after his unexpected disappearance before a game in Boston.

RAYS 4, TIGERS 1									
TAMPA BAY	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO		Avg.	
Yabiaz dh	4	1	1	0	1	0		.305	
Vilade rf	3	1	1	0	0	0		.264	
Mullins ph-cf	1	0	0	0	0	0		.205	
Camrnero 3b	3	0	1	1	1	1		.277	
DeLuca cf-rf	4	0	2	0	0	0		.271	
Aranda 1b	4	1	1	2	0	0		.280	
Mateo 2b	2	1	1	0	2	0		.200	
Fortes c	3	0	0	0	0	0		.263	
Simpson lf	4	0	2	1	0	0		.312	
Walls ss	4	0	0	0	0	2		.215	
Totals	32	4	9	4	4	3			

DETROIT	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO		Avg.	
Keith dh	3	0	0	0	1	2		.266	
Lee 2b	4	0	0	0	0	2		.276	
McGonigle 3b	4	1	1	0	0	0		.283	
Dingler c	3	0	1	0	0	1		.253	
Callahan lf	1	0	0	1	0	0		.263	
Malgeri ph-ph	2	0	1	0	0	1		.242	
McKintory rf	4	0	0	0	0	1		.221	
Torkelson 1b	4	0	1	0	0	2		.221	
Clark cf	3	0	0	0	0	1		.244	
Báez ss	3	0	1	0	0	2		.260	
Totals	31	1	5	1	1	12			

Tampa Bay	IP	H	R	E	BB	SO	ERA
Rasmussen W 14-5	6	3	1	1	0	5	2.95
Cleavinger	1	0	0	0	0	2	3.63
Rodriguez	1	0	0	0	1	3	0.00
Baker S 3-8	1	1	0	0	0	2	1.56
Detroit	IP	H	R	E	BB	SO	ERA
Valdez L 8-9	6	8	4	3	2	0	4.35
Rainey	1	0	0	0	2	2	0.00
Holtom	1	1	0	0	0	1	3.12
HPB — by Baker (Dingler). NP — Rasmussen 103.							
Cleavinger L 14, Rodriguez 23, Baker 16, Valdez 84,							
Rainey 31, Holtom 15. Umpires — Home, Quinn Wolcott;							
First, Paul Clemons; Second, Adrian Johnson; Third,							
Dexter Kelley. T-2:36. A-23,265 (40,988).							

HR — Langford (15), off Richards, Bürger (22), off Schweitzer, Peters (10), off Richards. CS — Duran (3).							
Text	IP	H	R	E	BB	SO	ERA
Rock W 5-10	5	5	2	2	3	8	4.41
Althstrom	1½	0	0	0	0	1	4.75
Montgomery	2	0	0	0	0	2	6.30
Chi. White Sox	IP	H	R	E	BB	SO	ERA
Urquidy L 2-1	3	6	5	5	4	2	5.68
Schweitzer	2	3	2	2	0	2	3.64
Rababzon	1	1	1	1	2	0	6.30
Richards	2½	3	3	2	2	3	3.77
Althstrom	4	0	0	0	0	3	6.30
Inherited runners scored — Althstrom 1, IBB — off Richards (Seager). HPB — by Urquidy (Diaz, Nimmo).							
WP — Richards 2. NP — Rocker 93, Althstrom 16,							
Montgomery 23, Urquidy 93, Schweitzer 36, Bra-							

HIGH SCHOOL FOOTBALL

Teams return to gridiron

New MIAA season kicks off with Day 1 of practices across the state

By **Brendan Kurie**
GLOBE STAFF
and **Nate Weitzer**
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Just over two hours into practice, Mikyle Hart snapped off his chin guard, peeled off his helmet, and let loose with a scream: “Football! We’re back baby!”

It was a little after 9:30 a.m. Monday under a burgeoning sun on Fairhaven’s Alumni Field. The Blue Devils, coming off three straight Super Bowl appearances, were caked in sweat as they wrapped up the first day of their Division 6 title defense.

“I might have gotten a couple of hours [of sleep last night],” seventh-year coach Derek Almeida said. “Then I was up thinking about practice and how to get this team ready for this year.”

Senior running back/safety Liam Pickup was in the same boat.

“I had those butterflies in my stomach last night,” he said. “I was waking up in the middle of the night. I was tossing and turning.”

For Almeida — who has a 55-13 record at his alma mater, leading Fairhaven to Super Bowl wins in 2023 and ’25 — the first day is all about the feet. By watching his players’ cleats, he can tell who has been keeping up with their conditioning over the summer.

“Speed, speed!” Almeida bellowed as the offense, which returns just one starter, ran through blocking schemes and worked on toss sweeps. “Everything’s fast. We have to be quicker!”

The Blue Devils have plenty of work to do to get back to the Super Bowl, having graduated their top four ball carriers, entire offensive line, quarterback, and top receiver from last year’s championship squad, which defeated Norwell in the Division 6 Super Bowl and averaged 40.8 points per game.

“I’m pumped for the season,” said senior running back Aiden Donnelly. “We have a lot to prove. I think we’re better than people think. A lot of us are going to step up. We’re going to put in the work and prove people wrong.”

Three decades and counting

Coach Brian Aylward opened his 30th season at Tewksbury by focusing on the basics — demonstrating to players how to slide their feet and stay in position to tackle.

Despite low enrollment for a Division 4 program, Tewksbury has almost always been in contention under Aylward, and went undefeated en route to the Merrimack Valley Conference’s Division 2 title last fall.

The Redmen graduated nine starters on both sides of the ball, but return star quarterback Will Harrison, and have the same expectations as always (they also won the Northeast Regional 7v7 title this summer). On Monday, Aylward and his staff kept a keen eye for improved agility and strength among the candidates to take those starting spots.

“We’re a small school, so we need those guys to work,” said Aylward, who surpassed 200 career wins last season. “If you want a bigger role, [the weight room at Doucette Field] is where you make it happen.”

A couple days after dropping a 42-41 thriller to Scituate in the Division 4 Super Bowl, Tewksbury’s weight room

was filled with returning players. Those incumbents worked hard through drills Monday afternoon, while Aylward and his experienced coaches critiqued their technique.

With 748 students, Tewksbury football opts up from D5 to D4 (the boys’ hockey and softball programs also opt up).

The Redmen are looking for a challenge, beginning with a Week 1 opener at Foxborough.

“We’re trying to coach them all up to have a chip on their shoulder,” said Aylward. “It’s built into the way we work and into the way we practice.”

New era in City of Champions

At Brockton, where the Boxers are searching for their first playoff win in seven years, you won’t find the freshmen practicing on a side field.

In an effort to build cohesiveness across the program, first-year coach Mike Norman Jr. is having all four classes practice together.

Everyone was on a side field Monday as work is completed on the new turf at Marciano Stadium. That included third-year starting quarterback Marcio Semedo, who is playing for his third coach in four varsity seasons.

“I’m ready to get after it,” said Semedo, who led the Boxers to playoff appearances the last two years. “I feel great. These guys have been putting in work all day, every day. We have great chemistry.”

Just an hour into orchestrating his first varsity practice, Norman, a former Boxers quarterback and 2019 graduate, wasn’t shy about what he was seeing.

“We’ve got a ton of talent,” he said. “We always have; we always will. It’s just putting the pieces together and making sure when we roll out there we’re a good football team.”

Shamrocks excitement

At Bishop Feehan’s McGrath Field in Attleboro, more than 100 hopefuls showed up on Day 1. The Shamrocks are coming off their first Super Bowl appearance under eighth-year coach Bryan Pinabell.

Has he detected a new level of excitement?

“I think it helps,” Pinabell said, “but I don’t look too much into it. I’d like to get there and win it. It certainly gives the kids confidence, but it also puts a target on their back.”

The Shamrocks are replacing 27 seniors, including three starting offensive linemen, while junior Ty Cinelli and sophomore Bradyn Hogan are locked in a battle for the starting QB spot.

Bishop Feehan, which is playing an independent schedule for the second straight year, brings back senior Xavier Baker, who finished with more than 1,000 combined rushing and receiving yards last year, as well as linebacker Dylan Crossman (108 tackles).

“We’re a young group,” Crossman said. “I think it’s going to take a lot of patience but it’s the same goal: Get back to Gillette.”

Familiar name, but in a new place

After wrapping up his first practice as coach at Central Catholic, John Dubzinski reminded his players that there is no wasted time.

“This is Day 1,” Dubzinski said un-

der the morning sun in Lawrence, “All of this matters. When we get into our first game and we reference the things we’ve worked on since Day 1, this is what we’re talking about.”

The Raiders ran scout team, broke into skill groups, and finished Monday’s session with passing drills out of the spread.

Dubzinski offered film hours afterward for any players that wanted to take more mental reps, something the players and coaches have been working through this offseason via online meetings.

“We want to jam in as much knowledge as possible without it being overwhelming,” said Dubzinski, who coached previously at Arlington (2011-14) and North Andover (2015-25, where he won the 2018 D2 Super Bowl). “Everyone is excited to be out here, but we want to see who is still excited tomorrow, and the day after that.”

New Golden era in Andover?

Later at Andover’s Lovely Field, former Central Catholic star and defensive coordinator Jay Fielding ran his squad through similar drills.

The Golden Warriors offense moved the ball through a “5-yard crawl” drill, and the defense went through defensive coordination with the safeties communicating against run plays.

Then came the conditioning sprints in the hot afternoon sun, before another round of positional drills.

“In today’s world it’s all about keeping things fun, but competing and sprinkling in some tricks to make sure they’re still working hard,” said Fielding, in his second year as Andover coach. “We set the tone today with one of the hardest practices around.”

Jack’s back at it in Foxborough

Day 1 never gets stale for Foxborough coach Jack Martinelli, who is entering his 45th season at the helm and is coming off three straight Super Bowl appearances.

“It’s still the same feeling; the smell of the cut grass,” he said. “Thinking about it is harder as you get older, but once you’re here, it’s like you never left.”

Look for the run-heavy Warriors to throw the ball more this year, with the addition of senior quarterback Brayden Jones, a transfer from Attleboro, and the return of Kameron Rice and the emergence of Chris Campbell at wide receiver.

Martinelli is particularly excited about his two senior kickers — Cam Russo punts and kicks off, and Andrew Higgins was hitting field goals from 52 yards in practice — who are expected to give the Warriors an edge in special teams.

“It’s the best time of year,” said senior running back Jack Taft, who ran for 10 touchdowns last year. “It feels amazing. We’ve been working all offseason and it’s finally here.”

Brendan Kurie reported from Fairhaven, Brockton, Bishop Feehan, and Foxborough. He can be reached at brendan.kurie@globe.com. Nate Weitzer reported from Central Catholic, Tewksbury, and Andover. He can be reached at nweitzer7@gmail.com.

SportsLog

Ex-NBA players ineligible for WNBA Draft

Former NBA players **Enes Kanter** and **Royce White** are not eligible for the WNBA Draft, a person familiar with the decision said Monday. The person spoke to The Associated Press on condition of anonymity because of the sensitive nature of the situation. The person did not elaborate on the reasons for declaring the two men ineligible. Freedom and White have declared their intention to enter next year’s draft, but the WNBA has not publicly addressed their eligibility. The WNBA has been the subject of recent debates on whether transgender women — people assigned male at birth who transition to align with their gender identity — should be allowed to participate in the league. There has never been such a player in the WNBA. Although the league’s collective bargaining agreement says the WNBA is restricted to women, it contains no more specific language about gender identity or sex assigned at birth. When Freedom and White announced their intention to enter the draft, the players said they identified as women. The 6-foot-10-inch, 250-pound Freedom played 11 seasons in the NBA, finishing his career with the Celtics in 2021-22. White played in three NBA games for the Kings in 2014. Freedom was ejected from Sunday night’s Indiana-Chicago WNBA game after he was confronted by

Sky guard **Natasha Cloud** late in the third quarter. Freedom was sitting along the baseline wearing a black shirt that read “WOMAN noun. adult human female.” The Fever called timeout after Cloud scored inside with 1:22 left in the third. Cloud then did a chest bump with teammate **Aicha Coulibaly** before turning around and walking in Freedom’s direction. Cloud started yelling and pointing at Freedom. Freedom held his arms out and took one step on the court as security moved in between the two.

BASEBALL

WPBL board accusations

A member of the Women’s Pro Baseball League’s board of directors is asking a Delaware court to force the fledgling organization to release records she says could reveal misuse of company funds and undisclosed conflicts of interest. The WPBL launched Aug. 1 hoping to become the most successful pro league for women’s baseball since the All-American Girls Professional Baseball League folded in 1954. The demand for books and records, filed in the Delaware Court of Chancery, could impact the league’s ability to bring in partners, sponsors and investors. The legal filing says the league has refused to provide **Mina Kim**, a WPBL investor, with “books and records

reasonably related” to her responsibilities as one of six members of the board.

COLLEGES

Court rules in favor of Luis

RJ Luis Jr., a former St. John’s standout who recently signed with LSU after spending time with two NBA clubs, was cleared by a court to start practicing and potentially play for the Tigers this season. Luis, who briefly was under contract with the Jazz and Celtics but never played in an NBA game, hugged LSU coach **Will Wade** after the ruling by East Baton Rouge Parish District Court Judge **Ronald R. Johnson**. Luis’s attorneys stressed that Luis not only had never played in an NBA game, but also had not played for the Celtics’ G League affiliate because of an injury.

AUTO RACING

Hill gets full-time ride

Austin Hill will drive the No. 33 Chevrolet on a full-time basis in the NASCAR Cup Series for Richard Childress Racing beginning next season, the team announced. Hill has 16 wins over the past five seasons driving RCR’s No. 21 Chevrolet in the NASCAR O’Reilly Auto Parts Series. He has qualified for the Chase in each of those five seasons.

Scoreboard

	TUE 8/25	WED 8/26	THU 8/27	FRI 8/28	SAT 8/29	SUN 8/30	MON 8/31
	MIA 6:40 NESN	MIA 6:40 NESN		NYN 7:15 AppleTV	NYN (2) 1:05, 7:15 NESN, Fox	NYN 1:35 NESN	SEA 6:45 NESN
			CLE (exh.) 8:00 Amazon				
					COLU 7:30 AppleTV		
							AC 8:00 CBCSSN NBCSB

Home games shaded

On the radio: Red Sox, WEEI-FM 93.7; Patriots and Revolution, WBZ-FM 98.5.

ON THE AIR

BASEBALL		
6 p.m.	Triple-A: Scranton/W-B at Worcester	NESN+
6:40 p.m.	Boston at Miami	NESN
7:15 p.m.	LA Dodgers at Atlanta	TBS
9:40 p.m.	Philadelphia at Seattle	MLB
LITTLE LEAGUE BASEBALL WORLD SERIES		
1 p.m.	Mexico vs. Japan	ESPN
3 p.m.	Tacoma, Wash., vs. Phenix City, Ala.	ESPN
5 p.m.	Canada vs. South Korea	ESPN
7 p.m.	Hamilton, Ohio, vs. Bayonne, N.J.	ESPN
PRO BASKETBALL		
7 p.m.	WNBA: Chicago at Connecticut	NBCSB
8 p.m.	WNBA: Portland at Dallas	NBA
CYCLING		
8:30 a.m.	Tour of Spain	NBCSN
TENNIS		
10 a.m.	US Open qualifying	ESPN2
■ For updates, go to bostonglobe.com/tvlistings		

International League

EAST				
	W	L	Pct.	GB
Rochester	31	20	.608	—
Durham	30	20	.600	1½
Scranton/W-B	28	20	.583	1½
Buffalo	27	23	.540	3½
Worcester	27	23	.540	3½
Syracuse	26	24	.520	4½
Lehigh Valley	25	24	.510	5
Charlotte	25	26	.490	6
Jacksonville	21	29	.420	9½
Norfolk	17	31	.354	12½

WEST				
	W	L	Pct.	GB
Indianapolis	31	20	.608	—
St. Paul	30	21	.588	1
Columbus	25	24	.510	5
Nashville	25	25	.500	5½
Omaha	24	25	.490	6
Gwinnett	24	27	.471	7
Toledo	24	27	.471	7
Iowa	22	29	.431	9
Memphis	22	29	.431	9
Louisville	22	29	.431	9

TUESDAY'S GAMES				
Scranton/W-B	at Worcester	6:05		
Columbus	at Indianapolis	6:35		
Memphis	at Charlotte	6:35		
Gwinnett	at Louisville	6:35		
Syracuse	at Lehigh Valley	6:45		
Buffalo	at Rochester	6:45		
Norfolk	at Durham	6:45		
Nashville	at Jacksonville	7:05		
Omaha	at Iowa	7:38		
Toledo	at St. Paul	8:07		

SUNDAY'S RESULTS				
At Syracuse 2		Worcester 0		
At Columbus 8		St. Paul 5		
At Buffalo 10		Lehigh Valley 2		
At Gwinnett 7		Durham 2		
At Scranton/W-B 9		Charlotte 5		
At Indianapolis 6		Louisville 0		
Iowa 4		at Toledo 2		
Jacksonville 6		at Memphis 2		
Nashville 7		at Norfolk 1		
Rochester 9		at Omaha 0		

Eastern League

NORTHEAST				
	W	L	Pct.	GB
Reading	29	21	.580	—
Binghamton	27	24	.529	2½
Wilmington	27	24	.529	2½
Portland	25	26	.490	3
New Hampshire	20	31	.392	6½
Hartford	18	33	.353	11½

SOUTHWEST				
	W	L	Pct.	GB
Erie	35	16	.686	—
Chesapeake	32	16	.667	7½
Richmond	27	23	.540	7½
Harrisburg	25	24	.510	9
Akron	23	26	.469	11
Altoona	21	28	.430	15½

TUESDAY'S GAMES				
Portland	at Richmond	7:05		
Binghamton	at Reading	11A		
Erie	at Altoona	6		
Hartford	at New Hampshire	6:03		
Chesapeake	at Harrisburg	6:30		
Akron	at Somerset	6:35		

SUNDAY'S RESULTS				
Reading 10		at Portland 3		
At Binghamton 7		Altoona 3		
At Akron 8		Harrisburg 4		
At Richmond 6		Chesapeake 5		
Somerset 9		at Hartford 6		
At Erie 6		New Hampshire 3		

South Atlantic League

NORTH				
	W	L	Pct.	GB
Frederick	32	22	.593	—
Greensboro	31	23	.571	1
Hudson Valley	31	23	.571	1
Wilmington	29	25	.537	3
Brooklyn	28	25	.528	3½
Jersey Shore	16	35	.312	14½

SOUTH				
	W	L	Pct.	GB
Bowling Green	29	24	.547	—
Winston-Salem	28	25	.528	1
Greenville	27	24	.529	2½
Asheville	24	29	.453	5
Rome	24	29	.453	5
Hub City	20	34	.370	9½

TUESDAY'S GAMES				
Rome	at Greenville	6:45		
Brooklyn	at Hudson Valley	6:05		
Hub City	at Greensboro	6:30		
Bowl. Green	at Winston-Salem	6:30		
Wilmington	at Jersey Shore	6:35		
Frederick	at Asheville	6:35		

SUNDAY'S RESULTS				
Winston-Salem 12		at Greenville 5		
Hub City 3		at Rome 1		
Hudson Valley 5		at Jersey Shore 4		
Frederick 7		at Wilmington 2		
Brooklyn 12		at Asheville 1		
Greensboro 11		at Bowling Green 5		

Carolina League

NORTH				
	W	L	Pct.	GB
Fayetteville	32	20	.615	—
Wilson	27	24	.529	4½
Salem	27	26	.509	5
Fredericksburg	24	29	.453	8½
Hill City 7		at Charleston 5		
Delmarva	19	35	.352	14

SOUTH				
	W	L	Pct.	GB
Hickory	37	16	.698	—
Kannapolis	31	23	.574	6½
Charleston	30	24	.556	7½
Augusta	29	24	.547	8
Columbia	25	28	.472	12
Myrtle Beach	18	35	.340	19

TUESDAY'S GAMES				
Salem	at Fayetteville	6:35		
Kannapolis	at Hill City	6:30		
Myrtle Beach	at Augusta	6:35		
Hickory	at Wilson	7:05		
Fredericksburg	at Delmarva	7:05		
Charleston	at Columbia	7:05		

SUNDAY'S RESULTS		
Wilson 17.....	at Salem 8	
Kannapolis 17.....	at Fredericksburg 4	
At Hickory 4.....	Delmarva 2	
Fayetteville 6.....	at Myrtle Beach 2	
Augusta 3.....	at Columbia 1	
Hill City 7.....	at Charleston 5	
Fayetteville 6.....	at Myrtle Beach 1	

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Remembered

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BY CITY AND TOWN

ANDOVER ARAM, Sherene Marie	NATICK MAHONEY, Daniel T. Jr.
ATTLEBORO DURSO, Angelo	NEEDHAM DAVIDSON, Myrna Elaine (Weiss)
BOSTON ARAM, Sherene Marie	DURSO, Angelo
BROOKLINE DAVIDSON, Myrna Elaine (Weiss)	NEWTON KOGAN, John N.
CAMBRIDGE ARAM, Sherene Marie MILES, Lorraine M. (Piekos)	NORWOOD DURSO, Angelo
CONCORD ARAM, Sherene Marie	ROXBURY RATTA, Eleanor S. (Figaratto)
DEDHAM DAVIDSON, Myrna Elaine (Weiss)	SCITUATE JONES, Anthony Andrieus
DORCHESTER RATTA, Eleanor S. (Figaratto)	SOMERVILLE KELLY, Suzan
LOWELL KELLY, Suzan	SUDBURY ARAM, Sherene Marie
LYNN LYNCH, Attorney Edward L.	
MEDFORD KELLY, Suzan MILES, Lorraine M. (Piekos)	
MELROSE MAHONEY, Daniel T. Jr.	

ARAM, Sherene Marie



Died at home, surrounded by loved ones, in Concord, Massachusetts, on August 21, after a brief illness. She was born on November 16, 1962, to Mary (Hass) Aram Arakelian and Ali Mohammed Aram. She is survived by her wife of twenty-eight years, Sheila Murphy; their daughter, Samantha Katzen, of Stoughton, Massachusetts; her mother, Mary Arakelian; sister, Lili Aram-Bost (Tom); and niece, Karina Mash, all of Richmond, Virginia; many aunts, uncles, and cousins; and a wide circle of friends who loved her dearly. She was predeceased by her father, Ali Aram. Sherene grew up in Melrose and Andover, Massachusetts. She graduated from Phillips Academy and Wellesley College, and received her MBA from Simmons University. She worked as a university administrator at MIT, retiring in 2018. Sherene was an avid cat lover, geocacher, scuba diver, puzzler and traveler. She volunteered in financial literacy and prison outreach. During retirement, Sherene and Sheila traveled the globe and made a pilgrimage to India with the Cambridge Insight Meditation Center. Sherene loved her community and deeply touched the lives of many. A celebration of life is planned for the fall. In lieu of flowers, gifts may be made in Sherene's memory to Cambridge Insight Meditation Center, Massachusetts Immigration and Refugee Advocacy Council, or Dana Farber Cancer Institute. For complete obituary, please visit www.DeeFuneralHome.com

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DAVIDSON, Myrna Elaine (Weiss)



Age 93, of Dedham, formerly of Needham and Brookline, passed away on August 22, 2026. She was born in Boston to the late Abraham Weiss and Anna (Herman) Weiss. As a young and gifted classical pianist, she won accolades and awards for her outstanding performances. Myrna attended Brookline High School and later studied at Brandeis University. She eventually transferred to Boston University to become an elementary school teacher. She met her future and beloved husband, (the late) Murray H. Davidson, on a blind date and they shared 65 years of love, family and devotion together. Myrna was a leader in the local Jewish community as one of the founders of Temple Aliyah in Needham. She loved Judaism and the Jewish community and she dedicated more than 25 years of her life to teaching Hebrew School. Her hard work, creativity and love for children led to her winning the Keter Torah Award as one of Boston's most outstanding Jewish educators.

Myrna's greatest joy was her family which includes her three sons, Leonard "Lenny" and his wife, Laurie; Paul and his wife, Susan; and Gary. She was also the proud grandmother of Michelle, Ashley, Alex and his wife Stephanie, and Rachel, and loving great-grandmother to Sadie.

A Funeral Service will be held at Temple Aliyah, 1664 Central Avenue, Needham, on Wednesday at 10:00am. Interment will follow immediately at Anshe Sfard Cemetery, 776 Baker Street, West Roxbury.

Please go on the Levine Chapels website for Shiva information. In lieu of flowers, please make donations to Temple Aliyah at <https://templealiyah.shulcloud.com/form/donate-2.html>

Myrna will be deeply missed and fondly remembered by her family, friends and community. May her loving memory continue to shine as a blessing to all.

Levine Chapels, Brookline
617-277-8300
www.levinechapel.com

DURSO, Angelo



Of Needham, August 20. Beloved husband of the late Jane; devoted and loving father of David, John and Dianne Durso. Cherished grandfather of Matthew; and brother of Alfred. Visiting Hours in the Eaton Funeral Home, 1351 Highland Ave., NEEDHAM, on Wednesday, August 26, from 4 - 7pm. Funeral Mass at St. Joseph Church in Needham, on Thursday, August 27, at 10am. Complete obituary, on EatonFuneralHomes.com

JONES, Anthony Andrieus "Tony"



Age 85, died peacefully, at his home in Wilmington, NC, surrounded by his family, on August 6, 2026. He is survived by his wife, Anne; brother, Michael; son, Adrian; daughter, Sarah; and four grandchildren.

Tony was a passionate outdoorsman and beloved husband and father. He attended St. Mark's high school in Southborough, MA, and graduated from Princeton University in 1963. He received his Master's in Arab Studies from the American University of Beirut, while teaching at International College in Beirut, Lebanon.

A Memorial Service will be held on Tuesday, October 27, at 11 a.m. at St. Mary of the Nativity Church, in Scituate, MA. Donations in his memory may be made to American Near East Refugee Aid (ANERA), Ducks Unlimited, The Nature Conservancy or Massachusetts Audubon Society.

KELLY, Suzan



Of Lowell, formerly of Somerville and Medford, died on August 23, 2026, after a brief illness. She was the loving daughter of the late Richard and Dorothy Kelly (Manning); and sister of the late Richard Kelly. She is survived by her sister, Patrice; many cousins and longtime friends. Sue spent 60 years on Boston Ave., in Somerville. She was a graduate of St. Clement High School, Class of '72 and Fisher Junior College. She worked for the federal government, initially with the Department of Fish and Wildlife and for the remainder of her career, with the U.S. Attorney's Office. She developed many lifelong friendships there and enjoyed the intricacies of the legal system and the challenges it presented. Her retirement afforded her more time to spend with her family and friends and also care for her mother, who she was devoted to. Some of her favorite pastimes included, photography, reading, movies and spending time at her favorite place, Hampton Beach. Sue was a lifelong friend to many people and was always there for support, comfort, advice and compassion. Her beautiful smile and great laugh will always be remembered. "...time it was and what a time it was..." (Simon and Garfunkel). Visiting Hours for Suzan will be held in the George L. Doherty Funeral Home, 855 Broadway (Powder House Sq.), SOMERVILLE, Thursday morning, August 27, 2026, from 11:00am - 12:00pm, followed by her Funeral Mass, in St. Clement Church, Somerville, at 12:30pm. Relatives and friends invited. Interment in Holy Cross Cemetery, Malden, where she will be laid to rest with her parents. In lieu of flowers, donations may be made in Suzan's memory to the charity of your choice.

Of Lowell, formerly of Somerville and Medford, died on August 23, 2026, after a brief illness. She was the loving daughter of the late Richard and Dorothy Kelly (Manning); and sister of the late Richard Kelly. She is survived by her sister, Patrice; many cousins and longtime friends. Sue spent 60 years on Boston Ave., in Somerville. She was a graduate of St. Clement High School, Class of '72 and Fisher Junior College. She worked for the federal government, initially with the Department of Fish and Wildlife and for the remainder of her career, with the U.S. Attorney's Office. She developed many lifelong friendships there and enjoyed the intricacies of the legal system and the challenges it presented. Her retirement afforded her more time to spend with her family and friends and also care for her mother, who she was devoted to. Some of her favorite pastimes included, photography, reading, movies and spending time at her favorite place, Hampton Beach. Sue was a lifelong friend to many people and was always there for support, comfort, advice and compassion. Her beautiful smile and great laugh will always be remembered. "...time it was and what a time it was..." (Simon and Garfunkel). Visiting Hours for Suzan will be held in the George L. Doherty Funeral Home, 855 Broadway (Powder House Sq.), SOMERVILLE, Thursday morning, August 27, 2026, from 11:00am - 12:00pm, followed by her Funeral Mass, in St. Clement Church, Somerville, at 12:30pm. Relatives and friends invited. Interment in Holy Cross Cemetery, Malden, where she will be laid to rest with her parents. In lieu of flowers, donations may be made in Suzan's memory to the charity of your choice.

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KOGAN, John N.



John Nathaniel Kogan, beloved husband, father, grandfather, brother, colleague, and friend, died on August 23, 2026, at the age of 86, after living with Parkinson's disease for 25 years.

John was born on January 15, 1940, to Jeanne and Robert Kogan and was the eldest of five children. Growing up on Manhattan's Upper East Side, he was independent, outspoken and endlessly curious, always looking for the next adventure.

That sense of adventure was matched by an exceptional intellect. After attending P.S. 6 on the Upper East Side, John earned a place at the Bronx High School of Science. He then boarded an Amtrak train with a single suitcase and his bicycle to enroll at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology, where he earned his undergraduate degree in Electrical Engineering with honors. He later attended the Sloan School of Management.

John spent more than four decades at Andersen Consulting, where his combination of analytical brilliance, leadership and mentorship skills, and ability to problem solve earned him the respect of his colleagues and clients. Among his many professional accomplishments, he led the firm's global consulting practice for the Y2K transition, traveling around the world to tackle an enormous and unprecedented technological challenge with the doggedness and determination that were hallmarks of his character.

John also believed strongly in helping others. As CEO of SCORE, he helped small-business owners navigate the challenges of entrepreneurship, including developing business plans and building the skills and strategies needed to succeed.

For 25 years, John faced the challenges of Parkinson's disease with extraordinary resilience, grit and grace. He defied expectations throughout the course of the disease, continuing to pursue the activities and interests he loved and refusing to give up. His determination and optimism remained undiminished until just days before his death.

John had a lifelong love of sports(diagramming over 300 baseball games in parks throughout the country), travel, cycling, photography, music and comedy. He traveled to 108 countries, bringing to each journey his characteristic curiosity and enthusiasm. He could be equally passionate about a bicycle ride, a photograph, a meal or a good joke. He had an encyclopedic memory and served as the household Chat GPT.

But above all else, John was devoted to his family.

He was married for 64 years to his beloved wife, Ann Gordon Kogan. Together they built a life filled with family, travel, laughter and love. He was the proud father of two daughters, Suzanne Kogan Yearley, (Andrew Yearley,) and Laura Kogan Tichner, (Jerome Tichner)

His grandchildren, Alexander Yearley, (Sydney); Campbell Yearley, (engaged to Josh Wasserman); Marin Yearley; Nicole Tichner; and Hailey Tichner, were a tremendous source of pride and joy.

John is also survived by his sisters Nan Rydzy, Jill Blake and Victoria Murphy. He was predeceased by his brother, Bruce Kogan.

To those who knew him, John was brilliant, persistent and, when he believed something mattered, nearly impossible to dissuade. He was also deeply loving, generous with his time and always willing to help solve a problem. John, your curiosity, humor, determination, and love of life will live forever in the hearts of those who were fortunate to know you.

A Memorial Service will be held at Levine Chapels, 470 Harvard Street, BROOKLINE, on Thursday, August 27, at 11:00 a.m.

In lieu of flowers, donations may be made in John's memory to The Michael J. Fox Foundation for Parkinson's Research at <https://give.michaelfox.org/campaign/754698/donate>

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LYNCH, Attorney Edward L.



 Age 85 years, died peacefully, at Salem Hospital, after a long illness

valiantly battled. He is survived by his wife, Elizabeth; brother, Owen and his wife, Anne; his brother-in-law, John Wall; his brother-in-law, Frank Cullinan and his wife, Anne; sister-in-law, Mary Jane and her husband, Tony Rodgers; several nieces and nephews, grandnieces and nephews, and great-grandnephews, as well as his lifelong friends. He was predeceased by his father, Arthur and mother, Louise; brother, Jimmy and his wife, Pat; sister, Marie Wall; and two nieces and one nephew. He graduated from Sacred Heart Grammar School and St Mary's High School in Lynn, Boston College and Suffolk University Law School. Ed served in the U.S. Army in the 60s, was honorably discharged as a Specialist 5th Class, and held a Top Secret Security Clearance.

A lifelong Lynn resident, who practiced law in Lynn for over 50 years, Ed loved his city and worked tirelessly to better the community all his life. He was committed to providing excellent legal advice and services to his clients. He was devoted to Catholic education in the St. Mary's community. Ed was renowned for his kindness, generosity and dedication, and would often be seen navigating Lynn in his '85 silver Volvo.

Ed's many positions included, serving as Trustee of North Shore Community College. Other achievements included, receiving the Lynn Boys and Girls Club Hall of Fame Recognition, Lynn Public Library Trustee for several years, past Director of the Lynn Chamber of Commerce, member of the Government Affairs Committee of the Lynn Area Chamber of Commerce, past Vice President of the United Cerebral Palsy of the North Shore, co-Founder and past Vice President of the Friends of Lynn and Nahant Beach Inc., former Director of the New Hampshire First Bank, Manchester NH, a member of Lynn Ward four Republican Committee and twice delegate to the State Convention. For many years, Ed was an enthusiastic supporter of the Northshore Philharmonic concert series and of the wide variety of events at the Lynn Auditorium. He was a generous donor to many charities, far too numerous to list.

One of his most esteemed positions was with East Boston Savings Bank, where he served as a Corporator and on the Board of Trustees for several years until his retirement. He loved all the employees that he worked with over the years, had a great and witty sense of humor and loved to gather with friends and family. Those who worked for Ed said they were always treated as family, no birthday went unnoticed and no burden went unlifted. His love of animals was profound, with their wonderful Cocker Spaniels and so many Lynn cats that found a home with him. He took great pride when F. Lee Bailey named him his personal lawyer. Ed had a gift to make others smile and laugh and he loved solving issues for clients and had a lasting impact on those who crossed his path.

His wife wishes to thank the staff of Salem Hospital's ICU, who gave such loving care and friendship to Ed.

For his love of life, family, friends and clients, Ed will be missed but not forgotten. May his spirit continue to inspire and uplift us.

Funeral Services will begin from the Solimine Funeral Home, on Friday, August 28, at 10 AM, followed by a Funeral Mass in St. Mary's Church, Lynn, at 11 AM, to which relatives and friends are invited to attend. Burial will follow at St. Joseph's Cemetery. Visiting Hours are at the Solimine Funeral Home, 67 Ocean St., LYNN, on Thursday, from 4 - 8 PM. Please make memorial donations in his name to St. Mary's Church, 8 South Common St., Lynn, MA 01902 or an animal welfare group of your choosing.

Announcements

SPRINKLER FITTERS LOCAL #550

We regret to announce the death of Brother James Louis Carter, Jr. Visitation will be held at the Dolan Funeral Home, 1140 Washington Street, DORCHESTER LOWER MILLS, on Wednesday, August 26 from 10:00am - 11:00am. Funeral Service to begin at 11:00am, with an interment at Fairview Cemetery.

Peter Gibbons
Business Manager
Secretary-Treasurer

MAHONEY, Daniel T. Jr.



 Age 84, passed away on Sunday, August 23, 2026, following a long journey

with Alzheimer's disease. Dan was born on June 2, 1942, in Providence, Rhode Island, to the late Helen (Keefe) and Daniel T. Mahoney, Sr. He was raised in Melrose, Massachusetts, alongside his three sisters, Alice, Helen and Ann.

Dan attended Boston College, graduating in 1964, with a degree in Economics. While at Boston College, he participated in ROTC and following graduation, was commissioned as a Second Lieutenant in the United States Army. He served in the Army Infantry, rising to the rank of First Lieutenant and completing two years of active duty, including service at Fort Leonard Wood, Missouri. He later continued his service in the U.S. Army Reserve and was awarded the National Defense Service Medal. It was during his college years that Dan met the love of his life, Rosemary Heron, while the two were working at the First National grocery store in Melrose. For Dan, it was love at first sight. They married shortly thereafter. During the early years of their marriage, Dan and Rosemary lived in Fort Leonard Wood, MO, Melrose, MA and Melbourne, FL, before eventually settling in Natick, Massachusetts, where they raised their four children and became deeply rooted in the community they would call home. Dan built his career in management at Honeywell, where his natural business instincts and leadership abilities served him well. His entrepreneurial spirit eventually led him in a new direction when he opened Uniglobe Travel in Natick, with Rosemary and their daughter, Christine. His business savvy remained a part of who he was throughout his life, and as his children grew up and entered careers of their own, Dad was often a trusted source of advice and counsel. He took great pride in sharing what he had learned and helping his children navigate their own professional lives. Dan believed strongly in giving back to the community. He was an active member of the Natick Rotary Club, including serving in leadership positions and was recognized multiple times as a Paul Harris Fellow. He generously gave his time and talents wherever they were needed and found great purpose in serving others. His Catholic faith was equally central to his life. Dan was a devoted member of St. Patrick's Parish in Natick, where he served as a Eucharistic Minister and was deeply involved in parish life. Together with Rosemary, he helped lead the parish's 24-hour Adoration Chapel for many years. Their shared faith was a cornerstone of their marriage and the life they built together. For his family, however, some of the most treasured memories were in the simpler moments. There were summers at his parents' home in South Yarmouth, Cape Cod, and evenings when he would pick up his guitar and play along with eight-track recordings of Neil Diamond and Peter, Paul and Mary, with the family singing along. We can still picture him relaxing on the couch with his old pipe, its familiar vanilla aroma filling the room. These are the memories that remain, the sounds, places and little traditions that made him "Dad." Becoming a grandfather brought out an especially playful and adoring side. He treasured his granddaughters, Emma Rosemary and Rebecca. Dan was predeceased by his beloved wife, Rosemary (Heron) Mahoney; his sons, James Mahoney and Daniel T. Mahoney, III; and his daughter-in-law, Stephanie Mahoney. Dan leaves behind his daughters, Christine LaRosa and her husband, Buddy, Karen Mahoney; and her daughter, Emma; and granddaughter, Rebecca. He also leaves his sisters, many nieces, nephews, extended family members and friends. After a long journey with Alzheimer's, we take comfort knowing that he is finally at peace and reunited with his beloved Rosemary and his sons, Jim and Dan. We invite Dan's family and close friends to join us in Celebrating his Life with Visiting in the John Everett & Sons Funeral Home, 4 Park Street, NATICK COMMON, on Saturday, August 29, from 8:30-9:30am, followed by Funeral Mass in St. Patrick Church, 44 East Central St. (Rt 135), Natick, at 10am. Interment St. Patrick Cemetery, Natick. In lieu of flowers, donations may be made in Dan's memory to the Alzheimer's Association in support of Alzheimer's care, support and research. For directions and guestbook, please visit www.everettfuneral.com

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Remembered

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MILES, Lorraine M. (Piekos)



Of Medford, August 28. Beloved wife of Robert R. Miles. Devoted mother of Robert Miles and his wife, Tina, Kathleen Kretz and her husband, Patrick, Kimberly Miles and her husband, Dermot Ryan, Lauren Miles, Robin Miles, Christopher Miles and his wife, Sabrina, Kristin Frye and her husband, Kevin, Jonathan Miles and his wife, Lyndsay. Loving grandmother to Alexander and his wife, Anna, Samantha, Rachel, Noah, Haley, Grant and Skyler. Loving great-grandmother to Ember. Dear sister of William Piekos and his partner, Kathy Sharpe, Claire Lundberg and her husband, Robert, Joseph Piekos and his wife, Clare, the late Barbara Neilly; and sister-in-law, Carol Piekos. Also survived by dozens of nieces and nephews. Relatives and friends are respectfully invited to visit with the family at the Dello Russo Funeral Home, 306 Main St., MEDFORD, Thursday, August 27, from 4 - 8 PM, and again on Friday morning, August 28, at 9 AM, followed by a Mass of Christian Burial, celebrated in St. Joseph Church, 118 High St., Medford, at 10 AM. Services will conclude with Burial at Oak Grove Cemetery, Medford. Lorraine requests to be overwhelmed with flowers and also welcomes donations in her memory to the Lewy Body Dementia Assoc., <https://lbda.org/donate> To leave a message of condolence, visit www.dellorosso.net

RATTA, Eleanor S. (Figaratto)



Of Roxbury, died peacefully, on August 24, 2026, at the age of 91 years. Beloved wife of the late Frank O. Ratta. Loving mother of Douglas and his wife, Kathy Ratta of Kingston, Frederick and his wife, Ann Ratta of South Weymouth, Karen and her husband, Phil Yuska of Winchester and the late Joseph Bavis. Devoted "Nana" of Samantha Kane, Lauren and her husband, Scott O'Neill, Nicole Bavis, Michaela Bavis, Joseph and his wife, Anastasia Bavis, Bailey and her husband, Jeffrey Davidson and Devan and her husband, Patrick O'Keeffe. Great-nana of James, Amelia, Violet, Willow, Lex, Luke, Mason, Matilda, Olivia, Parker, Griffin and Joseph. Sister of the late Angie Merritt, Vinnie Figaratto, Jenny Sanfilippo, Danny Figaratto, Joe Figaratto, Frank Figaratto, Albie Figaratto, Louie Figaratto and Richard Figaratto. Eleanor is also survived by many nieces and nephews.

Family and friends will honor and remember Eleanor's life by gathering for Visiting Hours in the Murphy Funeral Home, 1020 Dorchester Ave., DORCHESTER, on Wednesday, August 26, 2026, from 4:00 P.M. to 7:00 P.M.

Her Funeral Mass will be celebrated in St. Patrick Church, 400 Dudley Street, Roxbury, on Thursday morning, August 27, 2026, at 10:30 A.M.

Burial with her late husband, Frank, will be held in the Massachusetts National Cemetery, in Bourne, on Wednesday, September 2, 2026, at 11:15 A.M.

Eleanor was a longtime parishioner of St. Patrick Church in Roxbury, where she volunteered as a lector, worked with the C.Y.O. and is fondly remembered for cooking meatballs for the Christmas bazaar for many years. She also volunteered at the parish grammar school and was active in many community and neighborhood groups. She was an avid softball player and bowler, playing in her 70s.

In lieu of flowers, donations in Eleanor's memory may be made to St. Patrick Church, 400 Dudley St., Roxbury, MA 02119 or to The American Heart Association, at www.heart.org

For guestbook, please visit www.jmurphyfh.com



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The Boston Globe

Shelley Fabares, 'Donna Reed Show' actor, at 82

By Victor Mather
NEW YORK TIMES

Shelley Fabares, a veteran television actor whose career spanned decades and included prominent roles on programs including "The Donna Reed Show," "One Day at a Time," and "Coach," died Saturday in Los Angeles. She was 82.

Her husband, actor Mike Farrell, announced the death on social media but did not specify a cause.

Ms. Fabares's roles evolved over time from child to perky teen to Elvis Presley love interest to career woman. She also found time to record a No. 1 hit, "Johnny Angel."

She had worked as a child model and had small TV and movie roles before achieving her breakthrough in 1958 on the wholesome family sitcom "The Donna Reed Show" as Donna's winsome, upbeat teenage daughter, Mary.

The cast was like a family for her, she later said. "Donna was truly like my second mother," she told the YouTube channel That's Classic. Of her TV brother, Paul Petersen, she said, "We fought like brother and sister all the time."

Ms. Fabares said that she, Reed, Petersen, and her TV father, Carl Betz, would meet once a month for years after the show went off the air.

"I think the years on 'The Donna Reed Show,' the years from 14 to 19, were so incredibly important," Ms. Fabares told the Los Angeles Times in 1993.

"Donna Reed was simply an extraordinary woman, a woman of great strength, kindness, integrity and compassion. I am not trying to make her sound like a saint, but she had the most profound influence on me. I carry her with me today."

Inspired by the success of the singing career of "Ozzie and Harriet" star Ricky Nelson, pro-

ducers of "The Donna Reed Show" decided to try something similar with Ms. Fabares and a song called "Johnny Angel." But she didn't consider herself a singer.

"I can still feel the pain in my stomach today," she told the website Cryptic Rock in 2024, recalling the recording session.

"I was thinking: 'I cannot do this. Wait till I start singing, and these musicians are going to get up and walk out of the room.'"

She also performed the song on the show.

Powered by that appearance, it hit No. 1 in 1962.

In the song, she pined for Johnny " 'cause I love him, and I pray that someday he'll love me" — but "he doesn't even know that I exist."

In a similar-sounding sequel, "Johnny Loves Me," released later in 1962, Ms. Fabares gets her boy. That happier song hit No. 21. But she was never comfortable as a singer and soon returned to acting exclusively.

In 1963, she became interested in pursuing other acting opportunities. Her "Donna Reed Show" character left for college, but she continued to appear periodically until the show ended in 1966.

She became a regular in mid-1960s Elvis Presley movies, appearing in "Girl Happy" (1965), a beach film (she gets Elvis); "Spinout" (1966), a race car film (Elvis stays single); and "Clambake" (1967), another beach film (she gets Elvis again).

She said that before doing the films she had more of a crush on Jimmy Stewart. Nevertheless, her first impression of Presley, on the soundstage, was unforgettable.

"He wasn't doing anything," she told Elvis Australia in 2013. "He was walking in. The presence that this man had. You



RICHARD SHOTWELL/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE

Ms. Bradford Hobbs (left), pictured at a 2024 ceremony honoring George Clinton with a star on the Hollywood Walk of Fame, helped make Motown a music industry powerhouse.

Janie Bradford Hobbs, 87, early Motown songwriter

By Corey Williams
ASSOCIATED PRESS

Early Motown songwriter Janie Bradford Hobbs, who helped pen hits including "Money (That's What I Want)" and "Too Busy Thinking About My Baby," has died following an extended illness at a Los Angeles hospital, her family said in a statement Saturday. She was 87.

Ms. Bradford Hobbs was born in Charleston, Mo., and later moved to Detroit.

She was introduced in the late 1950s to Motown founder Berry Gordy by neighbor and singer Jackie Wilson.

She joined Motown as a receptionist in 1958 and like many of the company's employees took part in the creative process that helped make Motown a music industry powerhouse.

She and Gordy co-wrote "Money (That's What I Want)." The song was recorded in 1959 by Barrett Strong and became an early hit.

It was covered by The Beatles and also became one of that group's hits.

"Too Busy Thinking About My Baby" first was recorded by The Temptations in 1966 and became a hit for Marvin Gaye

three years later.

Ms. Bradford Hobbs also wrote songs for Stevie Wonder, The Supremes, Martha & The Vandellas, and others.

"Janie was there with me from the very beginning, before there was even a Motown, and she will always hold a very special place in my heart and in the Motown family," Gordy said in a statement.

"Janie was one of a special group I have always thought of as the original Motown family — the unsung heroes who believed in the dream before anyone knew what Motown would become," Gordy continued. "She was one of the people who helped make Motown what it became."

Ms. Bradford Hobbs later became head of Writer Relations for Jobete, Motown's publishing company.

After leaving Motown, she founded the annual Heroes and Legends Awards. The event spanned about 30 years, honoring music icons and awarding scholarships, according to her family.

Ms. Bradford Hobbs leaves her husband, Wardean Hobbs; daughter, Nicole Hobbs; son, Lance Finney; and two grandsons.

Obituaries



JOHN SHEARER/INVISION FOR SUNDANCETV/AP IMAGES/FILE

Ms. Fabares, with her husband, Mike Farrell, in 2014 in Los Angeles.

couldn't talk. Nobody did anything. You just sort of stopped and watched him."

The films were not especially acclaimed at the time or today — The New York Times review of "Girl Happy" says little of her performance beyond "and a cute chick she is" — but they have retained a following because of their carefree spirit and the stars' charisma.

Michele Marie Fabares was born Jan. 19, 1944, in Santa Monica, Calif., to James Fabares, who worked at a bank, and Elsa Eyler, a vice president of a mortgage company. Her aunt was actor Nanette Fabray.

Ms. Fabares returned to television after her run of Presley films, playing the wife of doomed football star Brian Piccolo (James Caan) in the acclaimed TV movie "Brian's Song" and making guest appearances in various series.

In the 1970s and '80s, she was a series regular on "One Day at a Time," playing a work rival and later business partner

of Bonnie Franklin's single mother lead character, Ann Romano. (Fabray appeared as Romano's mother.)

Ms. Fabares entertained yet another generation on the 1990s sitcom "Coach" as a TV anchor who was the funny, independent girlfriend and later wife of Hayden Fox (Craig T. Nelson).

The show took awhile to find its audience.

"I did always feel from the very beginning if they could find the right spot for us, this was a show that would last," she said in the Los Angeles Times interview.

Ms. Fabares's own marriage to music and film producer Lou Adler ended in divorce. In 1984, she married Farrell, an actor best known for playing B.J. Hunnicutt on the "M*A*S*H" TV series.

She leaves him, as well as two stepchildren, Erin and Michael Farrell.

"To her family and friends, Shelley was a source of love,

strength, laughter, and comfort," her family wrote in a statement. "She had a remarkable ability to make people feel welcomed, valued, and cared for."

In early 1999, a visit to the emergency room for an esophageal bleed revealed that she had progressive liver failure.

After spending 22 months on a waiting list, she had liver transplant surgery in October 2000.

In an interview with Cedars-Sinai Medical Center in Los Angeles three years after the transplant, she said she'd been "changed by the experience" and was eternally grateful to Farrell who was with her "every step of the way."

A few years later Ms. Fabares stepped away from acting. She was active in the Screen Actors Guild, serving on its board, and was involved in producing the SAG Awards from 2003 through 2018.

Material from the Associated Press was used in this obituary.

Marcos Rodríguez; told of living with wolves

By Ephrat Livni
NEW YORK TIMES

Marcos Rodríguez Pantoja, whose account of growing up in a remote part of Spain, with the companionship of only wolves and other animals, was analyzed in a case study and adapted into literature and film, died this month at 80, according to authorities in San Cibrao das Viñas, the municipality where he spent his final years.

Mr. Rodríguez's story came to light in the mid-1970s, about a decade after he had made what he described as an unwilling return to human society. Gabriel Janer Manila, a writer, heard about the case from a friend and wanted to learn more.

"At first, it seemed like a fabrication. It couldn't be true," Janer said in a 2010 interview with the site Anika Entre Libros.

But he came to believe the tale, finding corroboration for Mr. Rodríguez's claims from witnesses and other research. Janer would go on to write a study about Mr. Rodríguez's childhood and, later, a novel called "I Played With Wolves," originally published in 2009.

The story also inspired a 2010 film directed by Gerardo Oliveras, "Among Wolves," in which Mr. Rodríguez appeared.

Mr. Rodríguez faced doubts over the years, but his story fascinated many. Janer became convinced after visiting places Mr. Rodríguez said he had been and meeting people — including a seminarian who had cared for him — who backed up the story and spoke of Mr. Rodríguez's complete lack of social knowledge.

In Rante, a village in San Cibrao das Viñas, in northwest Spain, where Mr. Rodríguez lived for the last quarter-century of his life, some people told Germany's public broadcaster around the time the film was released that they had doubted his story until it was made into a movie — and some said they continued to be dubious.

In 2010, a team from Spain's public broadcaster traveled with Mr. Rodríguez to the place where he said he had lived, filming him showing some of his sur-

vival skills, like catching fish using rocks, and his deep familiarity with nature, including mimicking bird calls.

In any case, he eventually came to be known as the "wolf boy of Sierra Morena" and stuck to the story over the decades.

Claims of having grown up in the wild are widely viewed with skepticism, and expertise in the subject is rare. There have been some notable cases, though they are few. Feral children also appeared in ancient myths and medieval folk tales, fueling a real-life fascination with them.

In 1726, Caroline, the Princess of Wales, sought the guardianship of a youth found in the woods in Germany who became known as Peter the Wild Boy and was a source of wonder in Europe. She installed him in her house in London under the watch of a doctor, then put him in the care of a servant when he proved unruly. The so-called Wild Boy of Aveyron was found in France at the end of the 18th century and was taken to a physician in Paris who tried and failed to teach him society's ways.

Such tales have intrigued people because they say as much about society as they do about the children said to have lived outside of it.

"Through the stories, factual and fictional, of the feral children, there emerges, perhaps, another narrative: the fragmented and haunting story of our continuing relationship with the savage image of ourselves," the cultural historian Michael Newton wrote in his 2002 book, "Savage Girls and Wild Boys: A History of Feral Children."

As Mr. Rodríguez told it, he was born into a poor family in southern Spain in June 1946. His mother died when he was very young, and the woman his father later married was an abusive stepmother.

The family lived in a remote alpine hut in the Sierra Morena mountain range, turning firewood into charcoal.

When he was about 7, he said, he was put in the care of an old goat herd, to be trained to replace him.

"He takes Marcos in and teaches him how to survive, how to care for the flock of goats, how to do everything that might help him," Janer said in the 2010 interview.

The old man then died or disappeared, and young Marcos began to fend for himself, unwilling or unable to return to his former home.

Mr. Rodríguez said he lived in the wild for about 11 years with the help of wolves and other animals. In 1965, he was discovered by law enforcement authorities among wolves, wearing animal skins.

He described his return to life among humans as something he did not know how to manage and would never fully embrace. According to Mr. Rodríguez's interviews and Janer's study, his rehabilitation was undertaken by nuns.

He said he had lost the habits of walking upright and of using human speech, and he had forgotten how to behave with people.

Mr. Rodríguez said he struggled with human society for much of his life. Employers had taken advantage of him over the years, people had mocked him and he had been happiest among the animals, he said in interviews.

In Rante, he worked with Amigas das Árbores, an environmental group, speaking to children at schools about his youth and his unique experience with animals.

The group, in a post on social media earlier this month, said that one of his final wishes had been "for his ashes to remain in the village that took him in."

In an interview with the newspaper El País in 2018, Mr. Rodríguez said that despite his disappointment with humanity, he had no chance of returning to a life in the mountains. The area where he had once lived now featured cottages connected to the electric grid, and the wolves were strangers.

"If I call out to them they are going to respond, but they are not going to approach me," he said.

"I smell like people."

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Globe Opinion

State legislators call on WHDH to resolve contract fight with photographers' union

Employees are demanding higher wages and better benefits

By Aidan Ryan
GLOBE STAFF

A group of 27 state legislators have urged WHDH-TV (Channel 7) to resolve a contract fight between the station and the union representing photographers and technical employees.

In a letter dated Aug. 13 and addressed to Jimmy Rogers, the station's vice president and general manager, legislators, including Senator Paul Feeney, Senator Mark Montigny, and Representative Lisa Field, called on management to "to reach a fair and timely agreement with the members" of IBEW Local 1228 and said they were

"deeply concerned after being told of station management's position on critical workplace issues."

"We encourage the company to bargain in good faith and to reach an agreement that reflects the value these employees bring to the station," the lawmakers wrote. "Reaching a fair contract will benefit not only the employees, but also the long-term success of the station and the communities it serves."

Rogers told the Globe by email that "WHDH continues to bargain in good faith."

The station is owned by Miami-based Sunbeam Television, which also

operates the Miami ABC affiliate WSVN-TV. WHDH is an independent and unaffiliated station, meaning it doesn't have a connection with any national network.

Station leaders and union organizers have been in negotiations for over a year after the most recent contract lapsed in July 2025. The union has said it has not received a wage increase since 2023, and is fighting for salary bumps and additional benefits. Members also receive only six paid holidays, lower than the 10 paid holidays that their peers at WBZ-TV (Channel 4) and WCVB-TV (Channel

WHDH, Page D2



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

WHDH workers held an informational picket outside the station in downtown Boston in July amid ongoing contract negotiations.

LARRY EDELMAN TRENDLINES



PATRICK DOYLE/THE CANADIAN PRESS VIA ASSOCIATED PRESS

During a press conference Saturday, Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney said, "We cannot accept what they've offered, and we will not give what they've asked," in reference to negotiations with the United States.

Oh, Canada

President Trump has ordered 50 percent tariffs on \$20 billion worth of Canadian goods, a move that could hurt Massachusetts

In President Trump's Bizarro World, North Korea is "unthreatening and respectful" while Canada has "nasty" leaders who take advantage of the United States.

Or at least that's the excuse for ramping up his trade war with our northern neighbor over the weekend by ordering 50 percent tariffs on \$20 billion worth of Canadian goods.

"Canada wants the benefits of being a State, without being one!!!" Trump said in a social media post on Sunday.

Might the levies also have something to do with Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney's refusal to suck up to Trump? Don't answer; that was a rhetorical question.

The president's preoccupation with Canada — he

In 2025, MASSACHUSETTS...
imported **\$42.9 billion**
worth of goods,
23% from Canada

exported **\$33.8 billion**
worth of goods,
8.4% to Canada

says it should be the 51st state — would be laughable if the country weren't Massachusetts's and New England's largest trading partner.

Thankfully, this round of tariffs is relatively small and energy, the state's largest Canadian import, is exempt. Trump is especially sensitive to gasoline prices after the spike caused by his unsuccessful war against Iran.

But many Canadian agricultural goods and lumber products are affected. And, perhaps more important than the immediate financial impact, the deteriorating relationship between the two countries doesn't bode well for our region's economy and longstanding ties to Canada.

The latest: The administration imposed the new

TRENDLINES, Page D2

BOLD TYPES

Collegium moving to Boston from the suburbs

CEO says relocation to One Lincoln tower reflects desire to be player in city's biotech scene

By Jon Chesto
GLOBE STAFF

Welcome to Boston, **Vikram Karnani**.

The chief executive of **Collegium Pharmaceutical** is the latest boss of a publicly traded company to choose Boston as his firm's home. Its relocation from Stoughton to the One Lincoln tower is slated to happen early next year.

The reason Collegium is relocating? Karnani points to the quest for talent and the desire to be a player in Boston's biotech scene.

"Boston is an amazing ecosystem for biopharmaceutical and biotech talent," Karnani said. "To realize our ambitions, we need access to that world-class talent."

Collegium specializes in pain and ADHD medications, though Karnani is considering expansions into new areas, such as rare-disease treatments. Most of its revenue comes from drugs and technology that Collegium has acquired, such as the \$650 million purchase in May of ADHD drug Azstarys, rather than developed with an in-house lab like at traditional biotechs.

Karnani spent most of his career in Illinois, not Massachusetts. He grew what was known as Horizon Therapeutics from a company with 200 employees and \$300 million in revenue, to one with more than 2,000 and \$4 billion, before **Amgen** acquired it in 2023. He was still at Amgen when Collegium's

BOLD TYPES, Page D4



CHRIS MORRIS
FOR THE GLOBE

Vikram Karnani, CEO, says Boston has a lot of biotech talent.

STAT

Inside Moderna and Merck's cancer vaccine triumph

By Matthew Herper, Jason Mast, and Angus Chen

STAT

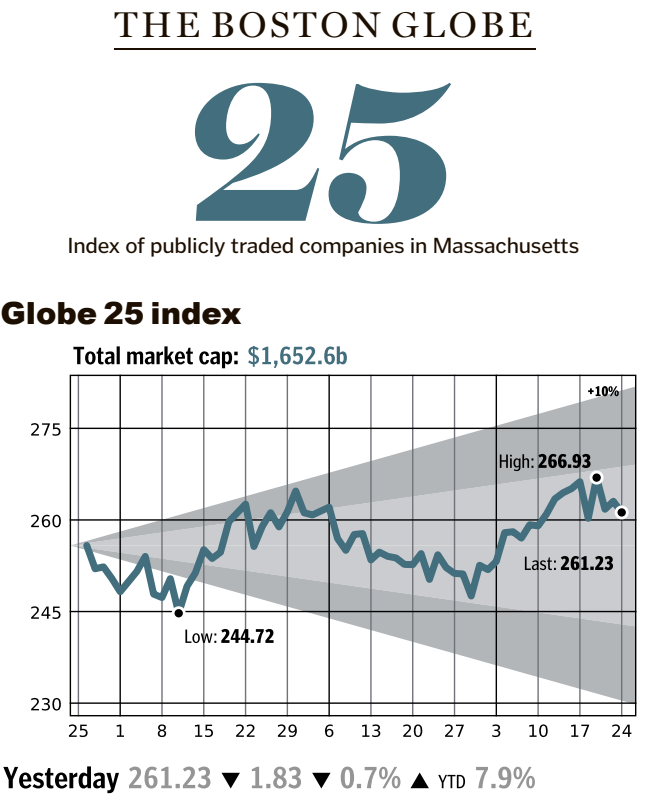
At an off-site leadership meeting held by Moderna in March 2023 — after mid-stage results of the biotech company's cancer vaccine showed promise — chief executive Stéphane Bancel had the floor. He asked if any of the 100 or so executives present had expected the experi-

mental treatment to succeed. If they did, he said, please stand up.

Stephen Hoge, Moderna's president, was standing on stage. He sat down. Then, Hoge recalled in an interview with STAT, Bancel sat down, too.

"None of us believed it," Hoge said. It had taken time before he remembers feeling, "Oh my gosh. This is real."

STAT, Page D3



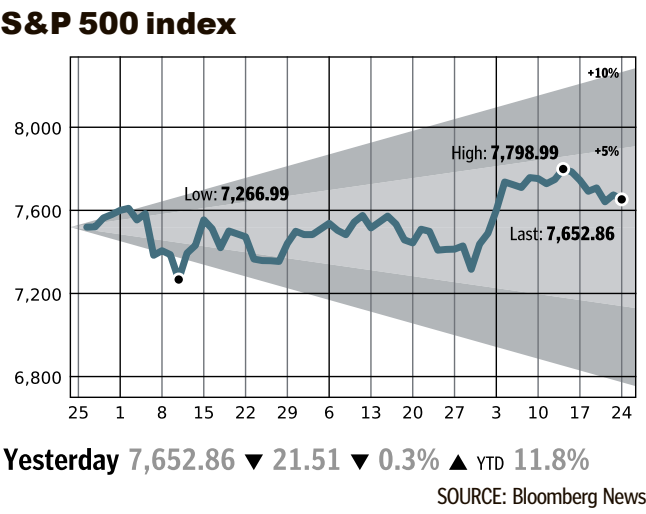
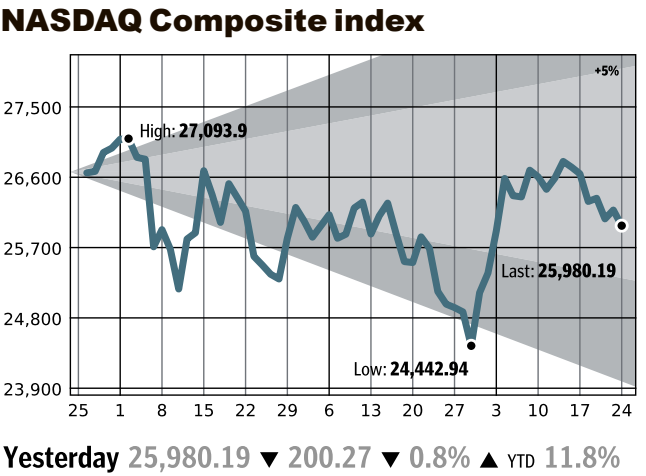
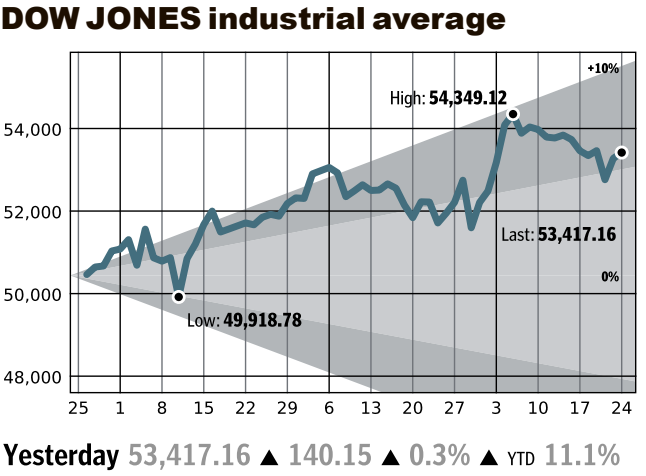
	Price	Chg	% chg	Market cap (bil.)
GE VERNOVA INC (GEV)	942.10	-14.75	-1.5	250.9
THERMO FISHER (TMO)	628.74	-0.53	-0.1	232.5
ANALOG DEVICES (ADI)	371.17	-1.92	-0.5	179.9
TJX COS INC (TJX)	140.71	+0.18	+0.1	155.4
VERTEX PHARM (VRTX)	547.59	-0.46	-0.1	138.8
AMERICAN TOWER C (AMT)	178.39	+2.59	+1.5	83.1
BOSTON SCIENTIFC (BSX)	49.01	-1.36	-2.7	71.0
TERADYNE INC (TER)	364.90	-10.84	-2.9	57.0
MODERNA INC (MRNA)	138.89	-6.24	-4.3	55.4
STATE ST CORP (STT)	190.92	+3.79	+2.0	52.4
KEURIG DR PEPPER (KDP)	32.51	+0.47	+1.5	44.2
WATERS CORP (WAT)	410.75	+0.05	+0.0	40.4
IRON MOUNTAIN (IRM)	121.19	-0.83	-0.7	36.1
BIOGEN INC (BIIB)	218.12	+1.34	+0.6	32.2
ALNYLAM PHARMACE (ALNY)	236.01	-0.21	-0.1	31.6
EVERSOURCE ENERG (ES)	71.25	+1.04	+1.5	26.8
SYMBOTIC INC (SYM)	40.03	-1.80	-4.3	24.2
VERALTO CORP (VLT)	99.37	+0.60	+0.6	24.2
ENTEGRIS INC (ENTG)	138.25	-5.41	-3.8	21.1
MACOM TECHNOLOGY (MTSI)	257.43	-9.18	-3.4	19.7
MKS INC (MKSI)	269.06	-10.05	-3.6	18.2
PTC INC (PTC)	154.31	-0.37	-0.2	16.7
CLEAN HARBORS (CLH)	313.74	-2.24	-0.7	16.6
AKAMAI TECHNOLOG (AKAM)	105.66	-4.76	-4.3	15.2
VICOR CORP (VICR)	189.99	-10.55	-5.3	8.8

Markets

Make or break week for AI stocks

US stocks drifted to a mixed finish Monday as the countdown ticks toward potentially market-moving events coming later in the week. The areas of the bond market that the Treasury Department is trying to calm down, meanwhile, eased a bit. Tech stocks led the way downward following big swings through the summer on worries that the frenzy around AI sent prices too high and that the huge demand for AI chips won't be sustainable if they don't produce enough profits. Chip giant Nvidia has been a tremendous winner of the AI boom and become Wall Street's largest and most influential stock because of it. It will deliver its latest quarterly earnings report on Wednesday, which could dictate the next big move for AI-related stocks. Nvidia sank 2.9 percent and was the heaviest weight on the S&P 500, where the majority of stocks rose. Drops of 5.8 percent for Micron Technology and 2.6 percent for Broadcom also helped drag the index lower. The other big factor moving stocks recently has been the bond market, where longer-term Treasury yields climbed through the summer on worries about high inflation, huge government debts and other factors.

— ASSOCIATED PRESS



Washington Post ordered to rehire columnist fired over Kirk comments

Arbitrator rules within rights as opinion writer

By Benjamin Mullin
NEW YORK TIMES

A private arbitrator has ordered The Washington Post to rehire opinion columnist Karen Attiah, who was fired in September over her social media posts about the assassination of conservative activist Charlie Kirk. It also ordered the company to compensate her with back pay.

Sarah Miller Espinosa, the arbitrator, said in a written decision Thursday that the Post “did not have good and sufficient cause” to terminate Attiah and “violated” its labor agreement, according to a copy of the decision shared with The New York Times by Attiah's lawyers. “The Washington Post failed to establish the grievant engaged in gross misconduct,” Espinosa wrote.

In a statement, Attiah said that she hoped the decision “sends a message to journalists and media institutions everywhere that freedom of expression is always worth fighting for.” She said that she was “willing to go back” to her work at the Post, which she called “one of the world's most storied newspapers.”

“This decision confirms what we've said from the start: I was doing my job as an opinion writer, and this was wrongful termination,” she said, adding that she was “relieved to finally have that record set straight.”

A spokesperson for the Post said the company respects the arbitration process and declined to comment further.

The decision is the result of a yearlong fight between the Post and Attiah, who last year accused the company of violating its labor agreement and social media policy when it fired her for posts she said were within her purview as an opinion columnist. A clause in the agree-



ASHARA WILSON VIA ASSOCIATED PRESS

Columnist Karen Attiah was also compensated backpay she was due after being fired for comments she made the day conservative activist Charlie Kirk was killed.

ment allows employees to submit disputes for arbitration.

Arbitration is generally considered binding in most disputes, though courts have occasionally overturned decisions after courtroom findings of fraud or other improprieties. The Post's labor agreement says arbitration is binding, though both the company and the employee retain their legal rights.

The Post said in its termination letter that Attiah's posts about Kirk had harmed “the integrity” of the organization and violated standards requiring employees to use social media with civility and respect.

Attiah's remarks about Kirk's assassination, which she posted to social network Bluesky on Sept. 10, the day he was shot, responded to the outpouring of grief after the shooting. “Refusing to tear my clothes and smear ashes on my face in performative mourning for a white man that espoused violence is

... not the same as violence,” Attiah wrote in one of the posts.

The Post's opinion section has been in flux since early last year, when Jeff Bezos, the newspaper's owner, moved to reorient the section to focus on “personal liberties and free markets.” Some readers canceled their subscriptions and accused Bezos of attempting to curry favor with the Trump administration.

Lawyers for the Post and Attiah made their arguments before Espinosa in June during a hearing that included testimony from Attiah; Adam O'Neal, then the opinion editor at the Post; and Wayne Connell, the company's chief human resources officer.

Attiah was represented by the Washington-Baltimore News Guild and Democracy Defenders Fund, a nonprofit cofounded by lawyer Norman Eisen.

In his testimony, O'Neal said

he saw Attiah's posts the morning after Kirk died and sent them to Connell, according to a transcript of the hearing obtained by The New York Times. “Karen's social media feed yesterday and today is beyond the pale, completely unacceptable for someone associated with Opinions,” O'Neal wrote, according to the transcript.

Soon after, O'Neal and Connell met with Will Lewis, then the CEO of the Post, to discuss the posts, according to the transcript. They ultimately decided to fire Attiah.

During her testimony, Attiah defended her social media posts, saying that they were part of her work for the Post, “commenting on our discourse on political violence,” Attiah said, according to the transcript.

In a statement, Eisen called the decision “a landmark victory for one of our nation's crusading journalists.”

Lawmakers call for WHDH contract deal

►WHDH
Continued from Page D1
5) receive.

For months, union members and supporters have held informational pickets outside of WHDH's office to rally for a new contract. But they've also raised additional workplace concerns in lawsuits and grievance filings.

Four WHDH photographers sued the station in federal court last month over wages, alleging they were not properly compensated for work-related travel. The union has also filed unfair labor practice complaints with the National Labor Relations Board, including over a change

to the schedule of the union's chief steward in the middle of negotiations, which means he sees his children significantly less.

The union is continuing its informational picketing with another rally on Wednesday outside of the WHDH studios in downtown Boston. Steve Katsos, the business manager of IBEW Local 1228, said that he hopes the sides can reach a deal at the next bargaining session scheduled for Sept. 2.

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DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

For months, union members and supporters have picketed outside of WHDH's office to rally for a new contract.

Mass. could be hurt in Canada tariff tiff

►TRENDLINES
Continued from Page D1

duties — covering about 5 percent of Canada's US exports — after trade negotiations collapsed late Friday.

The administration said it was acting in response to what it called Canada's discriminatory treatment of US exports of dairy, alcoholic beverages, and motor vehicles.

The hodgepodge list of hundreds of affected imports includes dairy and alcohol, as well as textiles and clothing. But many, um, peculiar items have also been targeted: tongue depressors, molasses, and horsehair and horsehair waste, to name just a few.

Step back: The move comes on top of other current tariffs against Canada.

The country, like nearly every US trading partner, is subject to a 10 percent surcharge on exports to America, with the exception of products covered under the US-Mexico-Canada trade pact.

Trump, citing national security concerns, also imposed sep-

arate duties on steel, aluminum, autos, and lumber.

“They've always had the best [trade] deal, and they still would have an even better deal, but they didn't want that,” Jamieson Greer, the US trade representative, said, referring to the failed negotiations with Canada.

In a speech on Saturday, Carney vowed to retaliate “dollar for dollar” starting Sept. 8. Trump responded on Monday by threatening to increase existing tariffs on motor vehicles and parts to 50 percent from 25 percent.

The local angle: Canada accounted for about a quarter of Massachusetts' \$43 billion of goods imports last year, according to US Census Bureau data.

As noted, energy, which accounts for 36 percent of Massachusetts' Canadian imports, is not on the tariff list.

But other top import categories are, including agricultural goods (27 percent) and forest products (9 percent). Higher prices for some food and lumber are possible.

Carney said Canada's retaliatory tariffs would focus on sectors including steel, dairy, appliances, agricultural equipment, pulp and paper, and electronics.

That might hurt some of Massachusetts' larger exports to Canada: optical, medical, and precision instruments; computers; plastics; pharmaceuticals; aircraft and parts; and paper and paperboard. About 8 percent of the state's \$33.8 billion in product exports go to Canada.

What's next: Trump is still miffed that eight Canadian provinces banned US alcohol imports in 2025 after he upped the volume on his “51st state” nonsense and imposed tariffs in violation of the free trade agreement between the two countries and Mexico.

Canadians, whose attitudes toward the administration have only hardened since then, aren't going to back down — even if the United States buys nearly three-quarters of their exports and is the source of nearly half their imports. They figure Trump and his tariff fixation

will be history in two years.

“We cannot accept what they've offered, and we will not give what they've asked,” Carney said on Saturday. “Our goal has always been to get the best deal for Canadians, never a deal at any price or any time frame.”

Although its economy is less than one-10th the size of the United States, Canada has some leverage in this trade fight. It is the largest foreign supplier of energy to America and the second-largest source of direct foreign investment.

Final thought: Stymied by Iran in the Persian Gulf, he's desperate for a win on trade.

While Canada and the United States have deep economic and cultural ties, Trump doesn't care.

“We've recognized from the start that America has changed,” Carney said. “We recognize that sometimes, its signature is written in pencil.”

Oh, Canada, with an ally like Trump, who needs enemies?

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TALKING POINTS

LEGAL

JUDGE NARROWS BEN & JERRY'S SUIT ACCUSING PARENT COMPANY OF SILENCING SOCIAL ACTIVISM



A federal judge on Friday dismissed major portions of a Ben & Jerry's lawsuit accusing its former parent Unilever of trying to silence the ice cream maker's social activism, dismantle its board, and stop funding its namesake foundation. US District Judge Kevin Castel in Manhattan dismissed seven claims and part of an eighth in a 10-count complaint by Vermont-based Ben & Jerry's, whose flavors include Cherry Garcia, Half Baked, and Phish Food, and by various independent directors. Castel also said Magnum, the Amsterdam-based company that has owned Ben & Jerry's since it was spun off from Unilever last year, will take Unilever's place as the primary defendant. The dismissed claims relate primarily to how Ben and Jerry's operates, while the two claims that survived in full relate to missed payments by Unilever. Unilever's purchase of Ben & Jerry's had preserved substantial and uncommon freedoms for the ice cream company, relative to most acquisitions. These included an independent board, and the ability to continue pursuing a social mission and charitable work dating from its 1978 founding by Ben Cohen and Jerry Greenfield. The relationship began unraveling in 2021, however, when Ben & Jerry's decided to stop selling ice cream in the Israeli-occupied West Bank. Lawyers for Ben & Jerry's independent directors did not respond to requests for comment. Unilever and its lawyers also did not respond. Magnum said that it welcomed Castel's decision, which it said significantly narrowed the case, and that the Ben & Jerry's brand is thriving. Ben & Jerry's accused Unilever of violating the 2000 merger agreement by censoring its speech, which has included protests against the war in Gaza, and ousting a chief executive who supported the company's social activism. The alleged censorship also included an effort to suppress planned criticism of President Trump as he began his second White House term. In addition, it accused Unilever of violating a 2022 settlement over the sale of Ben & Jerry's trademark rights in Israel, by failing to pay \$2.5 million to Ben & Jerry's and \$2 million to support Palestinian almond farmers. Unilever denied censoring Ben & Jerry's and said the former chief executive voluntarily resigned. Castel said the merger agreement's "plain meaning" did not afford Ben & Jerry's Class I directors and the Ben & Jerry's Foundation a right to sue on behalf of the company, including on the appointment and removal of directors. The judge said the directors could challenge new board eligibility requirements. He also said directors could sue over the missed payments on their own behalf, not on Ben & Jerry's behalf. Unilever and Magnum agreed that claims over the missed payments could proceed for now, court papers show.

— REUTERS

MEDIA

FOUNDER OF FIRM THAT PAID FORMER FORBES EDITOR \$6M EXPLAINS PAYMENT

The founder of a research firm explained Monday why he paid \$6 million to Randall Lane (below right), the former top editor of Forbes, who was fired after the media outlet learned of the transaction. Lane, the former chief content officer of Forbes, received the multimillion-dollar payment "in recognition of the services and guidance" he provided to RJ Shook, the founder of Shook Research, including helping him sell the firm last year, Shook said in a statement to The New York Times. Lane helped forge a partnership between Forbes and Shook's firm after the two men met in 2011, Shook added. Shook Research provides rankings of financial advisers to Forbes, which uses the data to compile some of its popular and lucrative lists. "My actions were taken with the best intentions, but ultimately the payment was a mistake," Shook said. "I deeply regret that this has raised questions about the integrity and independence of Shook's rankings." Shook said he paid Lane after selling a controlling stake in Shook Research to PPC Enterprises, a private equity firm, last year. Lane had no comment. In a statement to the Times, he called the payment "a gift" and said not disclosing it was a "serious error in judgment." Shook Research said it would take steps to "further strengthen and demonstrate the independence of its rankings." Those steps include commissioning an independent review of the company's governance, creating a new "independence charter" to reaffirm that its rankings cannot be purchased, and providing increased transparency about how it collects data. The company also said it plans to change its brand, a process that was started in February. Shook Research said Lane was not involved in the rankings. In a statement, Forbes said it had retained outside counsel to conduct "an independent and careful review of the facts," adding that it was "exploring all appropriate actions to hold Mr. Lane to full account." It called the payment "unacceptable" and inconsistent with its policies.

— NEW YORK TIMES



MERGER

CALIFORNIA CANCELS TALKS WITH PARAMOUNT OVER WARNER BROS. MERGER



California's attorney general has canceled a meeting with representatives of Paramount that was scheduled for Monday to begin discussing a settlement of the state's lawsuit seeking to block Paramount's proposed acquisition of Warner Bros. Discovery. Rob Bonta (left), the attorney general, called off the meeting late Sunday, accusing Paramount of acting in bad faith. In a statement to The New York Times, Bonta, a Democrat, accused Paramount of leaking details of a meeting the parties held Friday. "Not only did Paramount leak the alleged substance of settlement discussions, but they misrepresented these discussions, demonstrating a lack of good faith," Bonta said in the statement. "As soon as Paramount stops playing games and engages sincerely, my office is happy to meet again." A Paramount spokesperson on Monday disputed the accusations from Bonta and said the company was not responsible for sharing information on the confidential talks. "We share AG Bonta's concerns about the public discussions and misreporting that has surrounded this deal," Paramount said in a statement. "We remain hopeful and stand ready to continue good faith discussions to resolve the attorneys general suit and move forward with our plans for increased competition and increased output to the benefit of the talent and entertainment workers." The Monday meeting was supposed to be preliminary, and there was never any assurance that it would lead to meaningful negotiations toward a settlement. But the possibility that the two sides could begin moving toward an agreement was seen as something of a breakthrough after Paramount threatened to leave California and Governor Gavin Newsom expressed a preference for settling the case. Paramount's proposed \$111 billion purchase of Warner Bros. would create a media giant, combining two major movie studios, multiple streaming services, and the news outlets CNN and CBS News. Last month, California led a group of 12 state attorneys general in suing to block the deal, arguing it would create a company with outsize market power in cable television and movie studios.

— NEW YORK TIMES

HOUSING

ZILLOW AND REDFIN RESOLVE LITIGATION OVER DEAL FTC CLAIMS SUPPRESSES RENTAL LISTINGS COMPETITION



The Federal Trade Commission has reached a settlement with Zillow and Redfin to resolve the regulator's claim that the companies made an illegal deal to suppress competition in online rental advertising. The FTC said Monday that it filed a proposed order with the US District Court for the Eastern District of Virginia. It essentially requires Redfin to restart its standalone rental housing listings business, which the commission says will restore competition in the market for rental property listings. The settlement also resolves litigation brought by state attorneys general in Arizona, Connecticut, New York, Virginia, and Washington. "This settlement delivers better, quicker, more certain results for both renters and property management companies than we would have been able to achieve after prevailing at trial, including firm and enforceable commitments by Redfin to relaunch its rentals advertising business," Daniel Guarnera, director of the FTC's Bureau of Competition, said in a statement. In its complaint filed almost a year ago, the FTC claimed that in exchange for \$100 million and other compensation from Zillow, Redfin had agreed to shut down its internet listings and exclusively repost Zillow's apartment listings, transition its customers to Zillow, and stay out of the apartment listings market for up to nine years. The commission argued that the companies' February 2025 pact violated federal antitrust laws and could reduce incentives for competition, leading to higher prices and fewer choices for multifamily rental advertising customers. Zillow and Redfin said their agreement was not anticompetitive and benefited renters and property managers alike.

— ASSOCIATED PRESS

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DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Moderna initially kept the project small.

Moderna and Merck and a cancer vaccine

►STAT

Continued from Page D1

The rest of the world remained skeptical until last Wednesday, when Moderna and Merck revealed that a 1,137-volunteer study had shown the vaccine reduced the odds that melanoma that had been surgically removed would return or spread. Up to that point, investors were betting against Moderna's stock. Even after the news, some observers argue researchers should wait for fuller data — while skeptics of Moderna's core mRNA technology do the same.

Top-line results from large pharmaceutical firms are rarely reversed when full data emerge, but doubt is nothing new for Moderna's cancer treatment, called intismeran autogene. It has always been the breakthrough no one quite believed in.

Moderna initially kept the project small, and its board insisted it find a partner to pay for the product's expensive development. Even Merck, after agreeing to pay \$200 million to help develop the therapy, at one point wasn't willing to cover more costs (though it eventually did). And investors had been skeptical the treatment would prove effective any time soon; Moderna's stock had plummeted more than 80 percent from its pandemic peak, and when the results arrived, 13.5 percent of shares were sold short.

Yet Moderna's wildest gambit appears to have worked. Oncologists interviewed by STAT expect that it will become an important treatment for patients with a dreaded and deadly cancer. Financial analysts predict that sales could reach \$6 billion annually, according to Visible Alpha, which tracks consensus estimates.

That might only be the beginning. Intismeran autogene could represent the first success of an idea that dates back decades and has led to numerous failures among pharmaceutical companies: that a vaccine could train the immune system to hunt down cancer cells, similar to the way vaccines train it to attack infections. Several of the pharmaceutical industry's biggest successes have hinged on other ways of harnessing the immune system against tumors, but most such treatments never reached the market. Intismeran autogene, a new type of treatment called a neoantigen cancer immunotherapy, could represent a brand new way of attacking multiple cancers.

"I don't think this is going to be a one-off," said Eric H. Rubin, who led Merck's oncology clinical development until he retired in 2023. "I think this is likely to be something that's going to be helpful for a lot of cancer patients, which is just great."

This is the story of a biotech relay race in which one of the most well-funded startups in the industry's history found that what it thought was one of its riskiest projects turned out to be perhaps its biggest shot at success. It is the story of how one of the most storied large pharmaceutical companies was pulled along for the ride. And of how a researcher and drug company executive who had been holding on for decades to a radical idea he picked up while working at the National Institutes of Health lit the spark that may have made an anti-cancer dream come true.

From the start, intismeran had one chief advocate: Tal Zaks,

who was Moderna's chief medical officer until October 2021.

"Tal was the thinker on this clinical development plan," Hoge said. "He deserves all the credit on that. All of it."

Zaks, an oncologist, had emigrated from Israel in 1996 to work with Steven Rosenberg, one of the most lauded figures in cancer immunology, at the National Cancer Institute, with a focus on cancer vaccines. When he left to be a clinical fellow at the University of Pennsylvania, he had intended to work with Carl June, another of the field's giants. But then, in 2001, the results for the cancer drug Gleevec, a pill that could put a type of leukemia into remission, led him instead pursue drugs that worked by targeting specific genes.

But the idea of developing a cancer vaccine was still in his mind when he arrived at Moderna in 2015 after stints at GSK, Cephalon, and Sanofi. "The advantage we had, I think, at Moderna, is that we had an engineering mindset to the problem," Zaks told STAT. Hoge and Bancel, he noted, are engineers. "These are folks who understood how to combine biology, medicine, and engineering. And the beauty of what we had back in 2015, we had an understanding that we technically were at the cusp of being able to do something that really, at its core, enables this"

That something was mRNA, which some researchers now say may be the best technology for creating a cancer vaccine.

Until then, there had been two ideas for how to build a cancer vaccine. In one, scientists select which of the proteins on a tumor — called antigens — they want to present to the immune system. Most of these efforts stumbled.

The idea behind a "neoantigen" vaccine was to sequence an individual patient's tumor and identify specific mutations in that patient. Unlike a one-size-fits-all "antigen," the "neo" antigen is new, arising from the mutations caused by the cancer.

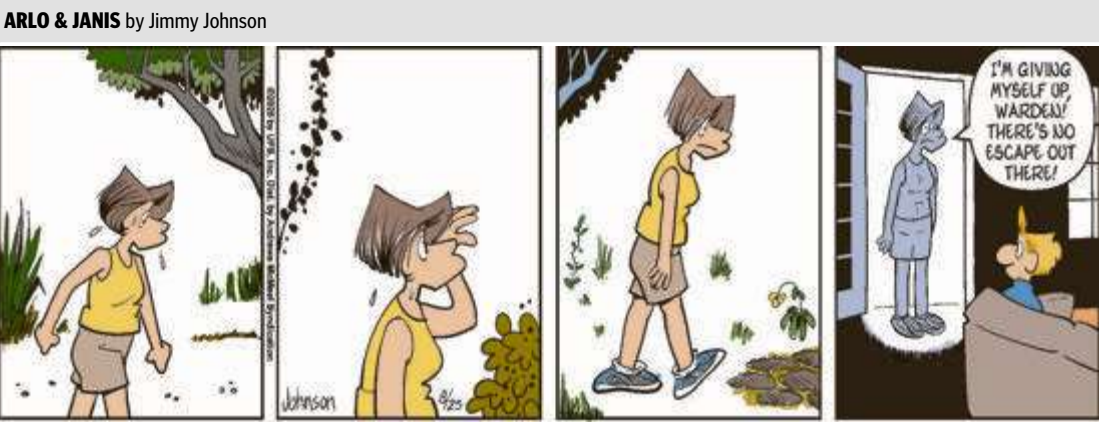
More than likely, scientists couldn't predict the exact antigen that would make a patient's immune system recognize a tumor. But if they could show enough neoantigens, hopefully one or two would stick out. Combine that with an immunotherapy like Keytruda, which helps counter tumors' ability to evade the immune system, then the body is on a path to overcome the cancer.

Before mRNA technology, cancer immunologists were tinkering with peptides and proteins and other molecules to try to build a vaccine. These more "traditional" biomaterials can induce an immune response against tumor antigens, but mRNA has particular advantages, experts told STAT.

"mRNA is where we want to be," said Elizabeth Jaffee, a cancer immunologist and the deputy director of the Sidney Kimmel Comprehensive Cancer Center at Johns Hopkins University. The body can develop an immune response to some other vaccine vectors, like modified viruses, meaning that they can only be given once before the immune system learns to destroy them.

That doesn't happen with mRNA and the lipid nanoparticle that encases it. "You can keep boosting [with more doses]. If you can't boost, particularly in cancer, then you have a problem," Jaffee said.

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UNIVERSAL CROSSWORD PUZZLE

NOT A GOOD LOOK BY CARINA DA ROSA | EDITED BY ANNA GUNDLACH

ACROSS

1 Skirt cut

5 Symptoms before a period

8 State of neglect

14 Delicate material

15 Just swell

16 Venues that might have Zambonis

17 *Teeny Apple music player of the 2000s

19 Replied "Nuh-uh"

20 Web portal that once promoted Hotmail and Bing

21 Dutch cheese

22 Vietnamese holiday that's a palindrome

23 Polite assent

25 Gem unit

27 *India's first female prime minister

31 Diminutive diminutive

33 Trick-or-treating score

34 America's national tree

35 "Let a person fantasize, will ya?!"

40 Tik ____

41 Layer of fur

42 "____ Miz"

43 *What lets you connect to the cloud while in the clouds

48 Mayhem

49 The whole package

53 Green prefix

54 Hot rod rod

55 Sense of self

56 Quick snooze

59 Judy glances ... or, phonetically, features of the starred clues' answers

DOWN

1 Like natto or okra

2 Temporary slip

3 Clickable images

4 "Bill & ____ Face the Music" (2020 film sequel)

5 Sponsored podcast interruption, for example

6 "My friend," in Montreal

7 Quickly read

8 Court figs.

9 Roth ____

10 Meat substitute made from gluten

11 Needing to be cooked more

12 They're worn with red suits

13 That, in Spanish

18 Intend

24 Actress Kunis

25 Trig follower

26 Polynesian figure

28 Link's "Good Mythical Morning" co-host

29 Itty-bitty battery

30 It gets chewed up and spat out

31 Feline nickname for Richard I

32 Major turnoff triggered by cringey behavior

36 Procedural drama on 56-Down

37 ____ days of summer

38 Pep rally holler

39 Landed

40 ____-tac-toe

44 Canadian \$1 coin

45 Like Madame Tussauds figures, compared to the real celebs

46 "Let me help with the dishes"

47 Make like a banana and split

50 2003 Outkast hit

51 Actor's rep

52 Puccini opera

54 "Stat!"

56 "Survivor" network

57 Brewpub brew

58 Winter hrs. in LA

60 Winter hrs. in NYC

JUMBLE CROSSWORDS™

by David L. Hoyt 8-25-26

ACROSS

1. Caravan

5. Courage

6. Disturb

7. Tranquil

DOWN

1. Small finch

2. Foster

3. Supervise

4. Mickey ____

CLUE: At age 23, he competed in the 1953 Mr. Universe contest.

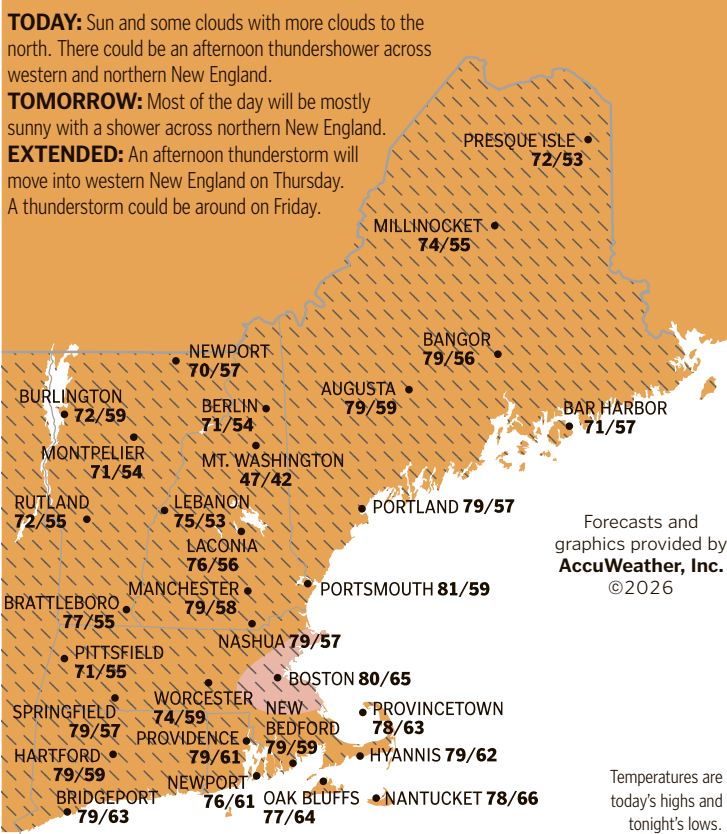
BONUS

How to play

Boston's forecast

TODAY				WEDNESDAY				THURSDAY				FRIDAY				SATURDAY			
6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.				6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.				6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.				6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.				6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.			
HIGH 78-83 LOW 63-68				HIGH 78-83 LOW 63-68				HIGH 80-85 LOW 66-71				HIGH 77-82 LOW 65-70				HIGH 75-80 LOW 61-66			
Mostly sunny; p.m. shower cannot be ruled out. Winds WSW 7-14 mph. Clear to partly cloudy tonight. Winds W 6-12 mph.				Mostly sunny. Winds ENE 6-12 mph. Partly cloudy at night. Winds SSW 6-12 mph.				Variable cloudiness. Winds SSW 8-16 mph. Mostly cloudy and humid at night with showers and a thunderstorm. Winds SSW 7-14 mph.				Mostly cloudy and humid with a thunderstorm. Winds SW 6-12 mph. Partly cloudy at night. Winds WNW 6-12 mph.				Pleasant and less humid with sunshine and some clouds. Winds ENE 6-12 mph. Partly cloudy at night. Winds WSW 4-8 mph.			

New England



Cities

Forecast high and low temperatures and conditions				Forecast high and low temperatures and conditions				Forecast high and low temperatures and conditions			
● Travel delays possible, ● C Clouds, ● F Fog, ● H Haze, ● I Ice, ● Pc Partly Cloudy, ● R Rain, ● Sh Showers, ● S Sun, ● Sn Snow, ● Fl Flurries, ● T Thunderstorms, ● W Windy				● Travel delays possible, ● C Clouds, ● F Fog, ● H Haze, ● I Ice, ● Pc Partly Cloudy, ● R Rain, ● Sh Showers, ● S Sun, ● Sn Snow, ● Fl Flurries, ● T Thunderstorms, ● W Windy				● Travel delays possible, ● C Clouds, ● F Fog, ● H Haze, ● I Ice, ● Pc Partly Cloudy, ● R Rain, ● Sh Showers, ● S Sun, ● Sn Snow, ● Fl Flurries, ● T Thunderstorms, ● W Windy			
Today	Tomorrow	Today	Tomorrow	Today	Tomorrow	Today	Tomorrow	Today	Tomorrow	Today	Tomorrow
Atlanta 93/70 Pc	90/72 T	Los Angeles 97/73 S	99/74 S	Seattle 85/56 Pc	76/58 Pc	Jerusalem 90/71 S	91/71 S	Atlanta 93/70 Pc	90/72 T	Los Angeles 97/73 S	99/74 S
Atlantic City 82/60 S	83/69 S	● Miami 92/80 T	92/79 T	Washington 85/67 S	87/72 Pc	London 77/62 Pc	79/64 Sh	Atlantic City 82/60 S	83/69 S	● Miami 92/80 T	92/79 T
Charlotte 87/67 Pc	88/70 T	● New Orleans 92/78 T	92/78 T	● Beijing 89/73 T	79/68 C	Moscow 61/54 Sh	62/50 C	Charlotte 87/67 Pc	88/70 T	● New Orleans 92/78 T	92/78 T
Chicago 80/66 Pc	83/65 T	New York City 78/64 S	80/70 S	Cancun 94/77 S	92/76 T	● Paris 78/64 R	82/65 Pc	Chicago 80/66 Pc	83/65 T	New York City 78/64 S	80/70 S
● Dallas 105/83 Pc	101/80 T	Philadelphia 83/65 S	85/71 S	● Mexico City 72/57 R	75/56 R	Rome 88/72 T	91/73 S	● Dallas 105/83 Pc	101/80 T	Philadelphia 83/65 S	85/71 S
● Denver 88/59 T	86/59 T	Phoenix 113/90 S	115/91 C	● Montreal 74/60 T	77/64 Pc	San Juan 92/80 R	91/80 T	● Denver 88/59 T	86/59 T	Phoenix 113/90 S	115/91 C
Detroit 80/60 Pc	81/64 T	Salt Lake City 92/70 S	96/70 Pc	● Toronto 76/60 R	78/64 S	Stockholm 67/44 Pc	71/44 Pc	Detroit 80/60 Pc	81/64 T	Salt Lake City 92/70 S	96/70 Pc
● Fort Myers 94/76 T	92/75 T	San Francisco 72/58 Pc	75/60 Pc	Vancouver 79/59 Pc	71/58 Pc	Tokyo 93/81 S	94/81 T	● Fort Myers 94/76 T	92/75 T	San Francisco 72/58 Pc	75/60 Pc

HOROSCOPES

HAPPY BIRTHDAY For Tuesday, Aug. 25, 2026: You are energetic, perceptive, and strategic. You're also a sensitive caregiver. This is a year of teaching and learning. Take time this year to renew your spiritual or religious beliefs. Explore philosophies that will give you a better self-awareness and get you closer to the true meaning of your life.

ARIES (March 21-April 19) Your interactions with friends and members of groups might be intense today. Someone might do something that catches you off guard. Or perhaps you'll meet someone unusual. Very likely, you'll feel sympathetic for someone else, and you might look for ways to help them. Tonight: Be friendly.

TAURUS (April 20-May 20) Encounters with bosses, parents, teachers, and the police might be intense today. Pull in your reins a bit in case you offend someone, or you might come on too strong. This could relate to something unexpected that impacts your money, possessions, or your earnings. Tonight: You're admired.

GEMINI (May 21-June 20) Steer clear of controversial subjects like politics, religion, and racial issues today. They will be intense and might quickly grow into an argument. If something catches you off guard, be careful because you might say something you could later regret. Be mindful of what you say and do. Tonight: Explore and learn something!

CANCER (June 21-July 22) If you're discussing how to divide or share something today — like something to do with shared property, taxes, or debt — make sure your facts are correct. Meanwhile, something unexpected might throw you off guard. Confusion with a boss or someone in authority also might be a factor. Tonight: Check your finances.

LEO (July 23-Aug. 22) Discussions with partners, spouses, and close friends are intense today. This might be because you're surprised by something a friend or group member does or says. This might rattle you! You also might feel sympathetic to the problems of someone far away. Tonight: Listen and cooperate.

VIRGO (Aug. 23-Sept. 22) This is a powerful time for you; nevertheless, something unex-

pected might occur if you attempt to improve your health or your job. This could relate to an authority figure or your efforts to help someone in need. Do what you can. Tonight: Work hard.

LIBRA (Sept. 23-Oct. 22) Surprise opportunities to socialize might pop up today. If so, act quickly. Romantic connections will be affectionate today. Likewise, you might feel affectionate toward your kids. However, parents should be extra vigilant, as this is also an accident-prone day for your kids. Tonight: Socialize!

SCORPIO (Oct. 23-Nov. 21) Your home routine might be interrupted today. You also might be involved with a parent or a female family member more than usual. If exploring new health remedies, be careful. Enjoy schmoozing with others today, especially younger people. Tonight: Relax at home.

SAGITTARIUS (Nov. 22-Dec. 21) Pay attention to everything you say and do today because this is a mildly accident-prone day for you. However, you will feel affectionate toward your kids as well as romantic partners. An unexpected inspiration might give you some wonderful creative ideas.

Tonight: An intense discussion.

CAPRICORN (Dec. 22-Jan. 19) You might impulsively purchase something today. You also might lose something, so protect what you own. Because something unexpected could impact your money or possessions, keep your eyes open! If you can help a family member today in practical ways or with a sympathetic ear, do so. Tonight: Check your money.

AQUARIUS (Jan. 20-Feb. 18) Today the Moon is in your sign lined up with Pluto, which can make you emotionally intense. In fact, you might feel overwhelmed by something. You also might feel obsessed with an idea. (This can make one jealous in love.) Be ready for a surprise invitation! Tonight: You're strong.

PISCES (Feb. 19-March 20) This is a restless day for you. Fortunately, you might attract money or favors from others to you. Romance will be affectionate, definitely. You also might be attracted to competitive sports, social activities, the arts, and playful times with kids. Enjoy your day! Tonight: Privacy.

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SUDOKU

	1	9	3		2	5	8	
2				9		8		6
					7			
		2		8		4		
8	3						7	5
		7		9		6		
				4				
1			2		9			7
	2	8	6		7	1	5	

Fill in the grid so that every row, every column, and every 3X3 box contains the digits 1 through 9. Puzzle difficulty levels: Easy on Monday and Tuesday, more difficult on Wednesday and Thursday, most difficult on Friday and Saturday. Tips and computer program at www.sudoku.com.

DAILY BRIDGE CLUB

BY FRANK STEWART
South dealer — N-S vulnerable

North
♠ 8 5
♥ J 10 8
♦ K 8 4
♣ A J 9 5 2

West
♠ Q 10 7 4 2
♥ A 9 2
♦ 10 5
♣ Q 6 3

East
♠ J 9 3
♥ 7 5 4 3
♦ Q J 9 6 3
♣ 7

South
♠ A K 6
♥ K Q 6
♦ A 7 2
♣ K 10 8 4

South 1 ♣
3 NT
West Pass
All Pass
North 3 ♣
East Pass
Opening lead — ♠ 4

Cy the Cynic says that statements starting with “Please don’t take this the wrong way” have a zero-percent success rate.

When Cy was North in my club’s penny game, he watched South go down at 3NT. West led a spade: five, jack, king. South then took the A-K of clubs. When East threw a diamond, declarer lost a club to West’s queen. He ducked West’s return of the queen of spades and won the third spade but had only eight tricks. West got in with his ace of hearts to cash two spades.

“Please don’t take this the wrong way,” Cy said to his partner, “but your play was wrong.”

“What do you mean?” South growled. “I would usually make overtricks.”

South should lead a heart at Trick Two; if dummy’s jack wins, he shifts to clubs for nine sure tricks. If West grabs the first heart to continue spades, South ducks and wins the third spade. Then he takes the king of clubs and leads to dummy’s jack. If East could win, South would lose at most two spades, a heart and a club.

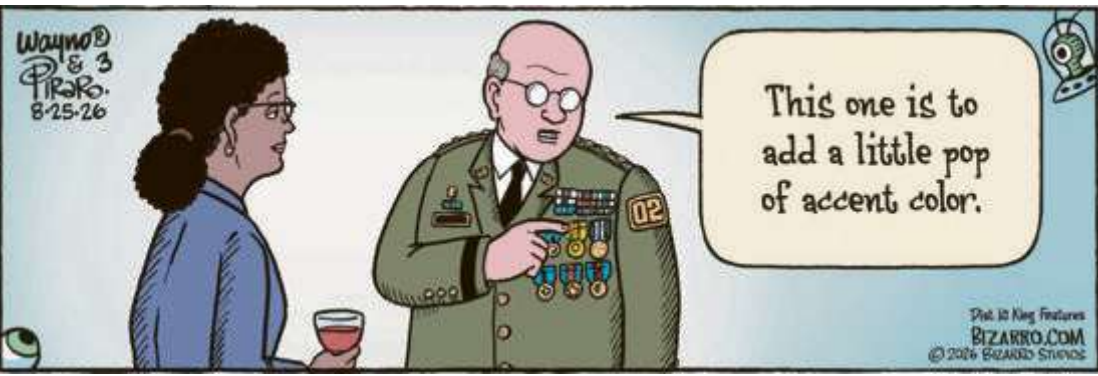
DAILY QUESTION You hold: ♠ Q 10 7 4 2 ♥ A 9 2 ♦ 10 5 ♣ Q 6 3. Your partner opens one diamond, you respond one spade, he bids two clubs and you return to two diamonds. Partner then bids two spades. What do you say?

ANSWER: Your two diamonds showed at most nine points, and partner would have passed if he saw no chance of game. With a minimum such as K J 3, 3, A Q 7 4 2, K 7 5 2, he would have raised your one spade to two. Bid four spades. Partner may hold K J 5, 3, A K 7 6 3, A J 5 2.

ZIPPY “Brain Drain” by Bill Griffith



BIZARRO by Wayno & Piraro



MOTHER GOOSE & GRIMM by Mike Peters



ADAM@HOME by Rob Harrell



ROSE IS ROSE by Pat Brady & Don Wimmer



Today's Crossword Solution

A	T	V	I		L	R	P		T	E	R	T	S
C	N	A	S		R	E	V		S	T	I	O	R
S	E	A	E		D	I	S		A	P	N	A	V
O	G	E		E	T	X	V				O	C	E
L	V	H	L	T	T	V			S	O	V	H	C
				I	F	I	M		H	G	I	T	E
	S	E	T						L	V	O	C	K
I	T	N	A	C	W	V	E		R	D	N	V	C
K	V	O	T	N	V	H						T	I
I	H	O	N	V					A	R	I	D	N
L	V	R	V	C					W	V	V	W	S
L	E	T							M	V	D	E	N
O	N	D	I	V	S				I	N	I	M	O
S	V	N	E	R	V				K	O	V		E
S	E	U	S	I	D				S	M	P	L	I

Today's Sudoku Solution

6	5	1	7	3	9	8	2	4
7	4	8	6	5	2	3	9	1
2	9	3	1	4	8	5	7	6
8	2	9	3	6	1	7	4	5
5	7	6	9	2	4	1	3	8
3	1	4	5	8	7	2	6	9
1	6	2	4	7	5	9	8	3
9	3	7	8	1	6	4	5	2
4	8	5	2	9	3	6	1	7